

تحفة الأطفال



TUḤFAT AL-AṬFĀL

WA-L-GHILMĀN FĪ TAJWĪD AL-QUR'ĀN

A CRITICAL SCHOLARLY ENGLISH EDITION

Translated, Annotated, and Explained for Advanced Students of Tajwīd



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AL-MULK INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

Texas, United States of America

CRITICAL EDITIONS IN QUR'ĀNIC STUDIES

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A Critical English Edition

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English editions for advanced students and researchers.*

تُحْفَةُ الْأَطْفَالِ وَالْغِلْمَانِ فِي تَجْوِيدِ الْقُرْآنِ

TUHFAT AL-AṬFĀL WA-L-GHILMĀN FĪ TAJWĪD AL-QUR'ĀN

The Gem of Children and Youths Concerning the Cantillation of the Qur'ān
by Sulaymān ibn Ḥusayn al-Jamzūrī (d. ca. 1200 AH / 1785 CE)



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Qur'ānic verses cited as examples throughout this edition are given in the muṣḥaf orthography with the riwāyah of Ḥafṣ 'an 'Āṣim, and are cited for the purpose of Tajwīd instruction and study; readers seeking legal rulings (fatāwā) should consult qualified scholars.

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A note on transliteration: this edition follows the Deutsche Morgenländische Gesellschaft (DMG) system. Macrons (ā, ī, ū) indicate long vowels; doubled letters indicate gemination (shaddah); a dot beneath a consonant (ṭ, ḍ, ṣ, ḏ) indicates emphasis; q represents the voiceless uvular stop qāf.

Typeset in EB Garamond and Amiri.

*To every teacher who has ever corrected a student's makhrāj with patience,
and to every student who has returned the next day to be corrected again.*

وصلی اللہ وسلم وبارک علی سیدنا محمد

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ABOUT THE EDITOR

Ahmad Sulaimiy is the editor, translator, and annotator of this edition, and the founder of Al-Mulk International University, Texas. His work focuses on making classical Islamic texts accessible to English-speaking students without sacrificing scholarly precision. This critical edition of *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl* reflects that commitment: a text that has shaped Qur'ānic recitation for over two centuries, presented with the linguistic, rhetorical, and phonetic apparatus that a serious student of Tajwīd deserves — and checked, verse by verse, against the primary sources before publication.

FRONT MATTER

ABOUT AL-MULK INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

Al-Mulk INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY is based in Texas, United States of America. This edition is published under its imprint for Critical Editions in Qur'ānic Studies.

PUBLISHER'S NOTE

Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl is, by any measure, one of the most widely memorized texts in the Islamic world — and one of the most thinly served by English-language scholarship. Most English treatments available to students are either simplified pamphlets, adequate for a first pass but too thin to answer a serious question, or bare translations with no apparatus at all. This edition was undertaken to close that gap: to give the English-speaking student of Tajwīd a text they can actually study from, verse by verse, with the same rigor a student of the Arabic original would expect from a properly supervised teacher.

That rigor cuts both ways. It means the apparatus is full — grammar, phonetics, rhetoric, worked examples, cross-references to Ibn al-Jazarī and al-Shāṭibī. It also means every claim in that apparatus was checked rather than assumed. Before this edition went to print, its entire verse-by-verse commentary was independently reviewed against the primary sources — every Qur’ānic citation verified against the muṣḥaf, every attribution checked, every phonetic rule tested against the standard Tajwīd manuals — and corrected wherever it fell short. That process, and what it found, is described in the Methodology and Editorial Principles that follow.

PREFACE

A critical edition makes a promise to its reader: that what is presented as fact has been checked, that what is uncertain has been marked as such, and that nothing has been quietly smoothed over for the sake of a cleaner page. For an ordinary text, breaking that promise is a scholarly failure. For a text whose entire purpose is teaching a student how to recite the words of the Qurʾān correctly, breaking it is something closer to a disservice to the reader's own religious practice.

This edition was built, and then rebuilt, with that distinction in mind. The first version of the manuscript was typeset faithfully from its source — but faithfulness to a source is not the same thing as accuracy, and a first pass at any large body of Tajwīd commentary will contain errors: a misquoted āyah, a rule stated backward, a scholar's work misattributed to another. Those errors were found, in this case, only because the text was deliberately re-examined by a dedicated scholarly review before publication, verse by verse, against the actual Qurʾānic text and the standard reference works of the science. Where that review found something wrong, it was corrected. Where it found something merely uncertain, the text now says so.

None of this makes the edition infallible — no single review of this scope can guarantee that. It does mean that the ordinary, expected errors of a first draft have been hunted down deliberately rather than left for the reader to discover. That is the standard this edition tries to meet, and the standard against which any future correction to it should be judged.

METHODOLOGY

Base text and readings. The Arabic text of *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl* follows the redaction associated with ‘Alī al-Ḍabbā’, cross-checked against the Qamḥāwī tradition (see Textual Notes). All Qur’ānic citations are given in the muṣḥaf orthography according to the riwāyah of Ḥafṣ ‘an ‘Āṣim, the transmission the poem itself assumes throughout.

Translation and gloss. Each verse receives a DMG transliteration, a three-column word-for-word gloss (Arabic, transliteration, gloss), and a smooth prose translation, in that order — so a reader can move from the literal to the readable without losing the connection between them.

Verification of citations. Every Qur’ānic example cited to illustrate a Tajwīd rule was checked against the actual wording of the sūrah and āyah given. Citations that did not match — a wrong reference, a paraphrase presented as a direct quotation, an example that did not in fact demonstrate the rule attached to it — were corrected or replaced with a verified citation that does.

Verification of attribution. Quotations or paraphrases attributed to Ibn al-Jazarī, al-Shāṭibī, or other named scholars were checked against their actual known works. Where an attributed passage could not be verified, or was found to belong to a different scholar or a different work entirely, the attribution was corrected, hedged, or removed.

Handling of uncertainty. Biographical and historical claims — dates, teacher-student relationships, disputed authorship of minor works — are hedged in proportion to how well they are actually attested in the secondary literature, rather than stated with uniform confidence. Where sources disagree, that disagreement is noted rather than silently resolved in favor of one account.

A note on scope: this methodology, and the corrections it produced, apply to the riwāyah of Ḥafṣ ‘an ‘Āṣim; a small number of Tajwīd particulars genuinely differ under other canonical readings and are outside the scope of what this edition’s review could check.

TRANSLITERATION SYSTEM

This edition follows the transliteration system of the Deutsche Morgenländische Gesellschaft (DMG), the standard used across most Western academic literature on Arabic and Islamic studies. The table below gives the correspondence for letters whose romanization is not self-evident from English orthography.

LETTER	RENDERS AS	NOTES
ء	ʾ	hamzah — a glottal stop
ع	ʿ	ʿayn — a voiced pharyngeal fricative
ث	th	voiceless dental fricative, as in English "think"
ذ	dh	voiced dental fricative, as in English "this"
ح	ḥ	voiceless pharyngeal fricative
خ	kh	voiceless uvular fricative, as in German "Bach"
ش	sh	voiceless postalveolar fricative
ص ض ط ظ	ṣ ḍ ṭ ḏ	emphatic (velarized/pharyngealized) counterparts of s, d, t, z (dh)
ق	q	voiceless uvular stop
ā ī ū	ā ī ū	long vowels (macron marks vowel length)
a i u	a i u	short vowels
shaddah	doubled letter	gemination, e.g. rabb, mudd
ة (in pause)	-ah	tā' marbūṭah, rendered -ah in pause and -at in construct/annexation

Names and technical terms that have well-established conventional English spellings (Qurʾān, Tajwid, sūrah, āyah) are given in their conventional form rather than a strict transliteration, except where precision requires the fuller form (e.g. al-Qurʾān in a construct phrase).

ABBREVIATIONS

AH Anno Hegirae — year of the Islamic (Hijri) calendar

CE Common Era

ca. circa — approximately

cf. compare

d. died

lit. literally

pl. plural

Q. Qurʾān, followed by sūrah:āyah (e.g. Q. 2:255)

r. narrated by / riwāyah of

sing. singular

ʾan "on the authority of" — used in chains of transmission (e.g. Ḥafṣ ʿan ʿĀṣim)

EDITORIAL PRINCIPLES

The Arabic text of the poem itself is never altered for the purposes of commentary; where the commentary's own analysis of a verse's grammar or phonetics required correction, the correction was made to the analysis, never to the verse.

Every factual claim is held to the standard of what can actually be verified. Where a claim could be confirmed, it is stated. Where it could not, it is hedged, or the uncertainty is stated outright, rather than presented with false confidence.

Corrections made during the editorial review are not hidden. This edition's front matter documents, in outline, the kinds of errors that review found and fixed, so that a reader who studied an earlier draft — or who compares this edition against another source — can see what changed and why.

No quotation is attributed to a scholar unless that attribution could be checked against a known work. Where an attribution appeared in the source material but could not be verified, it was either corrected to its actual source, softened to an unattributed statement of the underlying idea, or removed.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

This edition rests on the accumulated work of the Tajwīd tradition itself — al-Jamzūrī's own commentaries, the redactions of al-Ḍabbā' and Qamḥāwī, and the foundational treatments of Ibn al-Jazarī and al-Shāṭibī on which all later writing on this subject, including this volume, ultimately depends. Its debts to the standard reference works consulted are recorded throughout the commentary and in the Bibliography.

Named acknowledgements to individual readers, reviewers, and teachers will be added to future printings of this edition as appropriate.

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This edition's only tabular apparatus is the three-column word-for-word gloss table (Arabic, transliteration, gloss) accompanying every verse or verse group throughout Parts I–VIII. Letter-classification and articulation-point data are presented in running prose rather than in table form, and are not separately enumerated here.

READING GUIDE

The poem's eight parts open with a full-page Part divider giving the part's Arabic and English titles and the verse range it covers. Within each part, individual verses (or, where the source material treats several verses as a single unit, verse groups) are presented in a consistent sequence: Arabic text, transliteration, word-for-word gloss table, translation, linguistic and rhetorical analysis, and Tajwīd/phonetic commentary.

Worked Qur'ānic examples appear in bordered boxes set apart from the surrounding commentary, each citing the āyah, its transliteration, translation, and the specific point it demonstrates. A small set of additional callout types — set apart by border color and style — mark content of a particular kind: a teacher's practical note, a point reserved for advanced students, a historical aside, or a warning about a common student error.

Running heads give the book's title on the left-hand page and the current part or section on the right-hand page, so the reader's place in the text is visible at a glance without needing to consult the table of contents.

A NOTE TO THE READER

This critical edition preserves the verse-by-verse structure of al-Jamzūrī's original commentary tradition while organizing it under the eight parts the poem itself defines. Each verse is presented with its Arabic text, a DMG transliteration, a word-for-word gloss table, a smooth prose translation, linguistic and rhetorical analysis, and — where the source material provides it — Tajwīd and phonetic commentary grounded in the articulation points (makhārij) and characteristics (ṣifāt) of each letter.

Where a rule requires fuller exposition than a single verse allows, the commentary expands into a dedicated discussion — covering the rule's rationale ('illah), comparison with Ibn al-Jazārī's treatment in al-Muqaddimah, common errors made by non-native reciters, and worked Qur'ānic examples with full grammatical and phonetic analysis. These expository sections are set apart typographically from the verse-by-verse commentary that surrounds them.

Worked Qur'ānic examples are boxed throughout for quick reference, each citing the āyah in the muṣḥaf orthography, its transliteration, translation, and an explanation of how the rule under discussion applies. All such citations are indexed by sūrah in Appendix B.

This edition also includes, as a companion appendix, a shorter and considerably simpler guide to the same poem — useful as a quick-reference summary once the critical edition itself has been studied, or as a standalone primer for a beginning student not yet ready for the fuller apparatus.

TEXTUAL NOTES

Manuscripts, Commentaries, and Printed Editions

Al-Jamzūrī's *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl* belongs to a category of texts whose transmission has been governed less by manuscript stemmatics than by oral, chain-linked pedagogy (*ijāzah*). Unlike a literary work whose textual history is reconstructed primarily from divergent manuscript witnesses, the *Tuḥfah* has been transmitted continuously through unbroken teacher-to-student recitation in the Qur'ānic sciences, generation after generation, from al-Jamzūrī's own students down to the reciters of today. This does not mean the text is without minor variants; it means that its stability has been maintained by a living oral tradition running in parallel with, and prior to, its various printings.

The modern printed tradition of the *Tuḥfah* is dominated by two closely related redactions. The first is associated with 'Alī Muḥammad al-Ḍabbā' (d. 1380 AH / 1961 CE), who served as Chief of the Committee for the Revision of the Muṣḥaf at the Egyptian Dār al-Kutub, and whose gloss on the poem (often printed as *Al-Idā'ah fī Bayān Uṣūl al-Qirā'ah*) has become a standard reference for Egyptian and, by extension, much of the wider Sunni world's Qur'ānic schools. The second is the redaction and commentary tradition associated with Muḥammad al-Ṣādiq Qamḥāwī, whose *Al-Burhān fī Tajwīd al-Qur'ān* likewise incorporates and comments upon the *Tuḥfah*'s text. Where these two traditions diverge — chiefly in matters of punctuation, occasional word order in editorial headings, and vocalization of ambiguous forms — this edition follows al-Ḍabbā's redaction as the base text, noting significant divergences in the commentary where they affect meaning.

Two of al-Jamzūrī's own prose commentaries on his poem, *Faṭḥ al-Aqfāl bi-Sharḥ Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl* and the more detailed *Minḥat Dhī al-Jalāl fī Sharḥ Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl*, remain the primary internal witnesses to the author's own intended meaning, and both have been consulted throughout in resolving ambiguous constructions. Beyond al-Jamzūrī's own commentaries, this edition is indebted at every turn to the broader Tajwīd tradition synthesized by Ibn al-Jazarī (d. 833 AH / 1429 CE) in *al-Muqaddimah al-Jazariyyah*, and by Abū Muḥammad al-Qāsim al-Shāṭibī (d. 590 AH / 1194 CE) in *Ḥirz al-Amānī wa-Wajh al-Tahānī* (commonly known as *al-Shāṭibiyyah*), both of which are cited comparatively throughout the linguistic and Tajwīd commentary.

The transliteration and phonetic description offered in this edition reflect the *riwāyah* of Ḥafṣ 'an 'Āṣim, by far the most widely transmitted reading of the Qur'ān today. Readers working from other canonical readings (*qirā'āt*) should note that certain rulings — most consequentially some details of Madd and the pronunciation of hamzah — differ under other transmissions, and are outside the scope of a text whose own author restricted himself to Ḥafṣ.

A Critical English Edition of *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qurʾān*

by Sulaymān ibn Ḥusayn al-Jamzūrī (d. ca. 1200 AH / 1785 CE)

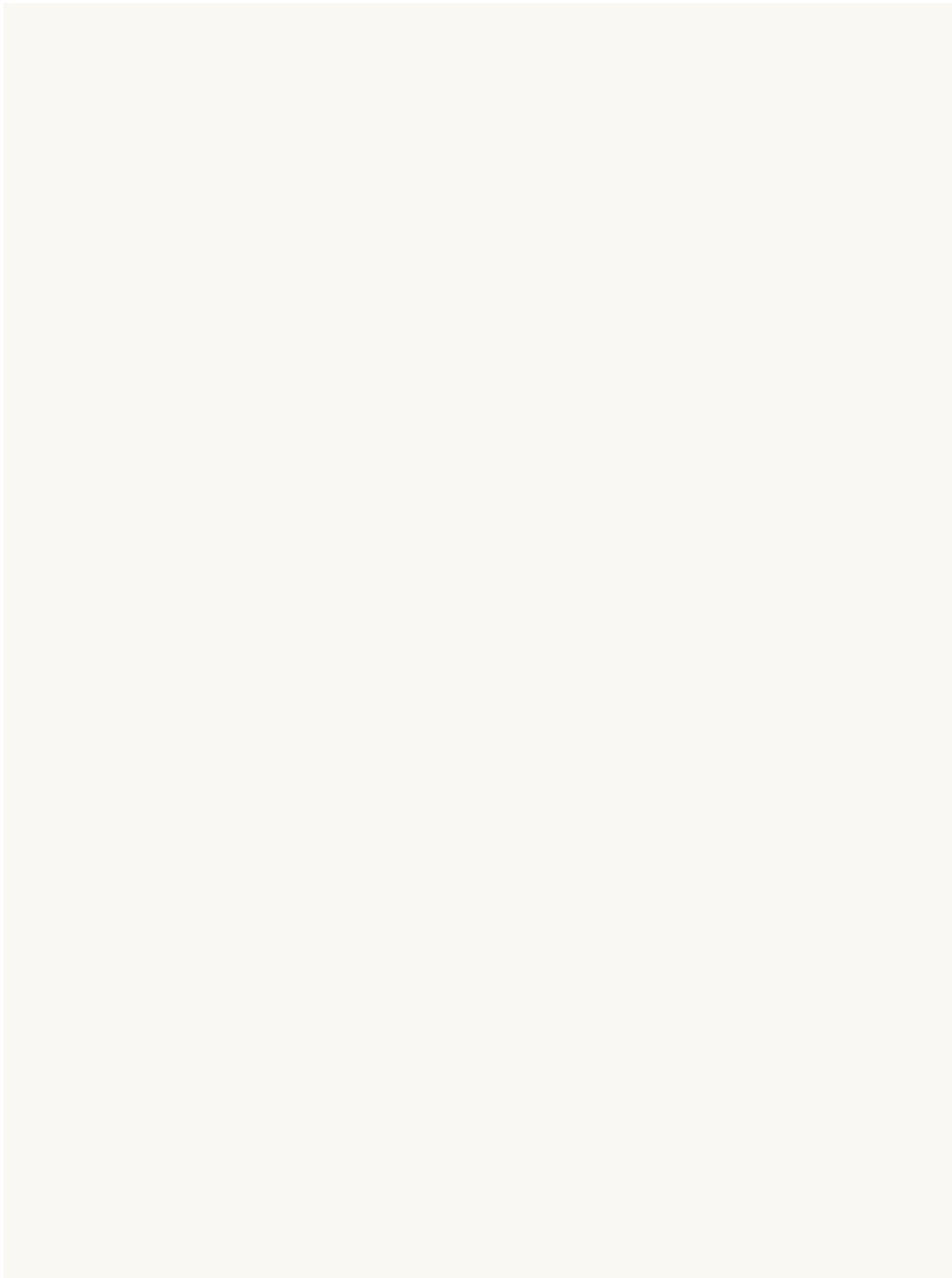
Translated, Annotated, and Explained for Advanced Students of Tajweed

INTRODUCTION

البَابُ

Introduction





The Significance of Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl

Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fi Tajwīd al-Qurʾān (The Gem of Children and Youths Concerning the Cantillation of the Qurʾān) is one of the most widely memorized and studied didactic poems in the science of Tajweed. Composed by the Egyptian scholar Sulaymān al-Jamzūrī (d. ca. 1200 AH / 1785 CE), it consists of 61 verses in the rajaz meter, a simple and memorable metre frequently used for instructional poetry in the Islamic tradition.

The poem's enduring popularity stems from its remarkable concision and clarity. In just over sixty lines, al-Jamzūrī manages to cover the essential rules that every student of Qurʾānic recitation must master: the four rules of nūn sākinah and tanwīn, the rules of mīm sākinah, the rules of the definite article lām, the rules of madd (prolongation), and the foundational classifications of identical, similar, and proximate letters. While it does not delve into the advanced minutiae of the ten canonical readings (al-qirāʾāt al-ʿashr), it provides an indispensable foundation for the reading of Ḥaḍḥ Ḥaḍḥ ʿan ʿĀṣim, the most prevalent transmission of the Qurʾān worldwide.

Al-Jamzūrī's Tuḥfah occupies a middle position in the traditional curriculum. It is studied after the memorization of the Qurʾān has begun, but before the student tackles more advanced works like Ibn al-Jazarī's al-Muqaddimah al-Jazariyyah or al-Shāṭibī's Ḥirz al-Amānī. Its affectionate title —"The Gem of Children and Youths"—reflects its pedagogical aim: to present the rules in a manner that is both accessible to the young and valuable to the mature student seeking a solid review.

The Author: Sulaymān al-Jamzūrī

Abū al-Rabīʿ Sulaymān ibn Ḥusayn ibn Muḥammad ibn Shalabī al-Jamzūrī, famously known as al-Afandī, was born in the village of Jamzūr, near Ṭanṭā in the Nile Delta of Egypt, in the mid-12th century AH (ca. 1160 AH / 1747 CE). He studied the Qurʾānic sciences in Cairo and Ṭanṭā, where he became a prominent student of the renowned reciter Nūr al-Dīn ʿAlī ibn ʿUmar al-Mayhī (d. ca. 1180 AH / 1766 CE), to whom he refers reverently in the Tuḥfah as "our shaykh, al-Mayhī, possessor of perfection."

Al-Jamzūrī was a prolific author in the field of Qurʾānic recitation. Besides the Tuḥfah, his known works include:

- Faḥ al-Aqfāl bi-Sharḥ Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl: A prose commentary on his own poem, often studied alongside the original text.
- Al-Risālah al-Faḥiyyah fi al-Tajwīd: A concise prose treatise on Tajweed.
- Minḥat Dhī al-Jalāl fi Sharḥ Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl: Another, more detailed commentary on the Tuḥfah.
- Kanz al-Maʿānī fi Sharḥ Ḥirz al-Amānī: A commentary on al-Shāṭibīyyah, demonstrating his expertise in the variant readings (qirāʾāt).

He passed away around the year 1200 AH (ca. 1785 CE) and was buried in his home village. His legacy, however, extends far beyond Egypt; the Tuḥfah is recited in Qurʾānic schools from Morocco to Indonesia, a testament to its clarity and pedagogical genius.

The Poem's Structure and Transmission

The *Tuḥfah* is composed in *raja* meter, a pattern of repeated feet (*mustaf'ilun* six times) that lends itself to easy memorization. The poem's language is clear, largely avoiding obscure vocabulary, though al-Jamzūrī skillfully employs grammatical constructions and rhetorical devices that merit close analysis.

The text has been transmitted reliably through the standard channels of Qur'ānic education (*ijāzah*). The most widely used printed editions are based on the commentaries of 'Alī al-Ḍabbā' (d. 1380 AH / 1961 CE), the renowned Egyptian master of Qur'ānic readings who served as the Chief of the Committee for the Revision of the Muṣḥaf in the Dār al-Kutub al-Miṣriyyah, and Muḥammad al-Ṣādiq Qamḥāwī. For this edition, I have relied on the widely available text as edited by al-Ḍabbā and cross-referenced with the recitation of contemporary scholars.

Notes on the Translation and Commentary

This translation aims to be both precise and readable. For each verse (*bayt*), I provide:

- The fully vocalized Arabic text.
- A DMG-standard transliteration.
- A word-for-word gloss.
- A smooth English translation in prose (and, where appropriate, a metrical verse translation).
- Detailed linguistic analysis of key grammatical structures and rhetorical features.
- Thorough Tajweed commentary, including definitions, comparison with other major texts, and phonetic guidance.
- Three Qur'ānic examples per rule, presented with full analysis.

A note on transliteration: I have adopted the Deutsche Morgenländische Gesellschaft (DMG) system for its widespread use in Islamic studies. Macrons (ā, ī, ū) indicate long vowels. The geminate (doubled) consonant is indicated by doubling the letter (e.g., nn). For the purpose of this text, I have added a superscript tilde over vowels to indicate nasalization (*ghunnah*) where necessary, e.g., [ṇ̃]. Emphatic consonants (ṭ, ḍ, ṣ, ḏ) are represented with a dot underneath; the voiceless uvular stop qāf is represented by q.

PART I

البَابُ الْأَوَّلُ

Prelude (Verses 1–5)



Al-Jamzūrī opens his poem with a standard Islamic prologue: the author identifies himself, praises God, invokes blessings upon the Prophet Muḥammad, and states the subject and purpose of his work. These five verses establish the spiritual and pedagogical framework for the technical rules that follow.

Verse 1

ARABIC TEXT

يَقُولُ رَاجِي رَحْمَةِ الْغَفُورِ
دَوِّمًا سُلَيْمَانُ هُوَ الْجَمْزُورِي

TRANSLITERATION

Yaqūlu rājī raḥmati l-ghafūri

dawman Sulaymānu huwa l-Jamzūrī

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
يَقُولُ	<i>yaqūlu</i>	He says
رَاجِي	<i>rājī</i>	one hoping for
رَحْمَةِ	<i>raḥmatī</i>	(the) mercy of
الْغَفُورِ	<i>al-ghafūri</i>	the Oft-Forgiving
دَوِّمًا	<i>dawman</i>	perpetually
سُلَيْمَانُ	<i>Sulaymānu</i>	Sulaymān
هُوَ	<i>huwa</i>	he
الْجَمْزُورِي	<i>al-Jamzūrī</i>	the Jamzūrī

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Sulaymān, the Jamzūrī, ever hoping for the mercy of the Oft-Forgiving, says:"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Verb-Subject Inversion: The verse begins with the verb *yaqūlu* ("he says"). This is a common stylistic feature in classical Arabic poetry, placing the action before the agent for emphasis. The subject of *yaqūlu* is not immediately apparent; it is delayed until the second hemistich (*Sulaymānu huwa l-Jamzūrī*). This creates a sense of anticipation.
2. The Phrase *Rājī Raḥmati l-Ghaḥūr*: The poet describes himself as *rājī*, the active participle of *rajā* (to hope). It is in the construct state (*idāfah*) with *raḥmati l-ghaḥūrī* ("the mercy of the Oft-Forgiving"). Note that the final *yā'* of *rājī* is elided (*maḥdhūfah*) in the text, which is standard for the indefinite nominative/genitive of a defective noun (*manqūs*), though it would be pronounced *rājin* in pause (*waqf*). In the context of the poem's meter, the *yā'* is dropped.
3. The Name of God *al-Ghaḥūr*: *Al-Jamzūrī* specifically chooses the divine name *al-Ghaḥūr* (The Oft-Forgiving) rather than, say, *al-Raḥmān* (The Most Merciful). This is an elegant rhetorical choice (*iltifāt*). The author, about to embark on a work of teaching the Divine Word, acknowledges his own shortcomings and places his reliance not on his own knowledge, but on God's forgiveness of his inevitable errors and deficiencies. This is an act of profound humility.
4. The Adverbial *Dawman*: *Dawman* is the indefinite accusative (*manṣūb*) of *dawm* (perpetuity). It functions as a *ḥāl* (circumstantial qualifier) modifying the implied state of the speaker. It means "continuously" or "forever." The hope for God's mercy is not a fleeting sentiment but a permanent state of being for the true scholar.
5. Emphatic Pronoun *Huwa*: The phrase *Sulaymānu huwa l-Jamzūrī* contains the third-person masculine singular pronoun *huwa* between the subject and predicate. In Arabic grammar, this is called *ḍamīr al-faṣl* (the pronoun of separation) or *ḍamīr al-ʿimād* (the pronoun of support). Its function is twofold: (a) it prevents the adjective *al-Jamzūrī* from being parsed as a mere modifier of *Sulaymān*, and (b) it adds emphasis and definiteness to the predicate, roughly equivalent to "Sulaymān, he indeed is the Jamzūrī."

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

While this verse is the poet's own speech and not a Qur'ānic āyah, it is traditionally recited with careful attention to the rules of Tajweed as an act of respect and practice.

- *Yaqūlu*: The *qāf* (ق) is a voiceless uvular stop [q]. For English speakers, this is a new articulation. It is produced by raising the back of the tongue to touch the soft palate (uvula). It should not be pronounced like an English /k/ (which is velar) or a glottal stop. The long vowel *ū* follows, a pure [u:] without the glide [w] that English speakers often add at the end.
- *Rājī*: The *jīm* (ج) is a voiced palato-alveolar affricate [dʒ] in the pronunciation of Ḥafṣ, similar to the English "j" in "judge." Some other qirā'āt may realize it as a fricative [ʃ] or a palatal stop [j].
- *al-Ghaḥūr*: The *ghayn* (غ) is a voiced uvular fricative [ɣ]. It is the voiced counterpart of *khā'* (خ [x]). English speakers can approximate it by gargling water without the vocal cord vibration, then adding voice. It is emphatic (*musta'li*), meaning the tongue is raised towards the soft palate, giving it a "dark" or "heavy" quality.

- Dawman: The wāw (و) here is a wāw al-līn (diphthongal wāw) because it is preceded by a fathāh. It is pronounced as the diphthong [aʊ], similar to the English "ow" in "how."
- Sulaymānu: The sīn (س) is a voiceless alveolar sibilant [s], lighter and sharper than the English /s/. The tongue tip is closer to the teeth.
- al-Jamzūrī: The jīm (ج) is [d̪]. The zāy (ز) is a voiced alveolar sibilant [z], again with the tongue tip near the upper teeth. The long vowel ū is pure [u:].

Verse 2

ARABIC TEXT

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ مُصَلِّيًا عَلَى
مُحَمَّدٍ وَآلِهِ وَمَنْ تَلَا

TRANSLITERATION

Al-ḥamdu li-llāhi muṣallīyan ‘alā

Muḥammadin wa-ālihī wa-man talā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
الْحَمْدُ	<i>al-ḥamdu</i>	The praise
لِلَّهِ	<i>li-llāhi</i>	belongs to God
مُصَلِّيًا	<i>muṣallīyan</i>	(while) invoking blessings
عَلَى	<i>‘alā</i>	upon
مُحَمَّدٍ	<i>Muḥammadin</i>	Muḥammad
وَآلِهِ	<i>wa-ālihī</i>	and his family
وَمَنْ	<i>wa-man</i>	and upon whom(ever)
تَلَا	<i>talā</i>	follows / recites

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Praise belongs to God, as I invoke blessings upon Muḥammad, and upon his family, and upon whoever follows [in reciting the Qur'ān]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. The Inaugural Formula: Al-Jamzūrī begins with the ḥamdalah (praising God) and ṣalāh (invoking blessings on the Prophet). This mirrors the opening of the Qur'ān (Sūrat al-Fātiḥah) and follows the Prophetic Sunnah: "Every matter of importance that is not begun with praise of God is severed (from blessings)." This is a near-universal convention in classical Islamic scholarly works.
2. The Circumstantial Muṣalliyan: The word muṣalliyan is an active participle in the accusative case (manṣūb). It functions as a ḥāl (circumstantial qualifier) from the implied speaker of the praise. It means "while invoking blessings" or "in a state of invoking blessings." The praise of God is inextricably linked with the invocation of blessings upon His final Messenger. This is a profound theological and rhetorical pairing.
3. The Phrase Wa-Man Talā: The verb talā means "to follow" or "to recite." As a relative clause (ṣilat al-mawṣūl) following man ("whoever"), it creates a beautiful ambiguity. It refers most directly to the followers of the Prophet—the Companions and the righteous successors—but it also includes anyone who recites the Qur'ān, i.e., the student of Tajweed who is reading this very poem. Thus, the author subtly includes his reader in the sphere of his prayer. This is a generous and encouraging gesture.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Al-ḥamdu li-llāhi: The lām in the word Allāh is emphatic (mufakhkhamah) [l^ʕ] because it is preceded by a ḍammah (in the word li-llāhi). The hā' (ه) is a voiceless glottal fricative [h], produced by airflow through the open glottis.
- Muṣalliyan 'alā: The ṣād (ص) is an emphatic, voiceless alveolar sibilant [s^ʕ]. It is heavier than the English /s/. The 'ayn (ع) in 'alā is a voiced pharyngeal fricative [ʕ]. This sound has no English equivalent. It is produced by constricting the pharynx muscles and vibrating the vocal cords. The tongue root is drawn back towards the pharyngeal wall.
- Muḥammadin: The ḥā' (ح) is a voiceless pharyngeal fricative [ħ], the unvoiced counterpart of 'ayn. It sounds like a strong, breathy "h" produced deep in the throat.
- Ālihī: The hamzah after the long ā is a glottal stop [ʔ], a catch in the throat, as in the middle of the English interjection "uh-oh."
- Talā: The tā' (ت) is a voiceless, unemphatic alveolar stop [t], lighter than the English /t/ which is often aspirated.

Verse 3

ARABIC TEXT

وَبَعْدُ هَذَا النَّظْمُ لِلْمُرِيدِ

فِي النُّونِ وَالتَّنْوِينِ وَالْمُدُّودِ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-ba‘du hādha n-naẓmu li-l-murīdi

fi n-nūni wa-t-tanwīni wa-l-mudūdī

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَبَعْدُ	<i>wa-ba‘du</i>	And after
هَذَا	<i>hādha</i>	this
النَّظْمُ	<i>an-naẓmu</i>	the poem / versification
لِلْمُرِيدِ	<i>li-l-murīdi</i>	(is) for the seeker / aspirant
فِي	<i>fi</i>	concerning
النُّونِ	<i>an-nūni</i>	the nūn
وَالْتَّنْوِينِ	<i>wa-t-tanwīni</i>	and the tanwīn
وَالْمُدُّودِ	<i>wa-l-mudūdī</i>	and the prolongations

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And after this [preamble]: This versification is for the dedicated seeker, concerning [the rules of] the nūn [sākinah], the tanwīn, and the prolongations."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. The Transition Wa-Ba‘du: The phrase *ammā ba‘du* (or simply *wa-ba‘du*) is the classical Arabic discourse marker for moving from the introduction to the main body of a text. It signals the end of the *khuṭbah* (sermon/introduction) and the beginning of the subject matter. Ba‘du is in the accusative case (*maṣnūb*) as an adverb of time (*ẓarf zamān*), but it is indeclinable (*mabnī*) on the *ḍammah* because it is a truncated expression. The implied full phrase is *wa-ba‘da mā taqaddama min al-ḥamdi wa-l-ṣalāti* ("and after what has preceded of praise and blessings").
2. The Word al-Murīd: The poem is said to be *li-l-murīd* ("for the seeker" or "for the aspirant"). Murīd is the active participle of *arāda* (to will, to desire). It is stronger than simply *ṭālib* (student). It implies not just learning, but a sincere, dedicated, and active desire to master the

science of Tajweed for the sake of God. This is a subtle reminder that the intention (niyyah) is paramount.

3. Delimitation of Topics: Al-Jamzūrī explicitly names the three main topics of his poem: an-nūn (meaning nūn sākinah), at-tanwīn, and al-mudūd (the prolongations). While the poem does cover other topics (mīm sākinah, lām al-ta'rif, etc.), these three are the most frequent and foundational. By naming them, he signals their importance. Some scholars note that he mentions the first topic (nūn) and the last major topic (madd) to encompass the entire work, a rhetorical device known as dhikr al-ṭarafayn (mentioning the two extremes to indicate the whole).

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Hādha n-naẓmu: The nūn of hādha is assimilated into the following nūn of an-naẓmu? Actually, hādha ends in an alif maqṣūrah represented by a yā' without dots, which is a long ā. There is no nūn to assimilate. The ẓā' (ظ) in an-naẓmu is an emphatic, voiced interdental fricative [ḏ]. It is the emphatic counterpart of dhāl (ذ [ḏ]). The tongue tip protrudes slightly between the teeth, and the back of the tongue is raised.
- Li-l-murīdi: The rā' (ر) is a voiced alveolar trill [r]. When it has a kasrah (as here, ri), it is light (muraqqaqah). The trill should be a single vibration, not a prolonged rolling, to avoid generating extra letters.
- An-nūni: The nūn is geminated (doubled) due to the assimilation of the lām of the definite article (al-nūn → an-nūn). This gemination must be held for the duration of one vowel (two counts), with a clear nasalization (ghunnah).
- Wa-t-tanwīni: Similarly, the tā' is geminated due to the assimilation of the lām (al-tanwīn → at-tanwīn).
- Wa-l-mudūdi: The dāl (د) is a voiced, unemphatic alveolar stop [d]. The mīm (م) of the definite article is not assimilated because the lām of al- before a moon letter (dāl is a moon letter) is pronounced clearly (iẓhār qamarī).

Verse 4

ARABIC TEXT

سَمِيَّتُهُ بِتُحْفَةِ الْأَطْفَالِ
عَنْ شَيْخِنَا الْمَيِّيِّ ذِي الْكَمَالِ

TRANSLITERATION

Sammaytuhū bi-Tuḥfati l-aṭfāli

‘an shaykhinā l-Mayhiyyi dhī l-kamālī

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
سميته	<i>sammaytuhū</i>	I have named it
بُحْفَةٍ	<i>bi-Tuḥfati</i>	The Gem of
الأطفال	<i>al-aṭfālī</i>	the Children
عَنْ	<i>‘an</i>	on the authority of / from
شَيْخِنَا	<i>shaykhinā</i>	our shaykh
الْمَيِّ	<i>al-Mayhiyyi</i>	al-Mayhī
ذِي	<i>dhī</i>	possessor of
الْكَامِلِ	<i>al-kamālī</i>	perfection

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"I have named it 'The Gem of the Children,' [transmitting it] from our shaykh, al-Mayhī, the possessor of perfection."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. The Title Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl: The word tuḥfah means a precious gift or a gem. By calling it a gift for children, al-Jamzūrī exhibits both humility (he is not presenting a weighty tome for scholars) and pedagogical wisdom (the poem's simplicity makes it suitable for the young, but its content is essential for all). The term aṭfāl (children) also evokes the idea of beginners in the science, regardless of age.
2. The Preposition ‘An: The use of ‘an ("on the authority of" or "from") is critical. In the Islamic sciences, the chain of transmission (sanad or isnād) is paramount. By stating that his knowledge comes ‘an shaykhinā, al-Jamzūrī anchors his poem in a living oral tradition, tracing back through his teacher al-Mayhī to the Prophet Muḥammad. This establishes the authority and reliability of his instruction.
3. The Epithet Dhī al-Kamāl: Al-Jamzūrī praises his teacher as dhī al-kamāl ("possessor of perfection"). Dhī is one of the six nouns in Arabic (al-asmā’ al-sittah) that are declined with letters (wāw in the nominative, alif in the accusative, yā’ in the genitive). Here it is in the genitive case (majrūr) as an adjective for al-Mayhī, hence dhī. This praise is an act of respect and gratitude (adab), and it implicitly assures the student that the knowledge contained herein is sound and perfected.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Sammaytuhū: The sīn (س) is a light, sharp [s]. The mīm is geminated (mushaddadah), so the ghunnah (nasalization) is prominent and must last for two vowel counts.
- Bi-Tuḥfati: The ḥā' (ح) is a voiceless pharyngeal fricative [ħ]. The fā' (ف) is a voiceless labiodental fricative [f], identical to the English /f/.
- al-Aṭṭālī: The ṭā' (ط) is an emphatic, voiceless alveolar stop [tʰ]. It is heavier and deeper than the English /t/. The fā' is [f].
- 'An shaykhinā: The 'ayn (ع) in 'an is [ʕ]. The shīn (ش) is a voiceless palato-alveolar fricative [ʃ], like the English "sh" in "she."
- Al-Mayhiyyi: The hā' (ه) is [h]. The doubled yā' at the end is for the attributive adjective (nisbah), pronounced -iyy.
- Dhī l-kamālī: The dhāl (ذ) is a voiced interdental fricative [ð], like the "th" in the English "this." The tongue tip protrudes slightly between the teeth.

Verse 5

ARABIC TEXT

أَرْجُو بِهِ أَنْ يَنْفَعَ الطُّلَّابَا
وَالْأَجْرَ وَالْقَبُولَ وَالثَّوَابَا

TRANSLITERATION

Arjū bihī an yanfa'a ṭ-ṭullābā

wa-l-ajra wa-l-qabūla wa-th-thawābā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَرْجُو	<i>arjū</i>	I hope
بِهِ	<i>bihī</i>	by means of it
أَنْ	<i>an</i>	that
يَنْفَعُ	<i>yanfa'a</i>	it benefits
الطُّلَّابَا	<i>aṭ-ṭullābā</i>	the students
وَالْأَجْرَ	<i>wa-l-ajra</i>	and (I hope for) the reward

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالْقَبُولَ	<i>wa-l-qabūla</i>	and the acceptance
وَالثَّوَابَا	<i>wa-th-thawābā</i>	and the recompense

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"I hope, by means of it, that it may benefit the students, and [I hope for] the [divine] reward, the acceptance, and the [heavenly] recompense."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. The Supplication for Benefit: Arjū ("I hope") expresses the author's humility. He has done the work of composing the poem, but he acknowledges that any benefit derived from it is ultimately from God. This is a practical application of the theology of tawakkul (reliance on God) combined with sa'y (striving).
2. The Verb Yanfa'a: This is in the subjunctive mood (manṣūb) because it follows the subordinating particle an. The implied phrase is arjū an yanfa'a ("I hope that it may benefit").

The Distinction between Ajr, Qabūl, and Thawāb:

- Al-Ajr (Reward): This is the general compensation for a good deed. It can be in this world or the next.
- Al-Qabūl (Acceptance): This is the most critical of the three. It is not merely reward for the deed, but God's active acceptance of the deed itself. A deed can be rewarded in some measure, but acceptance (qabūl) implies God's pleasure and the deed's spiritual efficacy. Many righteous predecessors (salaf) were more concerned with the acceptance of their deeds than with the deeds themselves.
- Ath-Thawāb (Recompense): This is the specific reward in the Hereafter. By mentioning it after al-ajr, al-Jamzūrī may be employing a general-to-specific rhetorical progression ('umūm khuṣūṣ).
- 4. The Alif al-Iṭlāq: The final alif in aṭ-ṭullābā and ath-thawābā is the alif al-iṭlāq (the alif of poetic license). It is added to the end of a word to maintain the meter and rhyme of the poem. It does not change the word's grammatical case or meaning. It is pronounced as a long ā.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Arjū: The rā' (ر) is [r] and here it is light because it has a ḍammah (in ru) which is not a heavy vowel context for rā'. The jīm (ج) is [d̪].
- Biḥī: The hā' (ه) has a kasrah and a yā' (ي) after it, creating a long ī sound [i:].
- Yanfa'a: The 'ayn (ع) is [ʕ].
- Aṭ-ṭullābā: The ṭā' (ط) is geminated due to the assimilation of the lām of the definite article (al-ṭullāb → aṭ-ṭullāb). It is an emphatic [tʰ] held for two counts.
- Wa-l-ajra: The rā' (ر) here is light because it has a faṭḥah (ra).

- Wa-l-qabūla: The qāf (ق) is a voiceless uvular stop [q], similar to /k/ but articulated much further back, at the uvula.
- Wa-th-thawābā: The thā' (ث) is a voiceless interdental fricative [θ], like the "th" in English "think." It is geminated here due to the assimilation of the lām of the definite article. The tongue tip must protrude slightly between the teeth.

PART II

البَابُ الثَّانِي

The Rules of Nūn Sākinah and Tanwīn (Verses
6–16)



Overview

The rules governing the pronunciation of the nūn sākinah (the letter nūn with a sukūn, i.e., a quiescent nūn) and the tanwīn (the nunation, a final nūn sound indicated by double vowels) are among the most frequent and fundamental in Tajweed. Al-Jamzūrī dedicates eleven verses (6–16) to this topic, outlining four distinct rules: al-Iẓhār (clarification), al-Idghām (assimilation), al-Iqlāb (conversion), and al-Ikhfāʾ (concealment).

VERSE 6

The Four Rules

ARABIC TEXT

لِلنُّونِ إِنْ تَسْكُنَ وَلِلتَّوْنِ
أَرْبَعٌ أَحْكَامٌ خُذْ بَيِّنِي

TRANSLITERATION

Lin-nūni in taskun wa li-t-tanwīni

arbaʿu aḥkāmin fa-khudhabyīni

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
لِلنُّونِ	<i>li-n-nūni</i>	For the nūn
إِنْ	<i>in</i>	if
تَسْكُنَ	<i>taskun</i>	it is quiescent
وَلِلتَّوْنِ	<i>wa</i>	li-t-tanwīni and for the tanwīn
أَرْبَعٌ	<i>arbaʿu</i>	four
أَحْكَامٌ	<i>aḥkāmin</i>	rulings
خُذْ	<i>fa-khudh</i>	so take
بَيِّنِي	<i>tabyīni</i>	my clarification

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"For the nūn, when it is quiescent, and for the tanwīn, there are four rulings – so take my clarification."

LINGUISTIC ANALYSIS

- Conditional In: The verse uses the conditional particle in ("if"), which governs two verbs in the jussive (majzūm) mood. Here, taskun is jussive. The response (jawāb) to the condition is the nominal sentence arba' u aḥkāmīn ("there are four rulings"), which does not require a jussive verb.
- Tabyīnī: The word tabyīn means "clarification" or "explanation." The yā' at the end is the first-person possessive pronoun ("my"). The phrase khudh tabyīnī is an idiomatic way of saying "take my explanation" or "learn my detailed exposition."

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definitions:

- Nūn Sākinah (النون الساكنة): A nūn (ن) that is devoid of any of the three short vowels (faṭḥah, ḍammah, kasrah) and is marked by a sukūn (◌ْ). It is an integral part of a word's structure and can occur in nouns, verbs, and particles (e.g., min, an'amta, lan). It remains present both in continuous recitation (waṣl) and when pausing (waqf).
- Tanwīn (التنوين): Literally "nunation." It is an extra, unscripted nūn sākinah that attaches to the end of most fully declinable nouns (ism munṣarif). It is represented in writing by doubling the final short vowel: -un (◌ْ), -an (◌َ), -in (◌ِ). It is pronounced only when continuing the recitation (waṣl). When pausing (waqf), the tanwīn is either dropped (for -un and -in) or converted into a long alif (for -an).

The Four Rulings (al-Aḥkām al-Arba'ah):

These rulings are applied based on the letter that immediately follows the nūn sākinah or tanwīn. The 29 letters of the Arabic alphabet are divided into four categories with respect to this rule:

1. Al-Izhār al-Ḥalqī (Clarification at the Throat Letters): 6 letters.
2. Al-Idghām (Assimilation): 6 letters.
3. Al-Iqlāb (Conversion): 1 letter.
4. Al-Ikhfā' al-Ḥaqīqī (True Concealment): the remaining 15 letters.

Phonetic Note for English Speakers: The nūn (ن) is a voiced alveolar nasal [n], similar to the English /n/. However, its pronunciation in Arabic is lighter and the tongue tip touches the upper gum ridge just behind the teeth. The tanwīn is exactly the same sound [n] at the end of a word.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES FOR CONTEXT (GENERAL):

- Nūn Sākinah: Min qablu (مِنْ قَبْلُ) [Q 2:25], An'amta (أَنْعَمْتَ) [Q 1:7], Lan tanālū (لَنْ تَنَالُوا) [Q 3:92].
- Tanwīn: 'Adhābun alīm (عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ) [Q 2:10], Ghafūran raḥīm (غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ) [Q 2:173].

The detailed application of each rule follows in the subsequent verses.

A Critical English Edition of Tuhfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qurʾān

Part II (Continued): The Rules of Nūn Sākinah and Tanwīn

VERSE 7

Al-Izhār al-Ḥalqī – The Clarification at the Throat Letters

ARABIC TEXT

فَالأَوَّلُ الْإِظْهَارُ قَبْلَ أَحْرَفِ
لِلْحَلْقِ سِتُّ رُتَبَاتٍ فَلْتَعْرِفِ

TRANSLITERATION

Fa-l-awwalu l-izhāru qabla aḥrufi

li-l-ḥalqi sittun ruttibat fa-l-taʿrifi

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فَالأَوَّلُ	<i>fa-l-awwalu</i>	So the first
الْإِظْهَارُ	<i>al-izhāru</i>	(is) al-Izhār
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	before
أَحْرَفِ	<i>aḥrufi</i>	(the) letters
لِلْحَلْقِ	<i>li-l-ḥalqi</i>	of the throat
سِتُّ	<i>sittun</i>	six
رُتَبَاتٍ	<i>ruttibat</i>	(which) are arranged
فَلْتَعْرِفِ	<i>fa-l-taʿrifi</i>	so know (them)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The first [rule] is al-Izhār, [occurring] before the letters of the throat – [they are] six, arranged [by their point of articulation]. So, know them!"

LINGUISTIC ANALYSIS

- Fa-l-awwalu l-izhāru: The definite article al- on *awwal* indicates that this is the first of the four previously mentioned rulings (*aḥkām*). Al-izhār is the predicate of the nominal sentence.
- Qabla aḥrufi: Qabla is an adverb of place (*ẓarf makān*) in the accusative case (*manṣūb*), governing the genitive noun *aḥrufi*. The phrase means "before the letters of the throat."
- Li-l-ḥalqī: The *lām* is for specification, "belonging to" or "pertaining to" the throat.
- Sittun: The number "six" is the predicate of an implied nominal sentence: *hiya sittun* ("they are six").
- Ruttibat: This is a passive verb in the perfect tense (*māḍī*), meaning "they have been arranged" or "ordered." This refers to the traditional ordering of these six letters based on their precise articulation points (*makhārij*) moving from the deepest part of the throat outward.
- Fa-l-ta'rifī: The *fā'* links the information to an imperative. *Lām* of command (*lām al-amr*) + the jussive verb *ta'rif*, with a final *kasrah* to avoid the meeting of two *sukūns* (*ta'rif + i*). It means "so know them!" or "so recognize them!"

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Izhār al-Ḥalqī

- Linguistic Meaning: *Izhār* (إظهار) is the verbal noun of *aẓhara* (أظهر), meaning "to make apparent," "to clarify," or "to manifest." It is the act of making something clearly visible or audible.
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: It is the pronunciation of the *nūn sākina*h or *tanwīn* clearly and distinctly from its own articulation point (*makhraj*), without any prolongation of the accompanying nasalization (*ghunnah*) and without any pause (*sakt*) or separation between it and the following throat letter.
- Acoustic Effect: The *nūn* is heard as a crisp, clear [n] sound, and then the reciter moves immediately to the throat letter. There is no merging, no nasal hum, and no transition sound.

The Six Throat Letters (Ḥurūf al-Ḥalq)

The throat (*al-ḥalq*) is the passage extending from the larynx to the back of the oral cavity. Classical Arabic phoneticians divide it into three precise regions, each producing two letters:

Region of Throat Letters Transliteration Description

Aqṣā al-Ḥalq (The deepest part, closest to the chest/larynx) ء (hamzah) ' / ? Glottal stop

ه (hā') h Voiceless glottal fricative

Wasat al-Ḥalq (The middle of the throat) ع (ʿayn) ʿ / ʔ Voiced pharyngeal fricative

ح (ḥā') ḥ / h Voiceless pharyngeal fricative

Adnā al-Ḥalq (The uppermost part, closest to the mouth/uvula) غ (ghayn) gh / ɣ Voiced uvular fricative

خ (khā') kh / x Voiceless uvular fricative

The Rationale ('Illah) for Izhār at the Throat Letters

The nūn sākinah is articulated from the tip of the tongue (ṭaraf al-lisān) and the gum ridge just above the upper teeth. The six throat letters are articulated deep in the throat. The distance between these two points of articulation is maximal. Assimilation (idghām) typically requires proximity or homogeneity of articulation. Attempting to assimilate the nūn into a distant throat letter would be phonetically awkward and would obscure both sounds. Therefore, the rule of izhār (clear separation) is the natural, phonologically optimal outcome. As Ibn al-Jazarī states in his Muqaddimah:

فَأُظْهِرَنَّ عِنْدَ حُرُوفِ الْحَلْقِ
لِبُعْدِ مَخْرَجِ النُّونِ عَنْ تِلْكَ الْحُرُوفِ

"So make [the nūn] clear when before the letters of the throat,

due to the distance of the nūn's articulation point from those letters."

Comparative Analysis: Al-Jamzūrī and Ibn al-Jazarī

Both poets agree on the six letters and the rule of izhār. Al-Jamzūrī's presentation is concise, simply listing the letters and noting their arrangement (ruttibat). Ibn al-Jazarī provides a more explicit statement of the phonetic rationale (li-bu'di makhraj). Al-Jamzūrī's choice to mention the arrangement hints at the pedagogical importance of understanding the makhārij, which he assumes the student has already studied or is studying concurrently.

Pedagogical Adaptation for Non-Arabic Speakers

— Common Errors for English Speakers:

1. Hamzah (ء): Replacing the glottal stop with a glide (ʃ/ or w/) or omitting it entirely. Drill: Practice the catch in the throat as in "uh-oh." In min ahl (من أهل), ensure the nūn is crisp and the hamzah is a distinct, sharp catch.
2. 'Ayn (ع): Pronouncing it as a glottal stop (ء) or a simple vowel. Drill: Constrict the pharynx muscles as if you are about to gag gently. Add voice. Practice the word 'alā (على) until the deep, raspy sound is consistent.
3. Ḥā' (ح): Confusing it with hā' (ه). Drill: Ḥā' (ه) is a breathy sound from the chest [h], like a sigh. Ḥā' (ح) is a sharp, raspy [ħ] from the pharynx. Imagine fogging a pair of glasses, but doing it deep in your throat.
4. Ghayn (غ): Pronouncing it like the French /ʁ/ or a simple /g/. Drill: It is the voiced counterpart of khā' (خ). Produce a gargling sound without water, then add vocal cord vibration. It is a "heavy" sound, accompanied by elevation of the back of the tongue (isti'lā').

Levels of Iẓhār

The degree of clarity in iẓhār is traditionally divided into three levels, corresponding to the distance of the throat letter from the nūn's articulation point:

- A'lā al-Marātib (Highest Level): At hamzah (ء) and hā' (ه). These are the furthest from the nūn. The nūn should be pronounced with the utmost clarity and a subtle separation from the following letter to prevent any hint of assimilation.
- Awsaṭ al-Marātib (Middle Level): At 'ayn (ع) and ḥā' (ح).
- Adnā al-Marātib (Lowest Level): At ghayn (غ) and khā' (خ). These are the closest to the nūn, being articulated near the uvula and soft palate, just behind the oral cavity. The iẓhār here is still clear but requires slightly less emphasis on separation.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IẒHĀR BEFORE HAMZAH (ء) – NŪN SĀKINAH

Āyah: ﴿وَمِنْ أَهْلِ الْكِتَابِ مَنْ إِنْ تَأْمَنْهُ بِقِنْطَارٍ يُدِّهِ إِلَيْكَ﴾ [آل عمران: 75]

Transliteration: Wa-min ahli l-kitābi man in ta'manhu bi-qinṭārīn yu'ddihī ilayk

Translation: "And among the People of the Scripture is he who, if you entrust him with a great amount [of wealth], he will return it to you."

Application: The word is مِنْ أَهْلٍ (min ahli). The nūn of min has a sukūn. The following letter is ء (hamzah) in ahli. The nūn is pronounced clearly and sharply from the tongue tip [min], followed immediately by the glottal stop of the hamzah [ʔa]. There is no nasal twang.

EXAMPLE 2: IẒHĀR BEFORE 'AYN (ع) – TANWĪN

Āyah: ﴿وَاللَّهُ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ﴾ [البقرة: 224]

Transliteration: Wa-llāhu samī'un 'alīm

Translation: "And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing."

Application: The word is سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ (samī'un 'alīm). The tanwīn (ٍ) on samī' represents a final -un sound, i.e., a nūn sākīnah. The following letter is ع ('ayn) in 'alīm. The tanwīn is pronounced as a clear [n] sound: samī'un. The reciter then moves to the deep pharyngeal [ʕ] of the 'ayn.

EXAMPLE 3: IẒHĀR BEFORE KHĀ' (خ) – NŪN SĀKINAH

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا تَفَرَّقَ الَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْكِتَابَ إِلَّا مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا جَاءَتْهُمْ الْبَيِّنَةُ﴾ وَمَا أُمِرُوا إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ
مُخْلِصِينَ لَهُ الدِّينَ جُنَافًا وَبِقِيَمَةِ الصَّلَاةِ وَيُؤْتُوا الزَّكَاةَ وَذَلِكَ دِينُ الْقِيَمَةِ﴾ [البينة: 4-5]

Alternative Example for precision: ﴿وَمَنْ خَفَ مَوَازِينَهُ﴾ [المؤمنون: 102]

Transliteration: Wa-man khaffat mawāzīnuh

Translation: "But as for those whose scales are light [in good deeds]..."

Application: The word is مَنْ خَفَّتْ (man khaffat). The nūn of man is sākinah. The following letter is خ (khā'). The nūn is pronounced clearly [n], followed by the voiceless uvular fricative [x] of the khā'.

VERSE 8

The Throat Letters Enumerated

ARABIC TEXT

هَمْزُ فَهَاءٍ ثُمَّ عَيْنٌ حَاءُ
مُهْمَلَاتَانِ ثُمَّ غَيْنٌ خَاءُ

TRANSLITERATION

Hamzun fa-hā'un thumma 'aynun ḥā'u

muhmalatāni thumma ghaynun khā'u

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
هَمْزٌ	<i>hamzun</i>	(a) hamzah
فَهَاءٍ	<i>fa-hā'un</i>	then (a) hā'
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	then
عَيْنٌ	<i>'aynun</i>	(an) 'ayn
حَاءُ	<i>ḥā'u</i>	(and a) ḥā'
مُهْمَلَاتَانِ	<i>muhmalatāni</i>	(both) unpointed
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	then
غَيْنٌ	<i>ghaynun</i>	(a) ghayn
خَاءُ	<i>khā'u</i>	(and a) khā'

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"[They are:] hamzah, then hā', then 'ayn, then ḥā' – both [latter two are] unpointed – then ghayn, and khā'."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Explicit Enumeration: This verse provides the definitive list. The poet moves from the abstract concept (aḥruf al-ḥalq) to the concrete letters, aiding memorization.
2. The Term Muhmalatān: Muhmal (مُهْمَلٌ) literally means "neglected" or "left untended." In the science of Arabic orthography ('ilm al-rasm), it refers to letters that are unpointed (i.e., they have no dots above or below them). The letters ع ('ayn) and ح (ḥā') are unpointed. This is contrasted with their pointed counterparts غ (ghayn) and خ (khā'), which each have a single dot above them. Al-Jamzūrī includes this detail because the shapes of these letters are identical in their basic skeletal form (rasm): ع and غ share the same shape, as do ح and خ. The distinction is only in the i'jām (dotting). This was a crucial mnemonic for students learning from manuscripts where vowel marks and dots might be sparse or ambiguous.
3. Rhetorical Pairing: The verse presents the letters in three pairs based on their makhraj:
 - Pair 1 (Aqṣā al-Ḥalq): Hamzah and Hā'.
 - Pair 2 (Wasaṭ al-Ḥalq): 'Ayn and Ḥā' (both muhmalatān).
 - Pair 3 (Adnā al-Ḥalq): Ghayn and Khā'.

This pairing reinforces the student's understanding of the articulatory phonetics.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Hamzun: The zāy (ز) is [z]. The tanwīn is pronounced -un.
- Fa-hā'un: The hā' (ه) is [h]. The hamzah (ء) on the kursī (seat) of a yā' is written as ع. Pronounced hā' + un.
- Thumma: The thā' (ث) is [θ] as in "think." The mīm is geminated (mushaddadah), so the ghunnah is pronounced for two counts.
- 'Aynun ḥā'u: The 'ayn (ع) is [ʕ]. The ḥā' (ح) is [ħ]. The nūn of the tanwīn on 'aynun is pronounced clearly before the ḥā', but this is a case of iẓhār before a throat letter, as per the rule being taught! Thus, 'aynun ḥā'u is itself an example of the rule.
- Muhmalatāni: The dual form (alif and nūn) indicates "two" letters. The hā' (ه) in muhmal is [h].
- Ghaynun khā'u: The ghayn (غ) is [ɣ]. The khā' (خ) is [x].

VERSE 9

Al-Idghām – The Assimilation

ARABIC TEXT

وَالثَّانِ إِدْغَامُ بِسْتَةٍ أَتَتْ
فِي يَرْمُلُونِ عَنْدهُمْ قَدْ ثَبَّتَتْ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-th-thānī idghāmūn bi-sittatin atat

Fī yarmulūna ‘indahum qad thabatat

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالثَّانِ	<i>wa-th-thānī</i>	And the second
إِدْغَامُ	<i>idghāmūn</i>	(is) Idghām
بِسْتَةٍ	<i>bi-sittatin</i>	with six (letters)
أَتَتْ	<i>atat</i>	which have come
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
يَرْمُلُونِ	<i>yarmulūna</i>	"YARMULŪNA"
عَنْدهُمْ	<i>‘indahum</i>	according to them (the scholars)
قَدْ	<i>qad</i>	indeed
ثَبَّتَتْ	<i>thabatat</i>	(they) are established

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The second [rule] is Idghām, with six [letters] which have come together in [the mnemonic] يَرْمُلُونِ (YARMULŪNA); according to them [the scholars], they are firmly established."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-th-thānī Idghāmūn: A nominal sentence introducing the second rule. The definite article al- on thānī refers back to the four aḥkām. Idghām is the predicate.

2. Bi-sittatin Atat: "With six [letters] which have come." The use of the verb *atat* (feminine singular, agreeing with the implied feminine plural *ḥurūf* or *aḥruf*) adds a sense of definiteness and authority, as if these letters have arrived from a recognized source.
3. The Mnemonic YARMULŪNA: This is the first of several brilliant mnemonic devices in the poem. The six letters that cause *idghām* are: ي (yā'), ر (rā'), م (mīm), ل (lām), و (wāw), and ن (nūn). By combining them into the quasi-word YARMULŪNA, al-Jamzūrī creates an easily memorized and recited string. The word itself has a phonetic resonance with the concept of "flowing" or "casting" (from the root *r-m-l*), perhaps alluding to the merging of sounds.
4. 'Indahum Qad Thabatāt: The phrase 'indahum ("according to them" or "in their view") refers to the authoritative scholars of *qirā'ah* and *tajwīd*. Qad thabatāt ("indeed established") emphasizes that this set of six letters is a matter of scholarly consensus (*ijmā'*) and continuous practice (*tawātur*), not a matter of speculation.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Idghām

- Linguistic Meaning: *Idghām* (إدغام) is the verbal noun of *adghama*, meaning "to insert," "to incorporate," or "to merge" one thing into another.
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: It is the meeting of a quiescent letter (*sākin*) with a vowel letter (*mutaḥarrik*), such that they become a single, geminated (doubled) letter of the second type. The first letter (the *nūn sākinah* or *tanwīn*) loses its independent identity and is fully assimilated into the following letter.

The Six Letters of Idghām (Ḥurūf al-Idghām)

Letter Name Transliteration Mnemonic Position

ي yā' y
 ر rā' r
 م mīm m
 ل lām l
 و wāw w
 ن nūn n

These six letters are called *ḥurūf al-idghām*. Whenever a *nūn sākinah* or *tanwīn* is immediately followed by any of these six letters, the *nūn* is not pronounced clearly; instead, it is completely merged into the following letter, which then receives a *shaddah* () indicating gemination.

Types of Idghām

Al-Jamzūrī will elaborate on this in the next two verses, but it is essential to introduce the division here:

- *Idghām bi-Ghunnaḥ* (Assimilation with Nasalization): Occurs with four letters: ي (yā'), و (wāw), م (mīm), ن (nūn). The *nūn* merges, but its nasal quality (*ghunnaḥ*) persists for two counts.

- Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah (Assimilation without Nasalization): Occurs with two letters: ل (lām) and ر (rā'). The nūn merges completely, and the ghunnah disappears entirely.

The Phonetic Rationale for Idghām

The six letters of idghām share a common phonetic feature: their articulation points are either identical to or very close to the articulation point of the nūn (tip of the tongue). Let us examine each:

- Nūn (ن): Articulated from the exact same point as the nūn sākinah (tip of the tongue and gum ridge). This is a case of mithlayn (two identical letters), making assimilation natural and necessary.
- Rā' (ر) and Lām (ل): Articulated from the tip of the tongue, slightly further back or forward than nūn, but still very close. This is idghām mutaḳāribayn (assimilation of proximate letters).
- Yā' (ي) and Wāw (و): While their primary articulation is from the middle of the tongue (yā') or the lips (wāw), their acoustic quality as medial vowels (glides) makes them sonorous and receptive to nasalization. The nūn merges into them smoothly.
- Mīm (م): Articulated from the lips. While not proximate to the nūn, it shares the key attribute of ghunnah (nasalization). This is a case of idghām mutajānisayn (assimilation of similar letters) where the nūn is first converted to a mīm (iqḷāb) and then assimilated.

The rule of idghām facilitates the flow of recitation (tajwīd means "to beautify" and "to make easy"). Pronouncing a clear, separate nūn before these letters would create a staccato, choppy effect that disrupts the smooth, connected nature of Qur'ānic recitation (al-waṣl).

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Conceptual Hurdle: English phonology generally avoids gemination across word boundaries. The phrase "in November" has two /n/ sounds, but they are not typically pronounced as one long, geminated [n:]. The student must consciously learn to hold the sound for the required duration.
- Drill for Idghām bi-Ghunnah: Take the phrase min yawmihim (مِنْ يَوْمِهِمْ). Instead of saying "min yawm," practice saying "miyyawm." Hold the y sound for a full two counts, letting the air resonate through the nose (ghunnah). The y should be noticeably stronger and longer than a single yā'.
- Drill for Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah: Take min rabbihim (مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ). This is easier for English speakers. Say "mirrabbihim." Ensure the nasal passage is closed; no air should escape through the nose.

Comparative Analysis with Ibn al-Jazarī

Ibn al-Jazarī's Muḳaddimah states:

وَأَدْعِمَنَّ بَغْنَةً فِي يَنْمُو... لَكِنَّا قَسَمَانِ قِسْمٌ يُدْعِمَا
فِيهِ بَغْنَةٌ يَنْمُو عَلِمَا

"And assimilate with ghunnah in [the letters of] YANMŪ (ي، ن، م، و). But they are two divisions: a division that is assimilated with ghunnah, known by YANMŪ."

Al-Jamzūrī's presentation is slightly different. He first introduces the complete set of six (YARMULŪNA) and then divides them. This is a pedagogical choice: from the general to the specific. Both methods are effective. Al-Jamzūrī's inclusion of the mnemonic YARMULŪNA is a hallmark of his concise, student-friendly style.

VERSE 10

Idghām bi-Ghunnah – Assimilation with Nasalization

ARABIC TEXT

لَكِنَّهَا قِسْمَانِ قِسْمٌ يُدْغَمَا
فِيهِ بَغْنَةٌ يَنْمُو عَلِمَا

TRANSLITERATION

Lakinnahā qismāni qismun yudghamā

fīhi bi-ghunnatin bi-yanmū ‘ulimā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
لَكِنَّهَا	<i>lakinnahā</i>	But they (the six letters)
قِسْمَانِ	<i>qismāni</i>	(are) two divisions
قِسْمٌ	<i>qismun</i>	(One) division
يُدْغَمَا	<i>yudghamā</i>	is assimilated
فِيهِ	<i>fīhi</i>	in which
بَغْنَةٌ	<i>bi-ghunnatin</i>	with a ghunnah
يَنْمُو	<i>bi-yanmū</i>	by (the letters of) YANMŪ
عَلِمَا	<i>‘ulimā</i>	(they) are known

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"However, they [the six letters] are [further divided into] two divisions. One division is assimilated with a ghunnah (nasalization) – it is known by [the mnemonic] يَمُو (YANMŪ)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Lakinnahā: Lakinna is a particle of emendation and emphasis. It signals a correction or a specification of the previous general statement. The previous verse stated there are six letters for idghām; this verse clarifies that they are not all treated identically.
2. Qismāni: Dual of qism (part, division). The predicate of the nominal sentence (hiya qismāni).
3. Qismun Yudghamā: The first of the two divisions. Yudghamā is a passive verb in the subjunctive or indicative mood, with an alif al-iṭlāq at the end for the sake of the meter/rhyme. The phrase means "a division [in] which [the nūn] is assimilated with a ghunnah."
4. The Mnemonic YANMŪ: This is the second key mnemonic. It combines the four letters that cause idghām bi-ghunnah: ي (yā'), ن (nūn), م (mīm), and و (wāw). The word yanmū (يَمُو) means "it grows" or "it increases." This is a beautiful semantic fit, as the ghunnah (nasalization) is a prolonged, resonant sound that seems to "grow" from the merged nūn. The sound persists and increases in the nasal cavity before the release of the following letter.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Idghām bi-Ghunnah (Incomplete/Partial Assimilation)

This is also called Idghām Nāqis (ناقص) – Deficient or Incomplete Assimilation. It is "incomplete" because while the nūn itself disappears (its oral articulation is lost), its primary attribute – the ghunnah (nasal resonance) – remains and is pronounced clearly for a duration of two vowel counts (ḥarakāt).

The Letters of YANMŪ and Their Phonetic Character**Letter Name Rationale for Ghunnah**

ي (y) yā' As a palatal glide, it is a "soft" sound that easily accommodates the nasal airflow. The ghunnah colors the y sound.

ن (n) nūn The assimilating letter is identical to the assimilated letter (idghām mithlayn). Since nūn inherently possesses ghunnah, the geminated nūn naturally retains a doubled nasal quality.

م (m) mīm Though articulated at the lips, mīm is the other primary nasal consonant in Arabic. The nūn is first converted to a mīm (due to the ghunnah and labial proximity) and then assimilated. The ghunnah is the shared attribute that bridges the two sounds.

و (w) wāw As a labial-velar glide, it is a "soft," sonorous sound. The ghunnah flows easily into the wāw, creating a smooth transition.

The Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter intends to pronounce the nūn sākinah.

2. Instead of forming the tongue tip on the alveolar ridge, the reciter stops the oral articulation of the nūn. The tongue may remain in a neutral position or anticipate the following letter.
3. The velum (soft palate) is lowered, allowing the air stream to flow entirely through the nasal cavity. This produces the ghunnah, a pure nasal hum [ḥ], for exactly the duration of two short vowels (ḥarakatayn).
4. At the end of the two counts, the articulators move to the position of the following letter (yā', nūn, mīm, or wāw), and that letter is pronounced as a geminate (doubled) consonant. The shaddah () on the following letter indicates this gemination.

Comparative Analysis

Ibn al-Jazarī and al-Jamzūrī are in complete agreement on this rule and its four letters. The mnemonic YANMŪ is standard in the field. The duration of the ghunnah is universally agreed to be two ḥarakāt (one alif). Some modern phoneticians describe this as a "nasalized approximant" or a "nasal glide."

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The Nasal Hum: English has nasal consonants (/m/, /n/, /ŋ/), but it does not have a standalone, prolonged nasal hum that is not attached to a specific consonant. The closest approximation is the humming sound "hmmm."
- Drill: Take the word *min yawm* (مِنْ يَوْمٍ). Hum a continuous "nnnnnn" for two seconds. Then, without stopping the airflow through the nose, slide into a "y" sound. The result is "minnnn-yyawm." The "y" will feel stronger and longer because it is geminated.
- Error to Avoid: Do not pronounce a clear "n" and then a separate "y." That would be *izhār*, not *idghām*. Do not pronounce "mi-yawm" without the nasal hum. The hum is the essential residue of the nūn.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IDGHĀM BI-GHUNNAH BEFORE YĀ' (ي)

Āyah: ﴿فَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْرًا يَرَهُ﴾ [الزلزلة: 7]

Transliteration: Fa-man y'amal mithqāla dharratin khayran yarah

Translation: "So whoever does an atom's weight of good will see it."

Application: The phrase is *مَنْ يَعْمَلْ* (man y'amal). The nūn of man is sākinah. The following letter is ي (yā') in y'amal. The nūn is not pronounced. Instead, a ghunnah (nasal hum) is sustained for two counts, and then the reciter pronounces a geminated yā': mayy-'amal. In the muṣṣḥaf, the nūn of man will be unmarked (no sukūn), and the yā' of y'amal will have a shaddah (), e.g., *مَنْ يَعْمَلْ*.

EXAMPLE 2: IDGHĀM BI-GHUNNAH BEFORE WĀW (و)

Āyah: ﴿[الجنائنة: ١٥] مِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ جَهَنَّمُ﴾

Transliteration: Min w'arā'ihim jahannam

Translation: "Behind them is Hell..."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ (min w'arā'ihim). The nūn of min is sākinah. The following letter is و (wāw). The nūn is assimilated with ghunnah. The reciter hums for two counts and then pronounces a geminated wāw: miww-arā'ihim. The muṣḥaf shows the nūn unmarked and a shaddah on the wāw: مِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ (often written with the shaddah).

EXAMPLE 3: IDGHĀM BI-GHUNNAH BEFORE MĪM (م)

Āyah: ﴿[السجدة: ٨] مِنْ مَاءٍ مَهِينٍ﴾

Transliteration: Min m'ā'in mahīn

Translation: "From a despised fluid."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ مَاءٍ مَهِينٍ (min mā'in). The nūn is sākinah. The following letter is م (mīm). The nūn is assimilated with ghunnah. The reciter hums for two counts and then pronounces a geminated mīm: mimm-ā'in. The muṣḥaf has the nūn unmarked and a shaddah on the mīm: مِنْ مَاءٍ مَهِينٍ.

EXAMPLE 4: IDGHĀM BI-GHUNNAH BEFORE NŪN (ن)

Āyah: ﴿[النحل: ٥٣] مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ فَمِنَ اللَّهِ﴾

Transliteration: Min n'i'matin fa-mina llāh

Translation: "Whatever blessing you have, it is from Allah."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ فَمِنَ اللَّهِ (min ni'matin). The nūn is sākinah. The following letter is ن (nūn). This is idghām mīthlayn (assimilation of identical letters). The reciter hums for two counts and then pronounces a geminated nūn: minn-i'matin. The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the second nūn: مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ فَمِنَ اللَّهِ.

VERSE 11

The Exception – Al-Iẓhār al-Muṭlaq (Absolute Clarification)

ARABIC TEXT

إِلَّا إِذَا كَانَا بِكَلِمَةٍ فَلَا

تُدْغِمُ كَدُنْيَا ثُمَّ صِنَوَانُ تَلَا

TRANSLITERATION

Illā idhā kānā bi-kilmatin fa-lā

tudghim ka-dunyā thumma ṣinwānun talā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
إِلَّا	<i>illā</i>	Except
إِذَا	<i>idhā</i>	when
كَانَا	<i>kānā</i>	they both occur
بِكَلِمَةٍ	<i>bi-kilmatin</i>	in one word
فَلَا	<i>fa-lā</i>	then do not
تُدْغِمُ	<i>tudghim</i>	assimilate
كَدُنْيَا	<i>ka-dunyā</i>	like dunyā
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	then
صِنَوَانُ	<i>ṣinwānun</i>	ṣinwān
تَلَا	<i>talā</i>	follows

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Except when they both [the nūn sākinah and the idghām letter] occur within a single word – then do not assimilate! As in [the word] دُنْيَا (dunyā), and then صِنَوَانُ (ṣinwānun) follows [as another example]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Illā: This is the particle of exception (istithnā). It signals a crucial departure from the general rule of idghām.
2. Idhā Kānā bi-Kilmatin: The verb kānā is in the dual form, referring to the nūn sākinah and the idghām letter. The condition is that both elements must be within the boundaries of a single word (bi-kilmatin).

3. Fa-lā Tudghim: The fā' is the response to the condition. Lā is the prohibitive particle (lā al-nāhiyah), and tudghim is a jussive verb. It is a direct command: "Do not assimilate!"

4. Ka-Dunyā: The kāf is for exemplification. Dunyā (دُنْيَا) is the feminine singular of ʿadnā (nearer, lower), meaning "the world" or "the present life." It contains a nūn sākinah (ن) followed by a yā' (ي), which is an idghām letter, but they are in the same word. The rule here is iẓhār.

5. Thumma Ṣinwānun Talā: Ṣinwān (صِنْوَان) is a word meaning "twin palm trees" or "branches growing from a single root." It contains a nūn sākinah followed by a wāw (و), another idghām letter, within the same word. Talā means "it followed" or "it came next," indicating this is the second example.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of *Al-Iẓhār al-Muṭlaq* (Absolute Clarification)

This is the mandatory clarification (iẓhār) of a nūn sākinah when it is followed by one of the six idghām letters within the same word. It is called muṭlaq (absolute) because it applies without exception in these specific circumstances, overriding the normal rule of idghām. It is also called iẓhār kalimī (word-based clarification).

The Rationale for the Exception

- Preservation of Word Identity (Ṣawn al-Kalimah): If the nūn were assimilated in these words, their recognizable form and meaning would be lost or obscured. For instance, dunyā (دُنْيَا) would become duyā (دِيَا), which is not a word in Arabic. Ṣinwān (صِنْوَان) would become ṣiwwān (صِيْوَان), which could be confused with a different root.
- Phonetic Weight: Assimilation within a single word (idghām kabīr) is generally avoided in the reading of Ḥaṣṣ (and most canonical readings) except for specific, established cases. The general principle is to keep the word's structure clear.
- Linguistic Analogy: Arabic morphology prefers clarity in word stems. Assimilating a radical nūn would disrupt the pattern (wazn) of the word.

The Four Words in the *Qur'ān*

This exception occurs in exactly four words in the entire *Qur'ān* according to the reading of Ḥaṣṣ 'an 'Āṣim:

Word Transliteration Meaning Surah & Verse Rule Applied

دُنْيَا dunyā World, present life Frequent, e.g., Q 2:86 Nūn sākinah + ي (yā') → Iẓhār

بُنْيَان bunyān Structure, building Q 61:4 Nūn sākinah + ي (yā') → Iẓhār

صِنْوَان ṣinwān Twin palm trees Q 13:4 Nūn sākinah + و (wāw) → Iẓhār

قِنْوَان qinwān Clusters of dates Q 6:99 Nūn sākinah + و (wāw) → Iẓhār

Al-Jamzūrī mentions two of them: dunyā and ṣinwān. The other two are taught by extension.

Comparative Analysis

This exception is a standard part of Tajweed curricula. Ibn al-Jazarī states:

إِلَّا إِذَا كَانَا بِكَلِمَةٍ فَلَا... تُدْغَمُ كَدُنْيَا ثُمَّ صِنَوَانٌ تَلَا
وَبُنْيَانٌ قِنَوَانٌ أَيْضًا فَاعْلَمَنَّ... إِظْهَارُهَا فِي الْوَصْلِ وَالْوَقْفِ مَعَنَّ

"Except when they are in one word, then do not assimilate, like *dunyā*, then *ṣinwān* follows. And *bunyān* and *qinwān* also, so know that their clarification is in both continuation and pause."

Al-Jamzūrī's treatment is concise but sufficient for the student, leaving the full list to the teacher's oral instruction or to commentaries.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Memorization is Key: Since there are only four words, the student should memorize them. A simple mnemonic in English could be: "The Dear Boy Saw Queens": *Dunyā*, *Bunyān*, *Ṣinwān*, *Qinwān*.
- Practice: Recite the four words repeatedly, ensuring the *nūn* is pronounced clearly and the following letter (*yā'* or *wāw*) is not geminated.
- Dun-yaa (not duy-yaa)
- Bun-yaan (not buy-yaan)
- Sin-waan (not siw-waan)
- Qin-waan (not qiw-waan)

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: DUNYĀ (دُنْيَا)

Āyah: ﴿[١٨٥: آل عمران: ﴿وَمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا إِلَّا مَتَاعُ الْغُرُورِ﴾﴾

Transliteration: Wa-mā l-ḥayātu d-dunyā illā matā'u l-ghurūr

Translation: "And the life of this world is nothing but the enjoyment of delusion."

Application: The word is *الدُّنْيَا*. It contains a *nūn sākinah* (نْ) followed by a *yā'* (ي). Despite the *yā'* being an *idghām* letter, the *nūn* is pronounced clearly: *dun-yā*. There is no *ghunnah* prolongation, and the *yā'* is not geminated. The *muṣḥaf* shows a *sukūn* on the *nūn*.

EXAMPLE 2: BUNYĀN (بُنْيَانٌ)

Āyah: ﴿[٤: الصف: ﴿إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الَّذِينَ يُقَاتِلُونَ فِي سَبِيلِهِ صَفًّا كَانَهُمْ بُنْيَانٌ مَرْصُورٌ﴾﴾

Transliteration: Inna llāha yuḥibbu lladhīna yuqātilūna fī sabīlihī ṣaffan ka-annahum bunyānun marṣūṣ

Translation: "Indeed, Allah loves those who fight in His cause in a row as though they are a compact structure."

Application: The word is بُنْيَانٌ. The nūn sākinah is followed by a yā'. The nūn is pronounced clearly: bun-yān.

EXAMPLE 3: QINWĀN (قِنْوَانٌ)

Āyah: ﴿وَمِنَ النَّخْلِ مِنْ طَلْعِهَا قِنْوَانٌ دَانِيَةٌ﴾ [الأنعام: 99]

Transliteration: Wa-mina n-nakhli min ṭal'ihā qinwānun dāniyah

Translation: "And from the palm trees – of its emerging fruit are clusters hanging low."

Application: The word is قِنْوَانٌ. The nūn sākinah is followed by a wāw. The nūn is pronounced clearly: qin-wān.

VERSE 12

Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah – Assimilation without Nasalization

ARABIC TEXT

وَالثَّانِ إِدْغَامٌ بِغَيْرِ غُنَّةٍ
فِي اللَّامِ وَالرَّاءِ ثُمَّ كَرَّرْنَاهُ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-th-thānī idghāmun bi-ghayri ghunnah

Fi l-lāmi wa-r-rā thumma karrirannah

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالثَّانِ	<i>wa-th-thānī</i>	And the second
إِدْغَامٌ	<i>idghāmun</i>	(is) Idghām
بِغَيْرِ	<i>bi-ghayri</i>	without
غُنَّةٍ	<i>ghunnah</i>	nasalization

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
الَّامِ	<i>al-lāmi</i>	the lām
وَالرَّاءِ	<i>wa-r-rā</i>	and the rāʾ
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	then
كَرِّرْنَاهُ	<i>karrirannah</i>	repeat them (or practice them repeatedly)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The second [division of Idghām] is assimilation without a ghunnah (nasalization). [It occurs] in [the letters] ل (lām) and ر (rāʾ). So, repeat them [or practice them diligently]!"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-th-thānī Idghāmun: This introduces the second division of the idghām rule. The definite article al- on thānī refers back to the qismānī (two divisions) mentioned in verse 10.
2. Bi-ghayri Ghunnah: This is the defining characteristic of this division: it is performed without the nasal hum (ghunnah). The nūn is completely annihilated, both in its oral articulation and in its nasal attribute.
3. Fi l-lāmi wa-r-rā: This specifies the two letters: ل (lām) and ر (rāʾ). These are the remaining two letters from the original six of YARMULŪNA after the four of YANMŪ have been accounted for.
4. Thumma Karrirannah: The verb karrir is an imperative from karrara (to repeat). It is reinforced with the energetic nūn of emphasis (nūn al-tawkīd), making it a strong command: karriranna-hu → karrirannah (with the final hāʾ). This command has a dual interpretation:
 - Pedagogical: "Repeat these two letters, practice them often, so that you master their correct pronunciation."
 - Phonetic: It alludes to the inherent quality of takrīr (repetition/trilling) in the letter rāʾ. When the rāʾ is geminated (as it is after idghām), the trill becomes more prominent. The student must be careful not to over-trill the rāʾ and produce multiple rāʾs instead of a single geminated one.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah (Complete Assimilation)

This is also called Idghām Kāmil (كامل) – Complete Assimilation. It is "complete" because the nūn is entirely assimilated into the following letter, leaving no trace of either its oral articulation or its nasal attribute. The resulting sound is simply a geminated lām or rāʾ.

The Letters Lām (ل) and Rā' (ر) and Their Attributes

Letter Name Makhraj (Articulation Point) Key Attributes

ل lām Tip of the tongue (ṭaraf al-lisān) and the gum ridge of the upper front teeth. Jahr (voiced), Tawassuṭ (intermediate), Infitāḥ (open), Isti'ālā' (light, not emphatic).

ر rā' Tip of the tongue (ṭaraf al-lisān), slightly further back on the alveolar ridge than lām and nūn. Jahr (voiced), Tawassuṭ (intermediate), Infitāḥ (open), Takrīr (trilled), Inḥirāf (deviated airflow). It can be light (muraqqaqah) or heavy (mufakhkhamah) depending on surrounding vowels.

The Phonetic Rationale for Complete Assimilation without Ghunnah

- Proximity: Both lām and rā' are articulated from the tip of the tongue, very close to the articulation point of nūn. This makes full assimilation phonetically natural.
- Absence of Nasality: Neither lām nor rā' possesses the attribute of ghunnah. In Arabic phonology, when a nasal sound (nūn) is fully assimilated into a non-nasal sound, the nasality is completely blocked. The velum raises to seal off the nasal cavity, forcing all air through the mouth.
- Acoustic Clarity: The ghunnah is a soft, humming sound. The lām and rā' are clear, resonant, and somewhat "sharp" sounds (especially rā' with its trill). Prolonging a nasal hum before these sounds would create an acoustic clash. The complete elimination of the ghunnah preserves the clarity and crispness of the lām and rā'.

The Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter intends to pronounce the nūn sākinah before a lām or rā'.
2. The reciter completely bypasses the nūn. The tongue does not go to the nūn position.
3. Instead, the tongue moves directly to the position of the lām or rā'.
4. The sound is held as a geminate consonant (indicated by the shaddah) for the duration of one vowel count.
5. Crucially, no air escapes through the nose. The nasal passage is closed.

The Command Karrirannah and the Takrīr of Rā'

The letter rā' inherently has the attribute of takrīr (repetition/trilling). This means the tip of the tongue vibrates slightly against the alveolar ridge. When rā' is geminated (as in mir-rabbiḥim), this trill is naturally prolonged. However, the classical scholars warn against exaggerated trilling that would result in producing multiple separate rā' sounds. Ibn al-Jazarī advises:

وَأَخْفِ تَكْرِيرًا إِذَا مَا شُدَّ

"And conceal the repetition when it [the rā'] is geminated."

This means the trill should be a smooth, single prolonged vibration, not a staccato series of taps. Al-Jamzūrī's instruction to karrirannah can be understood as "practice these letters repeatedly until you perfect them, especially being mindful of the rā's trill."

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- For Lām (ل): The Arabic lām is a "light" /l/, similar to the English /l/ in "leaf" (as opposed to the "dark" /l/ in "full"). When geminated, it simply becomes longer. Practice min ladunhu → milladunhu. Hold the "l" sound.
- For Rā' (ر): The Arabic rā' is a single-trill /r/, like the Scottish "r" or the Spanish "r" in "pero." It is not the English approximant /ɹ/. The challenge is to produce a geminated /r:/ without multiple taps. Practice min rabbihi → mirrabbihi. Keep the tongue tip loose and let it vibrate once, but sustain the sound. Avoid "mir-r-r-rabbihi" (with multiple distinct taps).
- Blocking Nasality: English speakers often inadvertently nasalize vowels before nasal consonants. When practicing idghām bi-lā ghunnah, consciously pinch your nose. If the sound is distorted or stops, you are still using nasal airflow. The sound should be unaffected when you pinch your nose.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS**EXAMPLE 1: IDGHĀM BI-LĀ GHUNNAH BEFORE LĀM (ل)**

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا كَانَ لِنَفْسٍ أَنْ تَمُوتَ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ يَكْفِيًا مَوْجِلًا وَمِنْ يُرِيدُ ثَوَابَ الدُّنْيَا نُؤْتِهِ مِنْهَا وَمَنْ يُرِيدِ﴾
 [145: عمران: ﴿أَلْأَمْثَلُ شَأْنًا﴾] – Alternative: Better example is from Surah al-Kahf.

Better Example: ﴿مِنْ لَدُنْهُ﴾ [الكهف: 65]

Transliteration: ...wa-‘allamnāhu min ladunnā ‘ilman

Translation: "...and We taught him from Us [certain] knowledge."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ لَدُنَّا (min ladunnā). The nūn of min is sākinah. The following letter is ل (lām). The nūn is completely assimilated without ghunnah. The reciter pronounces a clear, geminated lām: mill-adunnā. The muṣḥaf shows the nūn unmarked and a shaddah on the lām: لَدُنَّا.

EXAMPLE 2: IDGHĀM BI-LĀ GHUNNAH BEFORE RĀ' (ر)

Āyah: ﴿أُولَئِكَ عَلَىٰ هُدًى مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 5]

Transliteration: Ulā'ika 'alā hudan min rabbihi wa-ulā'ika humu l-mufliḥūn

Translation: "Those are upon [right] guidance from their Lord, and it is those who are the successful."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ (min rabbihi). The nūn of min is sākinah. The following letter is ر (rā'). The nūn is completely assimilated without ghunnah. The reciter pronounces a geminated rā': mirr-abbihim. The rā' here is light (muraqqaqah) because it is followed by a kasrah. The muṣḥaf shows the nūn unmarked and a shaddah on the rā': رَبِّهِمْ.

EXAMPLE 3: IDGHĀM BI-LĀ GHUNNAH WITH TANWĪN BEFORE RĀ' (ر)

Āyah: ﴿غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ﴾ [البقرة: 173]

Transliteration: ...fa-inna llāha ghafūrun raḥīm

Translation: "...then indeed, Allah is Forgiving and Merciful."

Application: The phrase is غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ (ghafūrun raḥīm). The tanwīn on ghafūr represents a nūn sākinah. The following letter is ر (rā'). The tanwīn is completely assimilated without ghunnah.

The reciter pronounces a geminated rā': ghafūrur-raḥīm. The rā' here is light because it is followed by a faṭḥah but preceded by a kasrah (on the fā' of ghafūr). The muṣḥaf shows the tanwīn (◌) and a shaddah on the rā'.

VERSE 13

Al-Iqlāb – The Conversion

ARABIC TEXT

وَالثَّالِثُ الْإِقْلَابُ عِنْدَ الْبَاءِ
مِيمًا بَغْنَةً مَعَ الْإِخْفَاءِ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-th-thālithu l-iqlābu 'inda l-bā'i

mīman bi-ghunnatin ma'a l-ikhfā'i

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالثَّالِثُ	<i>wa-th-thālithu</i>	And the third
الْإِقْلَابُ	<i>al-iqlābu</i>	(is) al-Iqlāb
عِنْدَ	<i>'inda</i>	at / before
الْبَاءِ	<i>al-bā'i</i>	the bā'
مِيمًا	<i>mīman</i>	(as) a mīm
بَغْنَةً	<i>bi-ghunnatin</i>	with a ghunnah

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
مَعَ	<i>ma'a</i>	along with
الْإِخْفَاءُ	<i>al-ikhfā'i</i>	concealment

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The third [rule] is al-Iqlāb (the Conversion). [It occurs] before [the letter] ب (bā'). [The nūn or tanwīn is converted] into a م (mīm) with a ghunnah (nasalization), accompanied by concealment (ikhfā')."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-th-thālithu l-Iqlābu: The third ruling is introduced. Al-Iqlāb literally means "the turning over" or "the conversion."
2. 'Inda l-Bā'i: This specifies the single letter that triggers this rule: ب (bā'). Unlike the previous rules which had multiple letters, iqlāb has only one.
3. Mīman bi-Ghunnatin: This is the core of the rule. The nūn sākinah or tanwīn is not pronounced as a nūn at all. It is converted (qalb) into a pure م (mīm). Furthermore, this mīm is pronounced with a full ghunnah (nasalization) lasting two counts.
4. Ma'a l-Ikhfā'i: This is a crucial detail. The converted mīm is not pronounced clearly (izhār). Instead, it is concealed (ikhfā'). This means the lips do not fully close to produce a complete [m] sound. Instead, they come together loosely, allowing the nasal ghunnah to be the primary audible element before the release into the bā'. This is the same mechanism as ikhfā' shafawī (the concealment of the mīm sākinah before bā'), which al-Jamzūrī will cover in a later chapter (verse 20).

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Iqlāb

- Linguistic Meaning: Iqlāb (إقلاب) or Qalb (قلب) means "turning over," "inverting," or "converting" something from its original state to another.
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: It is the substitution of the nūn sākinah or tanwīn with a pure, quiescent mīm (م) when followed by the letter ب (bā'). This mīm is then concealed (ikhfā') and pronounced with a sustained ghunnah for two vowel counts.

The Letter Bā' (ب)

- Makhraj: The bā' is articulated from the two lips (al-shafatān). Specifically, the inner portion of the lower lip meets the edges of the upper front teeth.
- Şifāt: Jahr (voiced), Shiddah (plosive/stop), Infitāḥ (open), Isti'fāl (light), Qalqalah (echoing when sākin).

The Phonetic Rationale for Iqlāb

The nūn is a lingual-alveolar sound (tip of the tongue). The bā' is a bilabial sound (two lips). The transition from a tongue-tip consonant to a lip consonant with a clear, separate nūn is phonetically awkward and disrupts the flow of speech. The options considered by the phonetic rules of classical Arabic were:

- Izhār: Pronouncing a clear nūn then bā' is heavy and inelegant (thaqīl).
- Idghām: Assimilating the nūn directly into the bā' is impossible due to the dissimilarity of their articulations.
- Ikhfā': Concealing the nūn near its own articulation point and then moving to the bā' is still awkward.

The elegant solution is Iqlāb: The nūn is converted into a م (mīm). Why a mīm? Because mīm (م) shares two crucial features with both nūn and bā':

- With Nūn: It shares the attribute of ghunnah (nasalization). The ghunnah of the original nūn is thus preserved, but through the body of a mīm.
- With Bā': It shares the bilabial articulation point. The mīm is produced by closing the two lips (dry portion), while the bā' is produced by the inner lip and teeth. The proximity is so close that the transition from mīm to bā' is seamless and effortless.

By converting the nūn to a mīm, the reciter can flow smoothly from the lip position directly into the bā', while still retaining the essential ghunnah that carries the identity of the original nūn.

The Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter encounters a nūn sākinah (or tanwīn) followed by a bā'.
2. Do not pronounce the nūn.
3. Instead, prepare to pronounce a م (mīm). Bring the two lips together, but lightly and incompletely. Do not press them firmly shut as you would for a full mīm.
4. Lower the velum to open the nasal passage. Produce a pure, sustained ghunnah (nasal hum) for the duration of two vowel counts (ḥarakatayn). The lips remain loosely closed during this hum.
5. After the two counts, the lips open or adjust slightly to produce the following ب (bā'). The bā' is pronounced normally.

The Meaning of Ma'a l-Ikhfā'i

The phrase "with concealment" is critical. It distinguishes the mīm produced by iqlāb from a regular mīm sākinah. If the mīm were pronounced clearly (izhār), the reciter would say min ba'di as mim ba'di with a clear [m] sound. This is incorrect. The correct pronunciation is with ikhfā': the mīm is concealed, meaning the lips do not fully close, and the sound is dominated by the nasal hum. This is precisely the same rule as Ikhfā' Shafawī (Concealment of the Labial Letter), which applies to the mīm sākinah before bā'. Al-Jamzūrī will say later (verse 20): Fa-l-awwalu l-ikhfā'u 'inda l-bā'i ("The first [rule of mīm sākinah] is ikhfā' before bā'").

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

In the standard muṣḥaf, a nūn sākinah that undergoes iqlāb will have its sukūn replaced by a small م (mīm) written above it. A tanwīn that undergoes iqlāb will have a small م written above or in place of the second vowel mark. The bā' that follows will not have a shaddah.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The "Hum": This is the same nasal hum practiced for idghām bi-ghunnah, but the lips are brought together. Hum "mmmm" for two seconds.
- Light Lip Closure: Practice the difference between a full "m" (lips firmly pressed) and a concealed "m" (lips just touching, air flowing mostly through the nose). For iqlāb, use the concealed "m."
- Drill: Take the phrase min ba'di (مِنْ بَعْدٍ). Do not say "min ba'di." Hum "mmmm" with lips lightly touching, then release into "ba'di." The result is "mimmm-ba'di" where the "m" is not fully pronounced.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IQLĀB WITH NŪN SĀKINAH

Āyah: ﴿الَّذِينَ يَنْقُضُونَ عَهْدَ اللَّهِ مِنْ بَعْدِ مِيثَاقِهِ وَيَقْطَعُونَ مَا أَمَرَ اللَّهُ بِهِ أَنْ يُوصَلَ وَيُفْسِدُونَ فِي الْأَرْضِ أُولَٰئِكَ هُمُ الْخَاسِرُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 27]

Transliteration: Alladhīna yanquḍūna 'ahda llāhi min ba'di mīthāqih...

Translation: "Those who break the covenant of Allah after its confirmation and sever that which Allah has ordered to be joined and cause corruption on earth – it is those who are the losers."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ بَعْدٍ (min ba'di). The nūn of min is sākinah. The following letter is ب (bā'). The nūn is converted into a concealed mīm with a two-count ghunnah. The reciter hums with lips lightly closed, then pronounces the bā': mimmm-ba'di. The muṣḥaf has a small م over the nūn.

EXAMPLE 2: IQLĀB WITH TANWĪN

Āyah: ﴿وَاللَّهُ سَمِيعٌ بَصِيرٌ﴾ [غافر: 20]

Transliteration: Wa-llāhu samī'un baṣīr

Translation: "And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing."

Application: The phrase is سَمِيعٌ بَصِيرٌ (samī'un baṣīr). The tanwīn (◌) on samī' is a nūn sākinah. The following letter is ب (bā'). The tanwīn is converted into a concealed mīm with ghunnah: samī'ummm-baṣīr. The muṣḥaf has a small م over the tanwīn or replacing one of the ḍammahs.

EXAMPLE 3: IQLĀB WITH NŪN SĀKINAH WITHIN A WORD

Āyah: ﴿قَالَ يَا آدَمُ أَنْبِئْهُمْ بِأَسْمَائِهِمْ﴾ [البقرة: 33]

Transliteration: Qāla yā Ādamu anbi'hum bi-asmā'ihim

Translation: "He said, 'O Adam, inform them of their names.'"

Application: The word is أَنْبِئْهُمْ (anbi'hum). It contains a nūn sākinah (the first letter after the hamzah) followed by a ب (bā') within the same word. The nūn undergoes iqlāb. The reciter hums a concealed mīm and then pronounces the bā': ammm-bi'hum. Note that the hamzah after the bā' is a separate sound. The muṣḥaf has a small م over the nūn.

VERSE 14

Al-Ikhfā' al-Ḥaqīqī – True Concealment

ARABIC TEXT

وَالرَّابِعُ الْإِخْفَاءُ عِنْدَ الْفَاضِلِ
مِنَ الْحُرُوفِ وَاجِبٌ لِلْفَاضِلِ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-r-rābi'u l-ikhfā'u 'inda l-fāḍili

mina l-ḥurūfi wājibun li-l-fāḍili

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالرَّابِعُ	<i>wa-r-rābi'u</i>	And the fourth
الْإِخْفَاءُ	<i>al-ikhfā'u</i>	(is) al-Ikhfā'
عِنْدَ	<i>'inda</i>	according to

الْفَاضِلِ al-fāḍili the eminent (scholar) / or: the one of excellence

مِنَ mina of

الْحُرُوفِ al-ḥurūfi the letters

وَاجِبٌ wājibun (is) obligatory

لِلْفَاضِلِ li-l-fāḍili for the excellent (reciter)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The fourth [rule] is al-Ikhfā' (the Concealment). According to the eminent scholar, it is [applied to the rest] of the letters, and it is obligatory for the excellent reciter [to observe it]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-r-rābi'u l-Ikhfā'u: The fourth and final rule for nūn sākinah and tanwīn is introduced.

2. 'Inda l-Fāḍili: The word fāḍil means "excellent," "eminent," or "virtuous." There are two primary interpretations among commentators:

- Interpretation A: It refers to God (Allāh), the Truly Excellent One. Thus, "According to God's decree in His Book..."
- Interpretation B: It refers to an eminent scholar of Tajweed, such as the author's own teacher or a recognized authority like Ibn al-Jazarī. Thus, "According to the eminent authority [in this science]..."

Both interpretations are plausible and do not affect the legal ruling.

3. Mina l-Ḥurūfi: This is an elliptical phrase meaning "[the rest] of the letters." It refers to the letters that remain after the six iẓhār letters, the six idghām letters, and the one iqlāb letter have been accounted for.

4. Wājibun li-l-Fāḍili: The rule of ikhfā' is wājib (obligatory). The second occurrence of al-fāḍil refers to the reciter. It is obligatory for the excellent, accomplished reciter to apply this rule correctly. This implies that neglecting ikhfā' is a serious error (laḥn khafī) that mars the excellence of the recitation.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Ikhfā' al-Ḥaqīqī (True Concealment)

- Linguistic Meaning: Ikhfā' (إخفاء) is the verbal noun of akhfā' (أخفى), meaning "to hide," "to conceal," or "to make obscure."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: It is the pronunciation of the nūn sākinah or tanwīn in a state between clear articulation (iẓhār) and complete assimilation (idghām). The nūn is not pronounced clearly, nor is it entirely merged. Instead, it is "concealed." The key feature is the retention of a full, two-count ghunnah (nasalization), while the oral articulation of the nūn is suppressed or greatly reduced.

The Letters of Ikhfā' (Ḥurūf al-Ikhfā')

These are the fifteen remaining letters of the Arabic alphabet after excluding the six ḥalqī letters, the six idghām letters, and the one iqlāb letter. They are:

ت، ث، ج، د، ذ، ز، س، ش، ص، ض، ط، ظ، ف، ق، ك

These letters represent a wide range of articulation points, from the tip of the tongue to the uvula and the lips. The common factor is that none of them are throat letters, none are the six idghām letters, and none are the bā'.

The Phonetic Rationale for Ikhfā'

The nūn is articulated from the tip of the tongue. The ikhfā' letters are neither extremely close to the nūn (like the idghām letters) nor extremely far (like the throat letters). They occupy an intermediate phonetic distance. Therefore, the rule applied to them is also intermediate: neither full separation (iḏhār) nor full merging (idghām). The nūn is "concealed" – its oral identity is obscured, but its nasal resonance (ghunnah) is preserved as a bridge to the following sound.

The Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter encounters a nūn sākinah (or tanwīn) followed by an ikhfā' letter.
2. Do not pronounce a clear nūn.
3. Do not fully assimilate the nūn.
4. Instead, the tongue abandons its firm contact with the alveolar ridge for the nūn. It moves towards the position of the ikhfā' letter but does not fully commit.
5. The velum is lowered, and a pure ghunnah (nasal hum) is sustained for two vowel counts.
6. At the end of the two counts, the tongue completes its movement to the articulation point of the ikhfā' letter, and that letter is pronounced clearly (without gemination).

The sound is a nasal hum that "glides" into the following consonant.

Levels of Ikhfā' (Marātib al-Ikhfā')

Because the ikhfā' letters vary in their distance from the nūn, the degree of concealment varies. This is traditionally divided into three levels:

- A'lā al-Marātib (Highest/Strongest Concealment): At ت، د، ط (tā', dāl, tā'). These are the closest to the nūn's articulation point (tip of the tongue). The concealment is strongest, meaning the nūn is almost assimilated, but the ghunnah remains. The tongue is very close to the nūn position.
- Awsaṭ al-Marātib (Middle Concealment): At the remaining ten letters: ث، ج، ذ، ز، س، ش، ص، ض، ظ، ف. The concealment is moderate.
- Adnā al-Marātib (Lowest/Weakest Concealment): At ق، ك (qāf, kāf). These are the furthest from the nūn (articulated at the back of the tongue/uvula). The concealment is lightest, meaning the nūn is almost clear, but the ghunnah still connects the sounds. The tongue is relatively far from the nūn position.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

In the standard muṣḥaf, a nūn sākinah that undergoes ikhfā' will have no sukūn and no other mark above it. A tanwīn that undergoes ikhfā' will be written with the two vowel marks parallel and sequential (e.g., or), not stacked or overlapping. The following ikhfā' letter will not have a shaddah.

Comparative Analysis with Ibn al-Jazarī

Ibn al-Jazarī's Muqaddimah is very concise on ikhfā':

وَالرَّابِعُ الْإِخْفَاءُ عِنْدَ الْفَاضِلِ ... مِنَ الْحُرُوفِ وَاجِبٌ لِلْفَاضِلِ

"The fourth is Ikhfā', according to the eminent one, from the [rest of the] letters; it is obligatory for the excellent reciter."

Al-Jamzūrī's wording is almost identical, showing the direct pedagogical lineage. He then provides the famous mnemonic verse for the fifteen letters, which is his own contribution (or a widely accepted one he incorporated).

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The "Half-N": The ikhfā' sound is notoriously difficult for English speakers. It is not a clear "n" and not a full assimilation. Think of it as a "half-n" – the tongue starts to go to the "n" position but stops short, leaving only the nasal hum.
- Drill: Take the word *min sharr* (مِنْ شَرٍّ). Do not say "min sharr." Do not say "mish-sharr" (that would be idghām, which is incorrect for shīn). Instead, try to say "min" but stop just as your tongue is about to touch the roof of your mouth. Let the air continue through your nose for two counts, and then say "sharr." The sound is "minnnn-sharr" where the "n" is not a crisp consonant but a nasal hum.
- Pinch Test: Pinch your nose closed. If you are doing ikhfā' correctly, the sound should stop or become severely distorted because the ghunnah requires nasal airflow.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IKHFĀ' AT ṬĀ' (ط) – HIGHEST LEVEL

Āyah: ﴿وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ سُلَالَةٍ مِنْ طِينٍ﴾ [المؤمنون: 12]

Transliteration: Wa-la-qad khalaqnā l-insāna min sulālatin min ṭīn

Translation: "And certainly did We create man from an extract of clay."

Application: The second phrase is مِنْ طِينٍ (min ṭīn). The nūn is sākinah. The following letter is ط (ṭā'). The nūn is concealed with a two-count ghunnah: minnnn-ṭīn. The tongue anticipates the emphatic ṭā'.

EXAMPLE 2: IKHFĀ' AT SHĪN (ش) – MIDDLE LEVEL

Āyah: ﴿قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ الْفَلَقِ﴾ [الفلق: 1-2] مِنْ شَرِّ مَا خَلَقَ

Transliteration: Qul a'ūdhu bi-rabbi l-falaq min sharri mā khalaq

Translation: "Say, 'I seek refuge in the Lord of daybreak, from the evil of that which He created.'"

Application: The phrase is مِنْ شَرِّ (min sharri). The nūn is sākinah. The following letter is ش (shīn). The nūn is concealed with ghunnah: minnnn-sharri.

EXAMPLE 3: IKHFĀ' AT QĀF (ق) – LOWEST LEVEL

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ إِلَّا رِجَالًا نُوحِي إِلَيْهِمْ﴾ [الأنبياء: 7]

Transliteration: Wa-mā arsalnā min qablīka illā rijālan nūhī ilayhim

Translation: "And We sent not before you [as messengers] except men to whom We revealed."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ قَبْلِكَ (min qablīka). The nūn is sākinah. The following letter is ق (qāf). The nūn is concealed with ghunnah, but the concealment is light because of the distance between the nūn and the qāf: minnnn-qablīka.

VERSES 15-16

The Mnemonic for the Fifteen Ikhfā' Letters

ARABIC TEXT

فِي خَمْسَةِ مِنْ بَعْدَ عَشْرِ رَمَزُهَا
فِي كَلِمٍ هَذَا الْبَيْتِ قَدْ ضَمَّنَهَا
صِفْ ذَا ثَنَاءٍ كَمْ جَادَ شَخْصٌ قَدْ سَمَا
دُمْ طَيِّبًا زِدْ فِي تَقَى ضَعْ ظَالِمًا

TRANSLITERATION

Fī khamsatin min ba'di 'ashrin ramzuhā

Fī kilmi hādhā l-bayti qad ḍammantuhā

Ṣif dhā thanā kam jāda shakhṣun qad samā

Dum ṭayyiban zid fī tuqan ḍa' ḡālīmā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فِي	<i>fī</i>	In
خَمْسَةِ	<i>khamsatin</i>	five
مِنْ	بَعْدَ	min ba'di after

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
عَشْرٍ	<i>‘ashrin</i>	ten
رَمَزُهَا	<i>ramzuhā</i>	their symbol / indication
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
كَلِمٍ	<i>kilmi</i>	(the) words of
هَذَا	<i>hādhā</i>	this
الْبَيْتِ	<i>al-bayti</i>	verse
قَدْ	<i>qad</i>	indeed
ضَمَّنْتُهَا	<i>ḍammantuhā</i>	I have included them

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"[They are] fifteen [letters], after ten [i.e., ten plus five]. Their symbol [or mnemonic] I have indeed included in the words of this verse:"

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
صِفْ	<i>ṣif</i>	Describe!
ذَا	<i>dhā</i>	(the) possessor of
ثَنَّا	<i>thanā</i>	praise
كَمْ	<i>kam</i>	How (many)
جَادَ	<i>jāda</i>	excelled / was generous
شَخْصٌ	<i>shakhṣun</i>	(a) person
قَدْ	<i>qad</i>	who has
سَمَا	<i>samā</i>	risen high

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
دُم	<i>dum</i>	Remain!
طَيِّبًا	<i>ṭayyiban</i>	good /pure
زِدْ	<i>zid</i>	Increase!
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
تَقَى	<i>tuqan</i>	piety
ضَعْ	<i>ḍaʿ</i>	Put down! / Humiliate!
ظَالِمًا	<i>ẓālimā</i>	(the) oppressor

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Ṣif dhā thanā kam jāda shakhṣun qad samā (Describe the possessor of praise; how many a person has excelled and risen high!) Dum ṭayyiban zid fī tuqan ḍaʿ ẓālimā (Remain good and pure; increase in piety; and humiliate the oppressor!)"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Mathematical Reference: Fī khamsatin min baʿdi ʿashrin literally means "in five after ten."

This is the classical Arabic way of expressing the number fifteen (10 + 5).

2. Ramzuhā: Ramz means "symbol," "code," or "indication." The poet tells us that the symbolic representation or the mnemonic code for these fifteen letters is contained in the following words.

3. The Dual Function of the Mnemonic Verse: This is the most famous and widely memorized verse of the Tuḥfah. It is a masterpiece of didactic poetry because it operates on two levels simultaneously:

- Tajweed Level: The first letter of each word in the verse is one of the fifteen letters of ikhfāʾ. Let us extract them:

ص - *Ṣif*

ذ - *Dhā*

ث - *Thanā*

ك - *Kam*

ج - *Jāda*

ش - *Shakhṣun*

ق - *Qad*

س - *Samā*

د - *Dum*

ط - *Ṭayyiban*

ز - *Zid*

ف - *Fī*

ت - *Tuqan*

ض - *Ḍaʿ*

ظ - *Zālimā*

These are precisely the fifteen letters of ikhfā'. The mnemonic is complete and flawless.

- Ethical Level: The verse is also a piece of moral instruction (adab). It commands the student (and the reciter) to:
- Praise and recognize those who are worthy (Ṣif dhā thanā).
- Acknowledge excellence and generosity (Kam jāda shakhṣun qad samā).
- Remain in a state of purity and goodness (Dum ṭayyiban).
- Strive for spiritual growth (Zid fī tuqan).
- Stand against oppression and injustice (Ḍaʿ zālimā).

This intertwining of technical knowledge with ethical exhortation is a hallmark of classical Islamic pedagogy.

Grammatical Notes on the Mnemonic Verse:

- Şif: Imperative verb from waṣafa (to describe).
- Dhā: One of the six nouns, meaning "possessor of." It is in the accusative case (manṣūb) because it is the object of şif. The alif is written but not pronounced in the nominative and genitive; here it is pronounced dhā.
- Thanā: Praise.
- Kam: Interrogative particle meaning "how many." It is in the nominative case as the subject of jāda.
- Jāda: Verb meaning "to be excellent" or "to be generous."
- Samā: Verb meaning "to be high" or "to be elevated."
- Dum: Imperative verb from dāma (to last, to remain).
- Ṭayyiban: Accusative circumstantial qualifier (ḥāl).
- Zid: Imperative verb from zāda (to increase).
- Tuqan: Accusative object of fi. The word is tuqā (piety), which is a defective noun (manqūṣ) with the final yā' elided.
- Ḍa': Imperative verb from waḍa'a (to put down, to humiliate). The middle radical wāw is elided in the imperative.
- Zālimā: Accusative object of ḍa', with an alif al-iṭlāq for the rhyme.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Reciting the Mnemonic: The verse itself is recited with Tajweed. For example, in min ba'di, the nūn undergoes iqlāb and is pronounced as a concealed mīm (mimmm-ba'di). In qad ḍammantuhā, the dāl of qad is assimilated into the ḍād of ḍammantu (this is a rule from a later section, idghām mutajānisayn).
- Pronunciation of the Letters:
 - ص (ṣād): Emphatic, voiceless alveolar sibilant [sʰ].
 - ذ (dhāl): Voiced interdental fricative [ð].
 - ث (thā'): Voiceless interdental fricative [θ].
 - ظ (ẓā'): Emphatic, voiced interdental fricative [ðʰ].
 - ض (ḍād): Emphatic, voiced alveolar stop or fricative [dʰ] or [ʒʰ].
 - ط (ṭā'): Emphatic, voiceless alveolar stop [tʰ].
 - ق (qāf): Voiceless uvular stop [q].
 - ك (kāf): Voiceless velar stop [k].

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES FOR EACH LETTER OF IKHFĀ' (CONCISE TABLE)

Letter Example Ayah Transliteration of Phrase Rule Applied

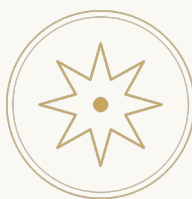
ت (t)	﴿البقرة: 23﴾ ﴿أَنْ تَقُولُوا﴾ an taqūlū Ikhfā'
ث (th)	﴿البقرة: 25﴾ ﴿مِنْ ثَمَرَةٍ﴾ min thamaratin Ikhfā'
ج (j)	﴿قريش: 4﴾ ﴿مِنْ جُوعٍ﴾ min jū'in Ikhfā'
د (d)	﴿البقرة: 23﴾ ﴿مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ﴾ min dūni llāh Ikhfā'
ذ (dh)	﴿النساء: 124﴾ ﴿مِنْ ذَكَرٍ﴾ min dhakaran Ikhfā'
ز (z)	﴿implied, e.g.,﴾ min zawjin Ikhfā'
س (s)	﴿آل عمران: 193﴾ ﴿مِنْ سَيِّئَاتِهِمْ﴾ min sayyi'ātihim Ikhfā'
ش (sh)	﴿الفرقان: 2﴾ ﴿مِنْ شَرٍّ﴾ min sharri Ikhfā'
ص (ṣ)	﴿الحجر: 26﴾ ﴿مِنْ صَلَٰلٍ﴾ min ṣalṣālin Ikhfā'
ض (ḍ)	﴿الغاشية: 6﴾ ﴿مِنْ ضَرِيْعٍ﴾ min ḍarī'in Ikhfā'
ط (ṭ)	﴿المؤمنون: 12﴾ ﴿مِنْ طِينٍ﴾ min ṭīnin Ikhfā'
ظ (ẓ)	﴿الإسراء: 92﴾ ﴿مِنْ ظَهْرٍ﴾ min ẓahīrin Ikhfā'
ف (f)	﴿الجمعة: 10﴾ ﴿مِنْ فَضْلِ اللَّهِ﴾ min faḍli llāh Ikhfā'
ق (q)	﴿البقرة: 25﴾ ﴿مِنْ قَبْلِ﴾ min qablu Ikhfā'
ك (k)	﴿آل عمران: 37﴾ ﴿مِنْ كُلِّ﴾ min kulli Ikhfā'

A Critical English Edition of Tuhfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qur'ān

PART III

الْبَابُ الثَّالِثُ

The Rules of Mīm and Nūn with Shaddah (Verse
17)



Overview

After establishing the detailed rules governing the nūn sākinah and tanwīn, al-Jamzūrī turns to a brief but essential rule concerning the letters م (mīm) and ن (nūn) when they appear with a shaddah (ّ), i.e., when they are geminated (doubled). This rule is foundational because the correct pronunciation of geminated mīm and nūn is a prerequisite for the proper application of many other rules, including idghām and ikhfāʾ. A single verse suffices to convey this rule, demonstrating the poet’s economy of language.

VERSE 17

The Obligation of Ghunnah in Geminated Mīm and Nūn

ARABIC TEXT

وَعَنْ مِيمًا ثُمَّ نُونًا شُدِّدَا
وَسَمِّ كُلَّ حَرْفٍ غُنَّةً بَدَا

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-ghunna mīman thumma nūnan shuddidā

wa-sammi kullan ḥarfa ghunnatin badā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَعَنْ	<i>wa-ghunna</i>	And apply ghunnah (nasalization)
مِيمًا	<i>mīman</i>	(to) a mīm
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	then (also)
نُونًا	<i>nūnan</i>	(to) a nūn
شُدِّدَا	<i>shuddidā</i>	when they are geminated
وَسَمِّ	<i>wa-sammi</i>	and call
كُلَّ	<i>kullan</i>	each (of them)
حَرْفٍ	<i>ḥarfa</i>	a letter of

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
غَنَّةٌ	<i>ghunnatin</i>	ghunnah
بَدَا	<i>badā</i>	(that) is apparent / evident

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And apply ghunnah (nasalization) to a م (mīm) and also to a ن (nūn) when they are geminated. And call each [of them] a letter of ghunnah [whose nasal quality] is clearly evident."

LINGUISTIC ANALYSIS

1. Wa-ghunna: The verb ghunna is an imperative (amr) from the root gh-n-n. It is in the second-person masculine singular form, instructing the reciter: "Apply ghunnah!" The nūn at the end is the nūn al-tawkid al-khafifah (light energetic nūn), which emphasizes the command. It is vocalized with a fatḥah because the verb is built upon it (mabnī 'alā l-fatḥ). The meaning is: "You must definitely nasalize."
2. Mīman thumma Nūnan: Both mīman and nūnan are in the accusative case (manṣūb) as the direct objects of the verb ghunna. The particle thumma indicates a sequential order, but here it simply means "and also." The order is not hierarchically significant; both letters are equal in this rule.
3. Shuddidā: This is a passive verb in the perfect tense (māḍī mabnī li-l-majhūl), in the dual form, meaning "they (both) have been geminated." It is a circumstantial qualifier (ḥāl) or a conditional clause meaning "when they are geminated." The alif al-iṭlāq is added for the meter and rhyme.
4. Wa-sammi kullān ḥarfā ghunnatin badā: This is a nominal sentence with an imperative. Sammi is an imperative verb meaning "call" or "name." Kullān is the direct object, meaning "each [of them]." The phrase ḥarfā ghunnatin badā is a compound noun phrase: ḥarfā (letter of) + ghunnatin (nasalization) + the relative clause badā (which is apparent/evident). The full predicate is "call each of them 'a letter of ghunnah that is clearly apparent'."

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Ghunnah and Gemination (Shaddah)

- Ghunnah (غَنَّةٌ): Linguistically, it is a nasal twang or resonance. In Tajweed terminology, it is a pure, melodious sound that is inherent to the letters م (mīm) and ن (nūn). It originates from the nasal cavity (al-khayshūm). It is an essential attribute (ṣifah lāzimah) of these two letters, present whether they are voweled, quiescent, or geminated.
- Shaddah (شَدَّةٌ) or Tashdīd (تَشْدِيدٌ): This is the diacritical mark (ّ) that indicates the gemination (doubling) of a consonant. A letter with a shaddah is, in phonetic reality, two identical letters: the first is sākin (quiescent), and the second is mutaḥarrik (voweled). For example, mīm mushaddadah (مّ) = mīm sākinah (م) + mīm mutaḥarrikah (م, م, or مّ).

The Ruling: Obligatory Ghunnah for Two Counts

The rule stated in this verse is universally agreed upon (ijmā') and is absolutely obligatory (wājib). When a reciter encounters a م (mīm) or ن (nūn) with a shaddah, they must produce a clear, full ghunnah (nasalization) lasting for the duration of two vowel counts (ḥarakatayn).

Why two counts? Because the geminated letter comprises two components: a quiescent letter and a voweled letter. The ghunnah is an inherent attribute of the quiescent mīm or nūn. When this quiescent letter is followed by its voweled counterpart, the ghunnah of the first letter is fully realized during the "hold" of the gemination. Thus, the sound we hear is the ghunnah of the first letter sustained for two counts, followed by the release of the voweled second letter. The total sound is a prolonged nasal resonance.

Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter encounters a mīm or nūn with a shaddah.
2. For م (mīm mushaddadah): The two lips are firmly closed (for the first, sākin mīm). The velum is lowered, opening the nasal passage. Air flows through the nose, producing a pure, humming ghunnah [m:] for exactly two counts. After the two counts, the lips open to release the voweled second mīm (e.g., ma, mu, mi). The sound is a continuous hum that transitions into the vowel.
3. For ن (nūn mushaddadah): The tip of the tongue is pressed against the upper alveolar ridge (for the first, sākin nūn). The velum is lowered. Air flows through the nose, producing a pure, humming ghunnah [n:] for exactly two counts. After the two counts, the tongue releases to pronounce the voweled second nūn. The sound is a continuous hum from the tongue-tip position.

The Phrase "Letter of Ghunnah that is Apparent"

Al-Jamzūrī instructs the student to identify mīm and nūn as ḥarfā ghunnah (letters of ghunnah). This is a crucial terminological designation. It signifies that ghunnah is not merely an incidental feature of these letters; it is their defining characteristic. This is why the ghunnah "survives" when these letters are concealed (ikhfā') or partially assimilated (idghām bi-ghunnah). The nasal resonance is the enduring identity of the mīm and nūn.

Comparative Analysis

Ibn al-Jazarī in his Muqaddimah states:

وَعَنَّ مِيمًا ثُمَّ نُونًا شَدَّدَا
وَسَمَّ كُلَّ حَرْفٍ غَنَّةً بَدَا

"And apply ghunnah to a mīm, then a nūn, when geminated; and call each a letter of ghunnah that is apparent."

The verse is identical. This indicates that al-Jamzūrī directly incorporated this line from the Jazariyyah into his own poem, a common practice in the didactic tradition, serving to connect his work to the authoritative source and to benefit from its precise phrasing.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- English Nasal Sounds: English has nasal consonants (/m/, /n/, /ŋ/), but we do not normally sustain them for a prolonged duration as independent sounds. The concept of a "two-count hum" is foreign and requires conscious practice.
- Drill for Mīm: Take the word **ثُمَّ** (thumma). Pronounce the th sound [θ], then close your lips and hum "mmm" for a full two seconds. Then, without stopping the hum, open your lips to an "a" sound: "thu-mmm-ma." The transition should be smooth, not "thum-ma" (with a short m).
- Drill for Nūn: Take the word **إِنَّ** (inna). Pronounce the i sound, then put your tongue tip to the roof of your mouth and hum "nnnn" for two seconds. Then release to an "a" sound: "i-nnn-na."
- Error to Avoid: The most common error is shortening the ghunnah to the length of a regular single consonant. This is *lahn jalī* (a major error) because it effectively reduces the geminated letter to a single letter, changing the word's meaning or structure.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS**EXAMPLE 1: MĪM MUSHADDADAH (مّ)**

Āyah: ﴿ثُمَّ رَدَدْنَاهُ أَسْفَلَ سَافِلِينَ﴾ [التين: ٥]

Transliteration: Thumma radadnāhu asfala sāfilīn

Translation: "Then We returned him to the lowest of the low."

Application: The word is **ثُمَّ** (thumma). It contains a mīm with a shaddah. The reciter must sustain the ghunnah for two counts: thu-mmm-ma. The lips are closed for the hum, then opened for the fatḥah.

EXAMPLE 2: NŪN MUSHADDADAH (نّ)

Āyah: ﴿إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ فِي لَيْلَةِ الْقَدْرِ﴾ [القدر: ١]

Transliteration: Innā anzalnāhu fī laylati l-qadr

Translation: "Indeed, We sent it down during the Night of Decree."

Application: The word is **إِنَّا** (innā). It begins with a nūn with a shaddah. The reciter sustains the ghunnah: i-nnn-nā. The tongue tip is on the alveolar ridge for the hum, then releases for the fatḥah.

EXAMPLE 3: NŪN MUSHADDADAH RESULTING FROM IDGHĀM

Āyah: ﴿مِنْ نِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ فَحَنِّكَ﴾ [النحل: ٥٣]

Transliteration: Min ni‘matin fa-mina llāh → minn-ni‘matin

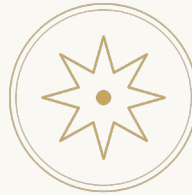
Translation: "Whatever blessing you have, it is from Allah."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ. The nūn of min is sākinah, and it is followed by a voweled nūn. The nūn sākinah is assimilated into the following nūn (idghām bi-ghunnah), resulting in a single geminated nūn with a shaddah. The reciter sustains the ghunnah for two counts: minn-ni‘matin. This demonstrates how the rule of idghām bi-ghunnah produces a geminated nūn that then must be pronounced according to the rule in this verse.

PART IV

الْبَابُ الرَّابِعُ

The Rules of Mīm Sākinah (Verses 18–23)





Overview

The rules for the quiescent mīm (al-mīm al-sākinah) are simpler than those for the nūn sākinah, as they involve only three possible rulings instead of four. The mīm sākinah is a mīm devoid of any vowel, occurring in nouns, verbs, and particles. Al-Jamzūrī dedicates six verses (18–23) to this topic, outlining the three rules: Ikhfā' Shafawī (Labial Concealment), Idghām Mithlayn Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation of Identical Letters), and Izhār Shafawī (Labial Clarification).

VERSE 18

Introduction and Condition

ARABIC TEXT

وَالْمِيمُ إِن تَسْكُنْ تَجِي قَبْلَ الْهَجَا
لَا أَلِفٍ لَّيِّنَةٍ لِّذِي الْهَجَا

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-mīmu in taskun tajī qabla l-hijā

lā alifin layyinatin li-dhī l-ḥijā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالْمِيمُ	<i>wa-l-mīmu</i>	And the mīm
إِنْ	<i>in</i>	if
تَسْكُنْ	<i>taskun</i>	it is quiescent
تَجِي	<i>tajī</i>	it comes
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	before
الْهَجَا	<i>al-hijā</i>	the letters of the alphabet
لَا	<i>lā</i>	not (excluding)
أَلِفٍ	<i>alifin</i>	the alif
لَّيِّنَةٍ	<i>layyinatin</i>	(which is) soft / flexible

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
لِـذِي	<i>li-dhī</i>	for the possessor of
الْحِجَا	<i>al-ḥijā</i>	intellect / understanding

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And the mīm, when it is quiescent and occurs before any of the letters of the alphabet—with the exception of the soft alif—[this is a matter] for the possessor of intellect [to understand]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-mīmu in taskun: The verse begins with a conditional clause. The subject is al-mīm, and the condition is in taskun ("if it is quiescent"). The verb taskun is in the jussive (majzūm) mood after the conditional particle in.
2. Tajī qabla l-ḥijā: Tajī is the apocopated form of tajī'u (it comes), also in the jussive mood, linked to taskun by the implied conjunction wa- ("and"). The phrase means "and it occurs before the letters of the alphabet." Al-ḥijā is a shortened form of al-hijā' (الهِجَاء), meaning the spelling or the alphabet. This establishes that the rules for mīm sākinah are determined by the letter that follows it.
3. Lā alifin layyinatīn: This is a crucial exception. The "soft alif" (al-alif al-layyinah) refers to the alif that functions as a long vowel (alif al-madd), which is always sākinah (quiescent) and is preceded by a faṭḥah. The poet excludes it because a mīm sākinah is never followed directly by a long-vowel alif. The phonetic structure of Arabic prohibits the meeting of two sākin letters in this specific sequence (a consonant followed by a long vowel without an intervening vowel). The alif is not an independent consonant; it is an extension of the preceding faṭḥah. Therefore, the mīm sākinah always faces a true consonant letter (one of the other 28 letters).
4. Li-dhī l-ḥijā: Dhī is one of the six nouns, meaning "possessor of." It is in the genitive case (majrūr) because of the preposition li-. Al-ḥijā means "intellect," "understanding," or "reason." The phrase li-dhī l-ḥijā is a parenthetical remark: "[This explanation is intended] for the one who possesses intelligence." It is a common rhetorical device to flatter the student and encourage attentive study, implying that only the thoughtful will grasp these subtleties.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Mīm Sākinah

The mīm sākinah (الميم الساكنة) is the letter م (mīm) that is devoid of the three short vowels and is marked by a sukūn (◌). It is a bilabial nasal consonant, articulated by closing the two lips together and allowing air to resonate through the nasal cavity. Like the nūn sākinah, it can occur in any part of speech (noun, verb, or particle) and remains present both in continuous recitation (waṣl) and when pausing (waqf). Examples include: al-ḥamdu (noun), lam (particle), ya'lam (verb).

The Three Rulings (al-Aḥkām al-Thalāthah)

Unlike the nūn sākinah which has four rulings, the mīm sākinah has only three, based on the following letter:

1. Al-Ikhfā' al-Shafawī (Labial Concealment): Before the letter ب (bā').
2. Al-Idghām al-Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation): Before the letter م (mīm).
3. Al-Iẓhār al-Shafawī (Labial Clarification): Before the remaining 26 letters.

These will be detailed in the following verses.

Phonetic Note for English Speakers

The Arabic mīm (م) is a voiced bilabial nasal [m], identical to the English /m/ in "moon." The sukūn simply means it is not followed by a vowel; it is a pure consonant closure.

VERSE 19

The Three Rulings Enumerated

ARABIC TEXT

أَحْكَامُهَا ثَلَاثَةٌ لِمَنْ ضَبَطَ
إِخْفَاءً ادْغَامٌ وَإِظْهَارٌ فَقَطْ

TRANSLITERATION

Aḥkāmuḥā thalāthatun li-man ḍabaṭ

ikhfā'un idghāmun wa-iẓhārun faqaṭ

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَحْكَامُهَا	<i>aḥkāmuḥā</i>	Its rulings
ثَلَاثَةٌ	<i>thalāthatun</i>	(are) three
لِمَنْ	<i>li-man</i>	for the one who
ضَبَطَ	<i>ḍabaṭ</i>	is precise / accurate
إِخْفَاءً	<i>ikhfā'un</i>	Ikhfā' (Concealment)
ادْغَامٌ	<i>idghāmun</i>	Idghām (Assimilation)
وَإِظْهَارٌ	<i>wa-iẓhārun</i>	and Iẓhār (Clarification)
فَقَطْ	<i>faqaṭ</i>	only / exclusively

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Its rulings are three, for the one who is precise [in his knowledge]: Ikhfā', Idghām, and Izhār – only [these three]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Aḥkāmuhā thalāthatun: A simple nominal sentence. Aḥkāmu is the plural of ḥukm (ruling). The feminine singular possessive pronoun -hā refers back to al-mīm (which is a feminine noun in Arabic).
2. Li-man ḍabaṭ: Man is a relative pronoun meaning "the one who." Ḍabaṭ is a perfect verb meaning "he was precise," "he mastered," or "he held firmly." The phrase means "for the one who has mastered [the science]." This is a pedagogical nudge: the student who has studied diligently will appreciate the clarity and sufficiency of these three rules.
3. Ikhfā'un Idghāmun wa-Izhārun Faqaṭ: This is a list of the three rules. The word faqaṭ (فَقَطْ) is a particle of restriction, meaning "only" or "exclusively." It firmly closes the door to any suggestion of a fourth rule for the mīm sākinah. This is important because students might mistakenly think that iqlāb (which applies to nūn) might also apply to mīm, or that there is a separate rule for mīm before a throat letter. The restriction faqaṭ clarifies that the matter is settled at three.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Comparison with Nūn Sākinah Rules

Feature Nūn Sākinah Mīm Sākinah

Number of Rules Four Three

Rule 1 Izhār Ḥalqī (6 letters) Ikhfā' Shafawī (1 letter: ب)

Rule 2 Idghām bi-Ghunnah (4 letters) Idghām Mithlayn (1 letter: م)

Rule 3 Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah (2 letters) Izhār Shafawī (26 letters)

Rule 4 Iqlāb (1 letter: ب) (None)

Rule 5 Ikhfā' Ḥaqīqī (15 letters) (None)

The mīm's rules are fewer because its articulation (bilabial) is less versatile than the nūn's (lingual-alveolar). It has no separate iqlāb rule (because converting mīm to another letter before bā' is unnecessary; instead, it is concealed). It has no ikhfā' at multiple letters; instead, it simply clarifies (izhār) before the vast majority of letters.

VERSE 20

Al-Ikhfā' al-Shafawī (Labial Concealment)

ARABIC TEXT

فَالأَوَّلُ الْإِخْفَاءُ عِنْدَ الْبَاءِ
وَسَمِّهِ الشَّفَوِيَّ لِلْقُرَّاءِ

TRANSLITERATION

Fa-l-awwalu l-ikhfā'u 'inda l-bā'i

wa-sammihi sh-shafawiyya li-l-qurrā'i

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فَالأَوَّلُ	<i>fa-l-awwalu</i>	So the first
الْإِخْفَاءُ	<i>al-ikhfā'u</i>	(is) Ikhfā'
عِنْدَ	<i>'inda</i>	at / before
الْبَاءِ	<i>al-bā'i</i>	the bā'
وَسَمِّهِ	<i>wa-sammihi</i>	and call it
الشَّفَوِيَّ	<i>ash-shafawiyya</i>	the Labial (Concealment)
لِلْقُرَّاءِ	<i>li-l-qurrā'i</i>	according to the reciters

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The first [rule] is Ikhfā' (Concealment), [which occurs] before the letter ب (bā'). And call it 'the Labial Concealment' (al-Ikhfā' al-Shafawī), according to the terminology of the reciters."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Fa-l-awwalu l-ikhfā'u 'inda l-bā'i: This is a direct parallel to the structure used for the nūn sākīnah rules. The rule is ikhfā', and the single triggering letter is ب (bā').
2. Wa-sammihi sh-shafawiyya: Sammi is an imperative verb ("call it," "name it"). The attached pronoun -hi refers to al-ikhfā'. Ash-Shafawī is an adjective derived from shafah (شفة), meaning "lip." Thus, al-ikhfā' al-shafawī means "the labial concealment" or "the concealment using the lips." This term distinguishes it from al-ikhfā' al-ḥaqīqī (the true concealment of the nūn).

3. Li-l-qurrā'i: This phrase attributes the terminology to the authoritative community of Qur'ān reciters (al-qurrā'). It emphasizes that this is not merely al-Jamzūrī's personal coinage but the established technical language of the science.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of *Al-Ikhfā' al-Shafawī* (Labial Concealment)

- Linguistic Meaning: Same as before: "to hide" or "to conceal."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: It is the pronunciation of the mīm sākinah in a concealed manner when followed by the letter ب (bā'). The lips do not close completely to produce a full, clear mīm. Instead, they close lightly and loosely, allowing a pure ghunnah (nasal hum) to be the dominant sound for a duration of two vowel counts (ḥarakatayn).

The Phonetic Rationale

This rule is identical in its phonetic execution to the rule of iqlāb for the nūn sākinah before bā' (see verse 13). Let us review the rationale in the context of the mīm:

- The mīm (م) and the bā' (ب) are both labial sounds (articulated with the lips).
- Mīm: Dry portion of both lips.
- Bā': Inner portion of the lower lip against the edges of the upper teeth.
- They are extremely close in articulation. If the mīm were pronounced with full, clear closure (iẓhār), the transition to the bā' would be somewhat heavy, requiring a full release of the lips and then a new closure.
- If the mīm were fully assimilated (idghām) into the bā', it would lose its identity and, more importantly, its ghunnah. The bā' is not a nasal sound, so complete assimilation would eliminate the nasal resonance.
- The optimal solution is ikhfā': The mīm is concealed. The lips close lightly and incompletely. The ghunnah (nasal hum) is sustained for two counts. This preserves the essential nasal quality of the mīm while allowing a smooth, effortless transition to the bā'. The tongue and lips are already in the general vicinity for the bā'.

Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter encounters a mīm sākinah followed by a bā' (e.g., hum bihi).
2. Do not pronounce a clear, firm mīm (lips pressed hard together).
3. Instead, bring the two lips together lightly, as if you are about to hum. There should be a tiny gap or very gentle contact.
4. Lower the velum to open the nasal passage. Produce a pure, sustained ghunnah (nasal hum) for exactly two vowel counts. The sound is a continuous "mmmm" but without the strong labial closure.
5. After the two counts, the lips adjust to the position for the ب (bā'), and the bā' is pronounced normally. The bā' does not receive a shaddah.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

A mīm sākinah that undergoes ikhfā' shafawī is usually written with its sukūn replaced by a small م (mīm) above it, or it is left unmarked. The following bā' has no shaddah. The tanwīn does not apply here, as the rule is for mīm sākinah only.

Comparative Analysis with Iqlāb

Feature Iqlāb (Nūn Sākinah) Ikhfā' Shafawī (Mīm Sākinah)

Original Letter ن (nūn) م (mīm)

Following Letter ب (bā') ب (bā')

Transformation Converted to م (mīm) Remains م (mīm)

Pronunciation Concealed م with ghunnah Concealed م with ghunnah

Acoustic Result Identical: A two-count nasal hum with light lip closure Identical: A two-count nasal hum with light lip closure

The student will notice that the sound produced by iqlāb and ikhfā' shafawī is exactly the same. In iqlāb, the nūn becomes a concealed mīm; in ikhfā' shafawī, the original mīm is itself concealed. The end result is a seamless, hummed transition to the bā'.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The "Light M": English speakers must learn to produce a nasal hum without firmly closing the lips. Practice humming "mmmm" with your lips barely touching. Then, practice transitioning from that hum to a "b" sound. It should feel like "mmmm-ba" where the "m" is not a crisp consonant.
- Drill: Take the phrase لَهُمْ بِهِ (lahum bihi). Do not say "lahum bihi" with a strong "m." Do not say "lahub bihi" (omitting the m). Say "lahu-mmmmm-bihi." The "mmmm" should be a smooth, two-count hum with light lip closure, followed directly by the "b."

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS**EXAMPLE 1: IKHFĀ' SHAFAWĪ WITH MĪM SĀKINAH AT THE END OF A WORD**

Āyah: ﴿خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَىٰ قُلُوبِهِمْ وَعَلَىٰ سَمْعِهِمْ وَعَلَىٰ أَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةٌ وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ عَظِيمٌ﴾ وَمِنَ النَّاسِ
[البقرة: 7-8] مَنْ يَقُولُ آمَنَّا بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ وَمَا هُمْ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ ﴿

Transliteration: ...wa-mā hum bi-mu'minīn

Translation: "...and they are not believers."

Application: The phrase is هُمْ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ (hum bi-mu'minīn). The mīm of hum is sākinah. The following letter is ب (bā'). The mīm is concealed with a two-count ghunnah: hummm-bi-mu'minīn. The lips are lightly closed for the hum, then released for the bā'.

EXAMPLE 2: IKHFĀ' SHAFAWĪ WITH MĪM SĀKINAH WITHIN A WORD

Āyah: ﴿أَمْ بِهِ جِنَّةٌ﴾ [المؤمنون: 70]

Transliteration: Am bihi jinnah

Translation: "Or is there in him madness?"

Application: The word is أَمْ (am bihi). The mīm of am is sākinah. The following letter is ب (bā') within the same prepositional phrase. The mīm is concealed: ammm-bihi.

EXAMPLE 3: IKHFĀ' SHAFAWĪ WITH MĪM SĀKINAH IN THE MIDDLE OF A WORD

Āyah: ﴿لَيَنْبِذَنَّ﴾ [الهمزة: 4] (This is actually iqlāb from nūn. For a pure mīm, consider:)

Alternative Example: ﴿وَمَا هُمْ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ﴾ is a perfect example. Another common one is هُمْ [الكهف: 47].

Transliteration: Hum bārizūn

Translation: "They will come forth."

Application: Hum bārizūn. The mīm is concealed: hummm-bārizūn.

VERSE 21

Al-Idghām al-Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation)

ARABIC TEXT

وَالثَّانِ إِدْغَامٌ بِمِثْلِهَا أَتَى
وَسَمِّ إِدْغَامًا صَغِيرًا يَا فَتَى

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-th-thānī idghāmun bi-mithlihā atā

wa-sammi idghāman ṣaghīran yā fatā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالثَّانِ	<i>wa-th-thānī</i>	And the second
إِدْغَامٌ	<i>idghāmun</i>	(is) Idghām

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
بِمِثْلِهَا	<i>bi-mithlihā</i>	with its like
أَتَى	<i>atā</i>	(which) comes
وَسَمِّ	<i>wa-sammi</i>	and call
إِدْغَامًا	<i>idghāman</i>	(it) Idghām
صَغِيرًا	<i>ṣaghīran</i>	Small

يَا فَتَى *yā fatā* O young man / O student

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The second [rule] is Idghām (Assimilation). It occurs with [a letter] like itself. And call it 'Small Assimilation' (Idghām Ṣaghīr), O young student!"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-th-thānī Idghāmūn: The second rule for mīm sākinah is idghām.
2. Bi-mithlihā Atā: The phrase bi-mithlihā means "with a letter like it." The feminine pronoun -hā refers to the mīm. Thus, this idghām occurs when the mīm sākinah is followed by another م (mīm). The verb atā means "it comes" or "it occurs."
3. Wa-sammi Idghāman Ṣaghīran: The poet instructs the student to call this specific type of assimilation idghām ṣaghīr (small assimilation). This terminology is crucial and will be explained in detail later in the poem (verses 33–34) when discussing the three types of similar letters (mithlayn, mutaḥāribayn, mutaḥāribayn). For now, the student learns the name.
4. Yā Fatā: Fatā literally means a young man, a youth, or a noble, generous person. It is a term of endearment and encouragement used by teachers for their students. It creates a friendly, supportive pedagogical tone.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of *Al-Idghām al-Ṣaghīr* (Small Assimilation)

- Linguistic Meaning: As previously defined, idghām is "insertion" or "merging."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: This is the complete assimilation of a mīm sākinah into a following voweled mīm. The two mīms become a single, geminated mīm (مّم). Because the first letter is sākin and the second is mutaḥarrik, it is classified as Idghām Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation). "Small" refers to the fact that the first letter is already quiescent, making the assimilation phonetically "easy" or "light."

The Phonetic Rationale

This is a case of Idghām Mithlayn (Assimilation of Two Identical Letters). When two identical consonants meet, with the first being quiescent and the second voweled, assimilation is

phonetically natural and almost universal in connected speech across languages. It is easier to pronounce a single, prolonged consonant than two separate ones. The Arabic script explicitly indicates this by writing a shaddah (ّ) on the second mīm.

Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter encounters a mīm sākinah followed by a voweled mīm (e.g., lahum mā).
2. The two lips close once for the mīm.
3. Instead of releasing the lips after the first mīm, the reciter sustains the closure for the duration of two vowel counts (ḥarakatayn). During this hold, the ghunnah (nasal hum) is fully realized.
4. After the two counts, the lips release directly into the vowel of the second mīm. The result is a single, geminated mīm with a clear, two-count ghunnah.

Comparison with the Rule for Geminated Mīm (Verse 17)

This rule is, in fact, a specific application of the general rule given in verse 17. The assimilation of mīm sākinah into mīm mutaḥarrikah creates a mīm mushaddadah (مّ). And verse 17 commanded: Wa-ghunna mīman... shuddidā ("Apply ghunnah to a mīm when it is geminated"). Thus, the pronunciation of idghām mithlayn for mīm is exactly the same as the pronunciation of any other geminated mīm. The ghunnah is obligatory for two counts.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

The mīm sākinah will be written without a sukūn, and the following mīm will have a shaddah (ّ). For example: lahum mā is written لهم ما.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- This rule is relatively easy for English speakers, as we naturally geminate identical consonants across word boundaries to some extent (e.g., "roommate" pronounced with a prolonged /m/). The key is to ensure the ghunnah is sustained for the full two counts and not shortened.
- Drill: Take لهم ما (lahum mā). Do not say "lahum mā" with a single, short m. Say "lahummm-mā." Hold the "mmm" for two full seconds before releasing the "ā."

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IDGHĀM ṢAGHĪR WITH MĪM SĀKINAH AT THE END OF A WORD

Āyah: ﴿وَلَهُمْ مَا يَشْتَهُونَ﴾ [الأنبياء: 102]

Transliteration: Wa-lahum mā yashtahūn

Translation: "And they will have whatever they desire."

Application: The phrase is لهم ما (lahum mā). The mīm of lahum is sākinah. The following word begins with a voweled mīm (mā). The mīm sākinah is assimilated into the following mīm, producing a geminated mīm with a two-count ghunnah: lahummmā. The muṣḥaf writes

it with a shaddah on the second mīm: **لَهُمْ مَا**.

EXAMPLE 2: IDGHĀM ṢAGHĪR WITH MĪM SĀKINAH WITHIN A WORD

Āyah: ﴿أَمِنْ هُوَ قَانَتْ أَنَاءُ اللَّيْلِ سَاجِدًا وَقَائِمًا﴾ [الزمر: 9]

Transliteration: Amman huwa qānitun...

Translation: "Is one who is devoutly obedient during periods of the night..."

Application: The word **أَمِنْ** (amman) is derived from am + man. The mīm of am is sākinah, and it is followed by the mīm of man. The two mīms are assimilated into a single geminated mīm: amm-mān. The ghunnah is sustained for two counts. The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the first mīm: **أَمِنْ**.

EXAMPLE 3: IDGHĀM ṢAGHĪR IN A COMMON QUR'ĀNIC PHRASE

Āyah: ﴿أَمْ مَنْ يَكُونُ عَلَيْهِمْ وَكِيلًا﴾ [النساء: 109]

Transliteration: Am man yakūnu 'alayhim wakīlā

Translation: "Or who could be against them a manager?"

Application: The phrase is **أَمْ مَنْ** (am man). The mīm of am is sākinah, followed by the mīm of man. Assimilated to amm-mān with a two-count ghunnah.

VERSE 22

Al-Izhār al-Shafawī (Labial Clarification)

ARABIC TEXT

وَالثَّالِثُ الْإِظْهَارُ فِي الْبَقِيَّةِ
مِنْ أَحْرَفٍ وَسَمِهَا شَفَوِيَّةٌ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-th-thālithu l-izhāru fi l-baqiyyah

min aḥrufin wa-sammihā shafawiyyah

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالثَّالِثُ	<i>wa-th-thālithu</i>	And the third
الْإِظْهَارُ	<i>al-izhāru</i>	(is) Izhār
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in / before
الْبَقِيَّةِ	<i>al-baqiyyah</i>	the remainder
مِنْ	<i>min</i>	of
أَحْرُفٍ	<i>aḥrufin</i>	letters
وَسَمِّهَا	<i>wa-sammihā</i>	and call it
شَفَوِيَّةً	<i>shafawiyyah</i>	Labial

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The third [rule] is Izhār (Clarification) before the remainder of the letters. And call it 'the Labial Clarification' (al-Izhār al-Shafawī)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-th-thālithu l-izhāru fī l-baqiyyah: The third and final rule is izhār. It applies to al-baqiyyah (the remainder) of the Arabic letters. This is an economical way of saying "all letters except the ب (bā') and the م (mīm)." Since there are 28 letters total, and two have specific rules, izhār applies to the remaining 26 letters.
2. Min aḥrufin: This is an explicative min (مِنْ), meaning "consisting of the letters" or simply "of the letters."
3. Wa-sammihā shafawiyyah: The pronoun -hā is feminine singular, referring to al-izhār (which is a masculine noun? Actually, izhār is masculine, but perhaps it refers to al-baqiyyah or al-aḥruf? It likely refers to al-qā'idah (the rule) which is feminine, or simply izhār is treated as feminine in this context. The meaning is clear: "Call this rule al-izhār al-shafawī." It is "labial" because it concerns the clear pronunciation of the labial letter mīm.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Izhār al-Shafawī (Labial Clarification)

- Linguistic Meaning: Izhār means "making apparent" or "clarifying."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: It is the clear, distinct pronunciation of the mīm sākinah from its own articulation point (the two lips), without any prolongation of the ghunnah, when it is followed by any letter other than ب (bā') and م (mīm). The mīm is heard as a crisp, clear [m] sound, and the reciter then moves immediately to the following letter.

The Remaining Letters (26 Letters)

These are all the letters of the Arabic alphabet except bā' and mīm. They include throat letters, emphatic letters, sibilants, etc. Because the mīm and the following letter do not share the specific relationship of being identical (mīm) or being a bā', the default rule of clear pronunciation applies.

Acoustic and Articulatory Process

1. The reciter encounters a mīm sākinah followed by any letter other than bā' or mīm.
2. The two lips are firmly closed to produce a full, clear م (mīm) sound. The ghunnah is present (as it is inherent to mīm), but it is not prolonged. It is the natural, brief nasalization of a single consonant.
3. The lips then open, and the reciter immediately moves to the articulation of the following letter. There is no hesitation, no hum, and no merging.

The Exception: Caution with Wāw (و) and Fā' (ف)

Al-Jamzūrī will address this in the very next verse. The letters و (wāw) and ف (fā') share the labial articulation point with the mīm. Because of this proximity, there is a risk that a careless reciter might inadvertently conceal (ikhfā') or assimilate (idghām) the mīm into these letters. The poet will explicitly warn against this, emphasizing that the izhār must be exceptionally clear before wāw and fā'.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

The mīm sākinah is written with its standard sukūn (◌ْ). The following letter has no shaddah. There is no special symbol.

Comparative Analysis with Izhār Ḥalqī

Feature Izhār Ḥalqī (for Nūn) Izhār Shafawī (for Mīm)

Original Letter ن (nūn) م (mīm)

Following Letters 6 throat letters 26 letters (all but ب and م)

Articulation Clear [n] from tongue tip Clear [m] from lips

Rationale Distance of makhraj Default rule / non-specific relationship

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Clear "M": This is the easiest rule for English speakers, as it simply requires pronouncing a clear, distinct [m] sound. The key is to ensure the lips close fully for the mīm and then release cleanly to the next sound.
- Drill: Take لَهُمْ أَجْرُهُمْ (lahum ajrun). Pronounce "lahum" with a full "m" sound, then pause imperceptibly and say "ajrun." Do not let the "m" blend into the "a." The result is "lahum-ajrun."

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IZHĀR SHAFAWĪ BEFORE A THROAT LETTER

Āyah: ﴿أُولَٰئِكَ لَهُمْ أَجْرٌ كَبِيرٌ﴾ [البقرة: 62]

Transliteration: Ulā'ika lahum ajrun kabīr

Translation: "Those will have a great reward."

Application: The phrase is لَهُمْ أَجْرٌ (lahum ajrun). The mīm is sākinah. The following letter is أ (hamzah), a throat letter. The mīm is pronounced clearly and fully from the lips: lahum-ajrun. The lips close for the "m," then open for the "a."

EXAMPLE 2: IZHĀR SHAFAWĪ BEFORE A LINGUAL LETTER

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا هُمْ بِضَارِّينَ بِهِ مِنْ أَحَدٍ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ﴾ [البقرة: 102]

Transliteration: ...wa-mā hum bi-ḍārrīna...

Translation: "...and they were not harming anyone through it except by permission of Allah."

Application: The phrase is هُمْ بِضَارِّينَ (hum bi-ḍārrīna). Wait, this is ikhfā' shafawī because the following letter is ب (bā'). Let us find a clear example with a lingual letter: هُمْ فِيهَا (hum fihā) – wait, fā' is also labial and will be cautioned against. A better example: [97: الأعراف: 97] هُمْ نَائِمُونَ (hum nā'imūn). The mīm is followed by a nūn. The mīm is pronounced clearly: hum-nā'imūn.

EXAMPLE 3: IZHĀR SHAFAWĪ BEFORE AN EMPHATIC LETTER

Āyah: ﴿وَهُمْ صَاغِرُونَ﴾ [النمل: 87]

Transliteration: Wa-hum sāghirūn

Translation: "...and they will be humiliated."

Application: The phrase is هُمْ صَاغِرُونَ (hum sāghirūn). The mīm is sākinah. The following letter is ص (ṣād). The mīm is pronounced clearly: hum-sāghirūn. The lips close for the "m," then open, and the tongue moves to the emphatic ṣād position.

VERSE 23

The Warning Regarding Wāw and Fā'

ARABIC TEXT

وَاحْذَرْ لَدَىٰ وَاوٍ وَفَا أَنْ تَخْتَفِيَ
لِقُرْبِهَا وَلَا تَحَادِّ فَاعْرِفْ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-ḥdhar ladā wāwin wa-fā an takhtafi

li-qurbihā wa-li-ttiḥādi fa-ʿrifi

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَاحْذَرْ	<i>wa-ḥdhar</i>	And beware
لَدَى	<i>ladā</i>	at / before
وَاوٍ	<i>wāwin</i>	a wāw
وَفَا	<i>wa-fā</i>	and a fāʾ
أَنْ	<i>an</i>	that
تُخْتَفِي	<i>takhtafi</i>	it (the mīm) becomes concealed
لِقُرْبِهَا	<i>li-qurbihā</i>	because of their proximity

وَلِاتِّحَادٍ wa-li-ttiḥādi and because of (their) union / similarity

فَاعْرِفْ fa-ʿrifi so know!

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And beware, before [the letters] و (wāw) and ف (fāʾ), lest the [mīm] become concealed! [This warning is] due to their proximity [in articulation] and due to [their] similarity. So, know [this]!"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-ḥdhar: A direct imperative from ḥadhira (to beware, to be cautious). The poet is issuing a strong warning.
2. Ladā wāwin wa-fā: Ladā is a locative adverb meaning "at" or "before." Wāwin and fā are in the genitive case as the objects of the preposition implied by ladā.
3. An takhtafi: An is a subordinating particle, and takhtafi is a subjunctive verb. The phrase means "that it becomes concealed." The subject of takhtafi is the mīm sākinah (feminine). The warning is: "Do not let the mīm be concealed before wāw and fāʾ."
4. Li-qurbihā wa-li-ttiḥādi: The lām is for causation (lām al-taʿlīl). The poet gives two reasons for the warning:
 - Qurb (Proximity): The letters wāw and fāʾ are articulated very close to the mīm. Mīm is bilabial (two lips). Wāw (as a consonant) is a bilabial glide (lips rounded). Fāʾ is labiodental

(lower lip and upper teeth). Because the articulators are so close, the tongue (or lips) might slip into concealment (ikhfā') instead of clear izhār.

- Ittiḥād (Union/Similarity): This refers to the fact that mīm and wāw share the same general area of articulation (the lips). Mīm and fā' also share a labial component. This "union" or "similarity" of makhraj creates a phonetic environment where assimilation or concealment is tempting but incorrect according to the rule of izhār.

5. Fa-ʿrifi: "So know [this]!" or "So be aware!" The imperative verb ʿarafa in the jussive mood (due to the imperative lām being implied or simply as a command) emphasizes the importance of this exception.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

The Core Warning

The rule is izhār shafawī for all letters except bā' and mīm. This includes و (wāw) and ف (fā'). The mīm must be pronounced clearly and distinctly before these two letters. The warning is necessary because the phonetic closeness can easily lead to an incorrect ikhfā' (concealment), where the mīm's ghunnah is prolonged and the lip closure is light, similar to what happens before bā'. This is a common error among students and even some experienced reciters.

Why is Ikhfā' Incorrect Before Wāw and Fā'?

The ikhfā' shafawī rule is a specific exception granted only before ب (bā') because the bā' is a stop consonant that benefits from the smooth, hummed transition. The wāw and fā' are not stop consonants in the same way; wāw is a glide, and fā' is a fricative. Concealing the mīm before them would distort the clear articulation of the mīm and is not sanctioned by the transmitted rules of recitation. The izhār preserves the distinct identity of the mīm and the following letter.

How to Achieve Clear Izhār Before Wāw and Fā'

- For م + و (mīm + wāw): After the mīm, the lips must fully open before rounding again for the wāw. There should be a clear release of the mīm. Example: ʿalayhim wa-lā (عليهم ولا). Pronounce "ʿalayhim" with a firm "m." Open the lips slightly, then round them for "wa-lā." Do not say "ʿalayhimmm-wa-lā" with a prolonged hum.
- For م + ف (mīm + fā'): After the mīm, the lower lip must move from the upper lip (for mīm) to the edge of the upper teeth (for fā') without hesitation. Example: hum fihā (هم فيها). Pronounce "hum" with a firm "m." Then immediately place the lower lip against the upper teeth for "fihā." Do not say "hummm-fihā" with a hum.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The "M-W" Transition: In English, the phrase "some way" often has a smooth, almost hummed transition from /m/ to /w/. The student must consciously break this habit for Arabic. Practice saying "hum" (with a strong /m/), pause, then say "wa." Gradually reduce the pause until it is imperceptible, but keep the /m/ crisp and distinct.
- The "M-F" Transition: This is less prone to humming but can still be sloppy. Practice "hum" (strong /m/), then "fee." Ensure the /m/ is fully released before the /f/ begins.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IZHĀR SHAFAWĪ BEFORE WĀW (و)

Āyah: ﴿صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ﴾ [الفاتحة: 7]

Transliteration: ...‘alayhim wa-lā ḍ-ḍāllīn

Translation: "...not of those who have evoked [Your] anger or of those who are astray."

Application: The phrase is وَلَا عَلَيْهِمْ (‘alayhim wa-lā). The mīm is sākinah. The following letter is و (wāw). The mīm must be pronounced with clear izhār: ‘alayhim-wa-lā. The lips close for the "m," release, and then round for the "w." There is no prolonged ghunnah.

EXAMPLE 2: IZHĀR SHAFAWĪ BEFORE FĀ' (ف)

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا هُمْ فِيهَا بِمُخْرَجِينَ﴾ [الحجر: 48]

Transliteration: Wa-mā hum fihā bi-mukhrajīn

Translation: "And they will not be removed from it."

Application: The phrase is هُمْ فِيهَا (hum fihā). The mīm is sākinah. The following letter is ف (fā'). The mīm must be pronounced clearly: hum-fihā. The lips close for the "m," then the lower lip moves to the teeth for the "f." There is no hum.

EXAMPLE 3: IZHĀR SHAFAWĪ BEFORE FĀ' WITHIN A WORD

Āyah: ﴿وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ﴾ [الإخلاص: 4] – Wait, kufuwan has a tanwīn, not mīm sākinah.

Alternative Example: The word أَمْ فِي يُلُوبِهِمْ does not contain mīm. A better example is أَمْ فِي الرِّعْدِ [16].

Transliteration: Am fī qulūbihim maraḍ

Translation: "Or is there in their hearts disease?"

Application: The phrase is أَمْ فِي (am fī). The mīm is sākinah. The following letter is ف (fā'). The mīm is pronounced clearly: am-fī.

A Critical English Edition of Tuhfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qur'ān

PART V

الْبَابُ الْخَامِسُ

The Rules of Lām al-Taʿrīf and Lām al-Fiʿl
(Verses 24–29)



Overview

After establishing the rules for nūn sākinah, tanwīn, and mīm sākinah, al-Jamzūrī turns to the rules governing the lām (ل) in two specific contexts: the lām of the definite article (lām al-taʿrīf) and the lām that is part of a verb (lām al-fiʿl). The lām al-taʿrīf is the prefixed ال (al-) that makes a noun definite. Its pronunciation depends on the letter that follows it, leading to the famous distinction between "sun letters" (al-ḥurūf al-shamsiyyah) and "moon letters" (al-ḥurūf al-qamariyyah). The lām al-fiʿl, on the other hand, is always pronounced clearly. Al-Jamzūrī dedicates six verses (24–29) to these topics.

VERSE 24

The Two States of Lām al-Taʿrīf

ARABIC TEXT

لَامٌ أَلْ حَالَانِ قَبْلَ الْأَحْرِفِ
أُولَاهُمَا إِظْهَارُهَا فَلْتَعْرِفِ

TRANSLITERATION

Li-lāmi ʿal ḥālāni qabla l-aḥrufi

ʿulāhumā ʾiẓhāruhā fa-l-taʿrifi

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
لَامٌ	<i>li-lāmi</i>	For the lām of
أَلْ	<i>ʿal</i>	ʿAl (the definite article)
حَالَانِ	<i>ḥālāni</i>	(there are) two states
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	before
الْأَحْرِفِ	<i>al-aḥrufi</i>	the letters
أُولَاهُمَا	<i>ʿulāhumā</i>	the first of them
إِظْهَارُهَا	<i>iẓhāruhā</i>	(is) its clarification
فَلْتَعْرِفِ	<i>fa-l-taʿrifi</i>	so know (it)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"For the lām of 'Al [the definite article], there are two states before the letters [of the alphabet]. The first of them is its clarification (iẓhār), so know it!"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Li-lāmi 'Al: The lām is in the genitive case (majrūr) because of the preposition li-. 'Al is the name of the definite article. The phrase literally means "For the lām of 'Al."
2. Ḥālāni qabla l-aḥrufi: Ḥālāni is the dual of ḥāl (state, condition). It is the predicate of the nominal sentence. The phrase qabla l-aḥrufi ("before the letters") specifies the context: these two states are determined by the letter that immediately follows the lām.
3. 'Ūlāhumā 'iẓhāruhā: 'Ūlā is the feminine form of 'awwal (first). The feminine dual pronoun -humā refers back to ḥālāni. The meaning is "the first of the two states is its clarification." The feminine pronoun -hā in 'iẓhāruhā refers back to al-lām (which is a feminine noun in Arabic).
4. Fa-l-ta'rifi: The fā' links the information to the command. Lām of command + jussive verb ta'rif + final kasrah to avoid two sukūns. It means "so know it!" or "so recognize this state!"

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Lām al-Ta'rīf

The lām al-ta'rīf (لام التعريف) is the lām of the definite article ال ('al-). It is always sākinah (quiescent). It is prefixed to indefinite nouns to make them definite (e.g., kitāb "a book" → al-kitāb "the book"). The hamzah that precedes it is hamzat al-waṣl (a connecting hamzah), which is pronounced only when beginning the word; in continuous recitation, it is elided, and the lām sākinah is pronounced directly after the preceding vowel.

The Two States: Iẓhār and Idghām

The lām al-ta'rīf has only two possible realizations, depending on the letter that follows it:

1. Al-Iẓhār al-Qamarī (Moon Clarification): The lām is pronounced clearly. This occurs before 14 letters known as the Moon Letters (al-ḥurūf al-qamariyyah).
2. Al-Idghām al-Shamsī (Sun Assimilation): The lām is completely assimilated into the following letter, which then receives a shaddah. This occurs before the other 14 letters, known as the Sun Letters (al-ḥurūf al-shamsiyyah).

The terms "moon" and "sun" derive from the words al-qamar (القمر) and ash-shams (الشمس). In al-qamar, the lām is pronounced (iẓhār). In ash-shams, the lām is assimilated into the shīn (idghām).

The Phonetic Rationale

- For Iẓhār Qamarī: The moon letters are articulated relatively far from the lām's articulation point (the tip of the tongue). They include throat letters, uvular sounds, and labial sounds. Because of this distance, assimilation is not phonetically natural. The lām remains clear and distinct.

- For Idghām Shamsī: The sun letters are all articulated from the tip or blade of the tongue, extremely close to the lām's articulation point. In fact, many of them share the exact same makhraj as the lām or are immediately adjacent. Assimilation in this environment is phonetically natural and facilitates smooth, connected speech. The lām is "swallowed" by the following sound.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The concept of a definite article that changes pronunciation is not foreign to English speakers (consider the pronunciation of "the" before a consonant vs. a vowel: /ðə/ vs. /ði/). However, the complete assimilation in "sun letters" is more extreme than English.
- Drill for Moon Letters: al-kitāb (الكتاب). Pronounce the lām clearly: "al-kitāb."
- Drill for Sun Letters: ash-shams (الشمس). Do not say "al-shams." Instead, say "ash-shams," holding the shīn for two counts. The lām is not heard at all.

VERSE 25

The Moon Letters (Al-Ḥurūf al-Qamariyyah)

ARABIC TEXT

قَبْلَ أَرْبَعٍ مَعَ عَشْرَةٍ خُذْ عَلَيْهِ
مِنْ إِبْغِي هَاجَكَ وَخَفِ أَقِيمَهُ

TRANSLITERATION

Qabla rba'in ma'a 'ashratin khudh 'ilmah

min 'ibghi hajjaka wa-khaf 'aqimah

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	Before
أَرْبَعٍ	<i>arba'in</i>	four
مَعَ	<i>ma'a</i>	with
عَشْرَةٍ	<i>'ashratin</i>	ten
خُذْ	<i>khudh</i>	take
عَلَيْهِ	<i>'ilmah</i>	its knowledge

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
مِنْ	<i>min</i>	from
إِبْغِ	<i>'ibghi</i>	"Seek!"
حَجَّكَ	<i>ḥajjaka</i>	"your pilgrimage!"
وَخَفْ	<i>wa-khaf</i>	"and fear!"
عَقِيمَهُ	<i>'aqīmah</i>	"its barrenness!"

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"[It occurs] before fourteen [letters]. Take its knowledge from [the initial letters of the phrase]: إِبْغِ حَجَّكَ وَخَفْ عَقِيمَهُ (Ibghi ḥajjaka wa-khaf 'aqīmah – 'Seek your pilgrimage and fear its barrenness!')."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Qabla rba'in ma'a 'ashratin: Arba'in (four) is in the genitive case because it is the object of the preposition qabla. The hamzat al-waṣl of arba' is elided in the poetic meter (rba'in). Ma'a 'ashratin means "with ten." Four with ten equals fourteen. This is the number of moon letters.
2. Khudh 'ilmah: "Take its knowledge." The imperative khudh is from 'akhadha (to take). The pronoun -h refers to the knowledge of these fourteen letters.
3. The Mnemonic 'Ibghi ḥajjaka wa-khaf 'aqīmah: This is the mnemonic phrase for the fourteen moon letters. They are the first letters of each word in this phrase:

Word First Letter Transliteration

إِبْغِ (hamzah) '

ب (bā) b

غ (ghayn) gh

حَجَّكَ (ḥā) ḥ

ج (jīm) j

كَ (kāf) k

و (wāw) w

خَفْ (khā) kh

ف (fā) f

عَقِيمَهُ (ayn) '

ق (qāf) q

ي (yā') y

م (mīm) m

ه (hā') h

The fourteen letters are: ه، ب، غ، ح، ج، ك، و، خ، ف، ع، ق، ي، م، ه. These are the moon letters (al-ḥurūf al-qamariyyah). Before any of these, the lām of the definite article is pronounced clearly (izhār).

1. Ethical Dimension: The phrase itself is a piece of moral advice: "Seek your pilgrimage (i.e., strive to perform Hajj) and fear its barrenness (i.e., fear that your Hajj might not be accepted or that you might be prevented from performing it)." It encourages the student to pursue acts of worship with sincerity and awareness of their spiritual stakes.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

List of Moon Letters and Their Articulation Points

Letter Name Makhraj Reason for Izhār

ء hamzah Deepest throat Far from lām

ب bā' Lips Far from lām

غ ghayn Upper throat/uvula Far from lām

ح ḥā' Middle throat Far from lām

ج jīm Middle tongue/palate Far from lām

ك kāf Back tongue/soft palate Far from lām

و wāw Lips Far from lām

خ khā' Upper throat/uvula Far from lām

ف fā' Lower lip/upper teeth Far from lām

ع 'ayn Middle throat Far from lām

ق qāf Back tongue/uvula Far from lām

ي yā' Middle tongue/palate Far from lām

م mīm Lips Far from lām

ه hā' Deepest throat Far from lām

Acoustic and Articulatory Process for Izhār Qamarī

1. The reciter pronounces the lām sākinah clearly from the tip of the tongue and the alveolar ridge.
2. The lām is heard as a distinct, crisp [l] sound.

3. The reciter then moves immediately to the articulation of the following moon letter.
4. There is no nasalization, no gemination, and no concealment.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

The lām of the definite article is written with a sukūn (◌ْ) when followed by a moon letter. The following letter has no shaddah. Example: الْقَمَرُ (al-qamaru).

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MOON LETTER QĀF (ق)

Āyah: ﴿الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ﴾ [الْفَاتِحَةُ: 2-4] ﴿مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ﴾

Transliteration: Al-ḥamdu li-llāhi rabbi l-'ālamīn... al-ḥamdu... al-qayyūm...

Application: The word الْقَمَرُ (al-qamaru) is the classic example. The lām is followed by ق (qāf). The lām is pronounced clearly: al-qamaru. The muṣḥaf shows a sukūn on the lām.

EXAMPLE 2: MOON LETTER ḤĀ' (ح)

Āyah: ﴿الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ﴾ [الْفَاتِحَةُ: 2]

Transliteration: Al-ḥamdu li-llāh

Application: The word is الْحَمْدُ (al-ḥamdu). The lām is followed by ح (ḥā'). The lām is pronounced clearly: al-ḥamdu.

EXAMPLE 3: MOON LETTER 'AYN (ع)

Āyah: ﴿وَالْعَصْرِ﴾ [الْعَصْرِ: 1-2] ﴿إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِفِي خُسْرٍ﴾

Transliteration: Wa-l-'aṣr...

Application: The word is الْعَصْرِ (al-'aṣri). The lām is followed by ع ('ayn). The lām is pronounced clearly: al-'aṣri.

VERSES 26–27

The Sun Letters (Al-Ḥurūf al-Shamsiyyah)

ARABIC TEXT

ثَانِيهَا إِدْغَامًا فِي أَرْبَعِ

وَعَشْرَةٌ أَيْضًا وَرَمَزَهَا فَع

TRANSLITERATION

Thānīhumā 'idghāmuhā fī arba'ī

wa-'ashratin 'ayḍan wa-ramzahā fa-'ī

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
ثَانِيَهُمَا	thānīhumā	The second of them
إِدْغَامُهَا	'idghāmuhā	(is) its assimilation
فِي	fī	into
أَرْبَعَ	arba'ī	four
وَعَشْرَةٌ	wa-'ashratin	and ten
أَيْضًا	'ayḍan	also
وَرَمَزَهَا	wa-ramzahā	and its symbol / mnemonic
فَع	fa-'ī	so understand / know

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The second of them [the two states] is its assimilation (idghām) into [the] fourteen [letters] also. And know its mnemonic!"

ARABIC TEXT

طَبُّ ثُمَّ صَلِّ رَحِمًا تَفُزْ ضِفْ ذَا نَعَمْ
دَعِ سَوْءَ ظَنِّ زُرْ شَرِيفًا لِلْكَرَمِ

TRANSLITERATION

Ṭib thumma ṣil raḥīman tafuz ḍif dhā ni'am

da' sū'a ṣannin zur sharīfan li-l-karam

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
طِبْ	<i>ṭib</i>	Be good! / Be pleasant!
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	then
صِلْ	<i>ṣil</i>	maintain / connect!
رَحِمًا	<i>raḥīman</i>	(the) ties of kinship
تَفُزْ	<i>tafuz</i>	you will succeed
ضِفْ	<i>ḍif</i>	host / be a guest of
ذَا	<i>dhā</i>	(the) possessor of
نِعَمَ	<i>ni'am</i>	blessings
دَعْ	<i>da'</i>	leave / abandon
سُوءَ	<i>sū'a</i>	(the) evil of
ظَنٍّ	<i>ẓannin</i>	suspicion
زُرْ	<i>zur</i>	visit
شَرِيفًا	<i>sharīfan</i>	(a) noble (person)
لِلْكَرَمِ	<i>li-l-karam</i>	for the sake of generosity

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Ṭib thumma ṣil raḥīman tafuz ḍif dhā ni'am (Be pleasant, then maintain the ties of kinship; you will succeed. Be a guest of the possessor of blessings.) Da' sū'a ẓannin zur sharīfan li-l-karam (Abandon evil suspicion; visit a noble person for the sake of generosity.)"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Thānīhumā 'idghāmuḥā: The second state of the lām al-ta'rīf is idghām (assimilation).
2. Fī arba'i wa-'ashratin 'ayḍan: "Into fourteen [letters] also." Just as there are fourteen moon letters, there are exactly fourteen sun letters. The remaining fourteen letters of the alphabet (since 28 total letters minus 14 moon letters = 14 sun letters).

3. Wa-ramzahā fa-‘i: Ramz means "symbol" or "code." Fa-‘i is an imperative from wa‘ā (to understand, to be aware). The poet says, "And its mnemonic – so understand it!" This introduces the second mnemonic verse.

4. The Mnemonic Verse for Sun Letters: The first letter of each word in this verse is one of the fourteen sun letters. Let us extract them:

Word First Letter Transliteration

طَبِّطْ (ṭā’) ṭ

ثُمَّ (thā’) th

صِلْ (ṣād) ṣ

رَحْمًا ر (rā’) r

تَفَرَّتْ (tā’) t

دُفِّضْ (ḍād) ḍ

ذَا ذ (dhāl) dh

نَعِمْ (nūn) n

دَعْ (dāl) d

سُوءَ س (sīn) s

ظَنَّ ظ (ẓā’) ẓ

زُرْ ز (zāy) z

شَرِيفًا ش (shīn) sh

لِلْكَرَمِ ل (lām) l

The fourteen sun letters are: ط، ث، ص، ر، ت، ض، ذ، ن، د، س، ظ، ز، ش، ل. Before any of these, the lām of the definite article is completely assimilated (idghām) into the following letter.

Ethical Dimension of the Mnemonic: This verse is rich in moral exhortation:

- Ṭib: Be good-natured, pleasant.
- Ṣil raḥīman: Maintain family ties (a major Islamic virtue).
- Tafuz: You will attain success (in this life and the next).
- Ḍif dhā ni‘am: Be a guest of the generous, or be generous to those who have blessings.
- Da‘ sū’a ẓannin: Abandon suspicion (a major sin in Islam).
- Zur sharīfan li-l-karam: Visit the noble and generous, or visit others for the sake of generosity.

This intertwines the technical rules of Tajweed with the cultivation of virtuous character (adab).

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

List of Sun Letters and Their Articulation Points

All sun letters are articulated from the tip or blade of the tongue, close to the lām's articulation point.

Letter Name Makhraj Proximity to Lām

ط ṭā' Tip of tongue & upper gums (emphatic) Very close

ث thā' Tip of tongue & upper teeth Close

ص ṣād Tip of tongue & upper gums (emphatic) Very close

ر rā' Tip of tongue & upper gums Adjacent to lām

ت tā' Tip of tongue & upper gums Adjacent to lām

ض ḍād Side of tongue & upper molars (emphatic) Close

ذ dhāl Tip of tongue & upper teeth Close

ن nūn Tip of tongue & upper gums Adjacent to lām

د dāl Tip of tongue & upper gums Adjacent to lām

س sīn Tip of tongue & lower teeth Close

ظ zā' Tip of tongue & upper teeth (emphatic) Close

ز zāy Tip of tongue & lower teeth Close

ش shīn Middle of tongue & palate Proximate

ل lām Tip of tongue & upper gums Identical

Acoustic and Articulatory Process for Idghām Shamsī

1. The reciter encounters the definite article al- followed by a sun letter (e.g., ash-shams).
2. The lām is not pronounced. The tongue does not go to the lām position.
3. Instead, the reciter moves directly to the articulation point of the sun letter.
4. The sun letter is pronounced as a geminate (doubled) consonant, with a shaddah (ّ). This gemination represents the assimilated lām + the original sun letter.
5. Important Exception: When the sun letter is ل (lām) itself, the assimilation is of two lāms. The resulting geminated lām is pronounced with a clear, prolonged lām sound, without ghunnah (since lām is not a nasal letter). Example: al-layl (الليل) → al-layl (with a geminated lām). Note that the ghunnah rules for nūn and mīm do not apply to the lām.

Comparison with Idghām for Nūn Sākinah

- The idghām of lām al-ta'rīf is always complete (idghām kāmil) and always without ghunnah (except when the sun letter is nūn or mīm, but the ghunnah then belongs to the nūn or mīm, not to the assimilated lām).

- The idghām of nūn sākinah is divided into bi-ghunnah and bi-lā ghunnah, as previously studied.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

The lām of the definite article is written without a sukūn, and the following sun letter is written with a shaddah (ّ). Example: الشمس (ash-shamsu). The shaddah is the explicit marker of the assimilation.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Sun Letters: The student must memorize the fourteen sun letters. The mnemonic verse is invaluable for this. Recite the verse repeatedly, focusing on the first letter of each word.
- Pronunciation Drill: Practice ash-shams (الشمس). Do not say "al-shams." Say "ash-shams," holding the "sh" for two counts. For an-nās (الناس), do not say "al-nās." Say "an-nās," holding the "n" for two counts with a nasal hum (because nūn is a nasal letter).

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: SUN LETTER SHĪN (ش)

Āyah: ﴿[الشمس: ١] وَالشَّمْسُ وَضَحَّاهَا﴾

Transliteration: Wa-sh-shamsi wa-ḍuḥāhā

Translation: "By the sun and its brightness."

Application: The word is الشمس (ash-shamsi). The lām is followed by ش (shīn), a sun letter. The lām is completely assimilated, and the shīn is geminated: ash-shamsi. The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the shīn.

EXAMPLE 2: SUN LETTER NŪN (ن)

Āyah: ﴿[الناس: ١] قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ النَّاسِ﴾

Transliteration: Qul a'ūdhu bi-rabbi n-nās

Translation: "Say, 'I seek refuge in the Lord of mankind.'"

Application: The word is الناس (an-nāsi). The lām is followed by ن (nūn), a sun letter. The lām is assimilated, and the nūn is geminated. Because nūn is a nasal letter, the geminated nūn is pronounced with a two-count ghunnah: an-nāsi.

EXAMPLE 3: SUN LETTER LĀM (ل)

Āyah: ﴿[الليل: ١] وَاللَّيْلُ إِذَا يَغْشَى﴾

Transliteration: Wa-l-layli 'idhā yaghshā

Translation: "By the night when it covers."

Application: The word is اللَّيْلِ (al-layli). The lām of the article is followed by the lām of the word layl. The two lāms are assimilated into a single geminated lām. The pronunciation is a clear, prolonged [l:] sound without any ghunnah: al-layli.

VERSE 28

Naming the Two Types of Lām

ARABIC TEXT

وَاللَّامَ الْأُولَى سَمَّيْنَاهَا قَمَرِيَّةً
وَاللَّامَ الْآخَرَى سَمَّيْنَاهَا شَمْسِيَّةً

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-lāma l-'ūlā sammihā qamariyyah

wa-l-lāma l-'ukhrā sammihā shamsiyyah

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَاللَّامَ	<i>wa-l-lāma</i>	And the lām
الْأُولَى	<i>al-'ūlā</i>	the first
سَمَّيْنَاهَا	<i>sammihā</i>	call it
قَمَرِيَّةً	<i>qamariyyah</i>	Moon (letter)
وَاللَّامَ	<i>wa-l-lāma</i>	and the lām
الْآخَرَى	<i>al-'ukhrā</i>	the other
سَمَّيْنَاهَا	<i>sammihā</i>	call it
شَمْسِيَّةً	<i>shamsiyyah</i>	Sun (letter)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And the first lām – call it a Moon Letter (qamariyyah). And the other lām – call it a Sun Letter (shamsiyyah)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-lāma l-ʿūlā: The definite article al- is attached to lām, making it al-lām. The lām of the article assimilates into the lām of the word, resulting in a geminated lām: wal-lāma. Al-ʿūlā is the feminine form of al-ʿawwal (the first), referring back to the first state (iẓhār) mentioned in verse 24.
2. Sammihā qamariyyah: Sammi is an imperative verb ("call," "name"). The attached pronoun -hā refers to al-lām al-ʿūlā. Qamariyyah is a feminine adjective derived from qamar (moon). It means "moon-like" or "lunar." The lām that is clarified (iẓhār) is called Lām Qamariyyah (Moon Lām).
3. Wa-l-lāma l-ʿukhrā sammihā shamsiyyah: The same structure is repeated for the second lām. Al-ʿukhrā means "the other one." It is called Shamsiyyah (Sun Lām), from shams (sun).

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

The Origin of the Terms "Moon" and "Sun"

These terms are derived directly from the words الْقَمَر (al-qamar) and الشَّمْس (ash-shams). In al-qamar, the lām is followed by a ق (qāf), a moon letter, and is pronounced clearly. In ash-shams, the lām is followed by a ش (shīn), a sun letter, and is assimilated. The two celestial bodies serve as archetypal examples for the two rules. This naming convention is universally used in Tajweed pedagogy.

Significance of the Terminology

The terminology is not merely descriptive; it is prescriptive. When a student memorizes that a certain letter is a "moon letter," they immediately know that the lām before it must be pronounced clearly (iẓhār). When they hear "sun letter," they know the lām must be assimilated (idghām). This binary classification simplifies the application of the rule.

Mnemonic Recap

- Moon Letters (I4): ه، م، ي، ق، ع، ف، خ، ك، و (from 'Ibghi ḥajjaka...)
- Sun Letters (I4): ط، ث، ص، ر، ت، ض، ذ، ن، د، س، ظ، ز، ش، ل (from Ṭib thumma sil...)

VERSE 29

The Rule of Lām al-Fi‘l (The Lām of the Verb)

ARABIC TEXT

وَأَظْهَرَ نَّ لَامَ فِعْلِ مُطْلَقًا

فِي نَحْوِ قُلْ نَعَمْ وَقُلْنَا وَالتَّقَى

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-'aẓhiranna lāma fi'lin muṭlaqan

fi naḥwi qul na'am wa-qulnā wa-ltaqā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَأُظْهِرَنَّ	<i>wa-'aẓhiranna</i>	And you must clarify
لَا مَ	<i>lāma</i>	the lām of
فِعْلٍ	<i>fi'lin</i>	a verb
مُطْلَقًا	<i>muṭlaqan</i>	absolutely / in all cases
فِي	<i>fi</i>	in
نَحْوِ	<i>naḥwi</i>	(the) manner of / like
قُلْ	<i>qul</i>	"Say!"
نَعَمْ	<i>na'am</i>	"Yes"
وَقُلْنَا	<i>wa-qulnā</i>	and "We said"
وَالْتَقَى	<i>wa-ltaqā</i>	and "He met"

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And you must always clarify the lām of a verb – absolutely! As in [the examples]: قُلْ (qul – 'Say!'), نَعَمْ (na'am – 'Yes'), وَقُلْنَا (qulnā – 'We said'), and وَالتَّقَى (iltaqā – 'He met')."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-'aẓhiranna: This is a strong imperative. The verb 'aẓhir is from 'aẓhara (to make clear). It is reinforced with the energetic nūn of emphasis (nūn al-tawkīd): 'aẓhiranna. This conveys an emphatic command: "You must clarify!" or "Be absolutely sure to clarify!"
2. Lāma fi'lin muṭlaqan: Lāma is the accusative object of 'aẓhiranna. Fi'lin is in the genitive case, part of the construct phrase lāmu fi'lin ("the lām of a verb"). Muṭlaqan is an adverb meaning "absolutely," "categorically," or "without exception." It emphasizes that this rule applies in all circumstances, without any of the exceptions that apply to the lām al-ta'rīf.

3. Fī naḥwi...: Naḥw means "manner," "direction," or "like." The phrase fī naḥwi means "in the manner of" or simply "like." The poet provides four concrete examples:

- قُلْ (qul): Imperative verb from qāla (to say). The lām is sākinah (quiescent) because the verb is in the imperative mood, which is built on sukūn. The lām is part of the root (q-w-l).
- نَعَمْ (na'am): This is a particle meaning "yes." While not a verb, it is included because it contains a lām sākinah that follows the same rule of izhār and serves as a useful example. Some grammarians consider it a verbal noun.
- قُلْنَا (qulnā): Perfect verb, first-person plural ("we said"). The lām is sākinah because it is followed by the pronoun nā. The lām is part of the verb root.
- التَّقَى (iltaqā): Perfect verb, Form VIII, from laqiya (to meet). The lām is the first radical of the root (l-q-y) and is sākinah because it is followed by the tā' of Form VIII.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Lām al-Fi'l

The lām al-fi'l is any lām that is an original or augmented part of a verb's root or pattern. This includes the lām in verbs like qāla (قال), ja'ala (جعل), fa'ala (فعل), and their various conjugations (qul, qulnā, yaqul, iltaqā, etc.). It is distinct from the lām of the definite article, the lām of preposition, and the lām of emphasis.

The Ruling: Obligatory Izhār in All Cases

Unlike the lām al-ta'rīf, which sometimes undergoes idghām (before sun letters), the lām al-fi'l never assimilates. It is always pronounced clearly (izhār) regardless of the letter that follows it. The word muṭlaqan ("absolutely") in the verse underscores this universality.

The Phonetic and Morphological Rationale

- Morphological Clarity: The lām is often a radical letter (part of the root) in the verb. Assimilating it would obscure the verb's root and potentially confuse it with other words. For example, if the lām in qul (قُلْ) were assimilated into a following rā' (as in qul rabbi – قُلْ رَبِّ), and pronounced qur-rabbi, the imperative form of the verb would be distorted. Maintaining izhār preserves the morphological integrity of the verb.
- Linguistic Precedent: In classical Arabic grammar and recitation, idghām of the lām al-fi'l is extremely rare and generally not permitted in the canonical readings. The default is izhār.

Comparison with Lām al-Ta'rīf

Feature Lām al-Ta'rīf Lām al-Fi'l

Function Definite article Part of verb root

States Two (izhār qamarī, idghām shamsī) One (izhār muṭlaq)

Assimilates? Yes, before 14 sun letters Never

Examples al-qamar, ash-shams qul, qulnā, iltaqā

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The Rule is Simple: This is a straightforward rule for English speakers. Whenever you see a lām that is part of a verb (especially in qul, ja'alnā, etc.), just pronounce it as a clear [l] sound. Do not worry about the following letter.
- Drill: Practice قُلْ رَبِّ (qul rabbi). Do not say qur-rabbi. Pronounce the lām clearly: qul (with a crisp [l]), then rabbi. For قُلْنَا (qulnā), pronounce the lām clearly before the nūn: qul-nā.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS**EXAMPLE 1: LĀM AL-FI'L BEFORE A SUN LETTER (POTENTIAL ASSIMILATION CONTEXT)**

Āyah: ﴿قُلْ رَبِّ إِمَّا تُبَيِّنْهُ لِي مَا يُوعَدُونَ﴾ [المؤمنون: 93]

Transliteration: Qul rabbi...

Translation: "Say, 'My Lord, if You should show me that which they are promised...'"

Application: The word is قُلْ (qul). The lām is sākinah. The following word begins with ر (rā'), which is a sun letter for the definite article. If this were lām al-ta'rīf, it would assimilate.

However, because it is lām al-fi'l, it is pronounced clearly: qul rabbi. There is no gemination of the rā' caused by the lām.

EXAMPLE 2: LĀM AL-FI'L WITHIN A WORD

Āyah: ﴿وَقُلْنَا يَا آدَمُ اسْكُنْ أَنْتَ وَزَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةَ﴾ [البقرة: 35]

Transliteration: Wa-qulnā yā 'adamu...

Translation: "And We said, 'O Adam, dwell, you and your wife, in Paradise...'"

Application: The word is قُلْنَا (qulnā). The lām is sākinah and is followed by the nūn of the plural pronoun. The lām is pronounced clearly: qul-nā.

EXAMPLE 3: LĀM AL-FI'L IN FORM VIII VERB

Āyah: ﴿التَّقَىٰ الْجَمْعَانِ﴾ [الشعراء: 61]

Transliteration: Iltaqā l-jam'ān

Translation: "The two hosts met."

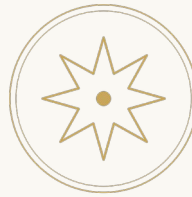
Application: The word is التَّقَى (iltaqā). The lām is sākinah (the first radical) and is followed by the tā' of Form VIII. The lām is pronounced clearly: il-taqā. There is no assimilation of the lām into the tā'.

A Critical English Edition of Tuhfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qurʾān

PART VI

الْبَابُ السَّادِسُ

The Rules of Al-Mithlayn, Al-Mutajānisayn, and
Al-Mutaqāribayn (Verses 30–34)





Overview

The next section of the *Tuḥfah* addresses a more advanced and foundational topic in Tajweed: the classification of letter combinations based on their articulatory and acoustic properties. Understanding these categories—Al-Mithlayn (The Two Identicals), Al-Mutajānisayn (The Two Similar in Genus), and Al-Mutaqāribayn (The Two Proximate)—is essential for grasping the underlying phonetic logic of rules like *idghām* and *izhār*. Al-Jamzūrī dedicates five verses (30–34) to defining these categories and linking them to the previously learned rules.

VERSE 30

Al-Mithlayn – The Two Identicals

ARABIC TEXT

إِنْ فِي الصِّفَاتِ وَالْمَخَارِجِ اتَّفَقَ
حَرْفَانِ فَالْمِثْلَانِ فِيهِمَا أَحَقُّ

TRANSLITERATION

In fi ṣ-ṣifāti wa-l-makhārījī ttafaq

ḥarfāni fa-l-mithlāni fihimā aḥaqq

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
إِنْ	<i>in</i>	If
فِي	<i>fi</i>	in
الصِّفَاتِ	<i>aṣ-ṣifāti</i>	the attributes
وَالْمَخَارِجِ	<i>wa-l-makhārījī</i>	and the points of articulation
اتَّفَقَ	<i>ttafaq</i>	(they) agree / are identical
حَرْفَانِ	<i>ḥarfāni</i>	two letters
فَالْمِثْلَانِ	<i>fa-l-mithlāni</i>	then "Al-Mithlān" (The Two Identicals)
فِيهِمَا	<i>fihimā</i>	for them

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَحَقُّ	<i>aḥaqq</i>	(is) more appropriate / most deserving

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"If two letters agree in [both] the attributes (aṣ-ṣifāt) and the points of articulation (al-makhārīj), then the term Al-Mithlān (The Two Identicals) is most deserving for them."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. In fi ṣ-ṣifāti wa-l-makhārījī ttafaq: The conditional particle in introduces the definition. Ttafaqa is a perfect verb in the jussive mood (majzūm) because of the conditional, but it appears in the perfect form (ttafaq with a fathah on the qāf for the sake of the meter/rhyme). The verb means "they agree" or "they are identical." The subject is the dual ḥarfāni (two letters), which comes later. The prepositional phrases fi ṣ-ṣifāt and wa-l-makhārīj specify the domains of agreement: the attributes (inherent phonetic qualities like jahr, hams, shiddah, rakhāwah, etc.) and the points of articulation (the precise place in the vocal tract where the sound is produced).
2. Ḥarfāni: This is the subject of ttafaq, in the nominative case (marfūʿ) with the dual marker -āni. It means "two letters."
3. Fa-l-mithlāni fihimā aḥaqq: This is the response (jawāb) to the condition. Al-mithlāni is a dual noun meaning "the two identicals" or "the two likes." It is the subject of the nominal sentence. Fihimā means "for them" or "concerning them [the two letters]." Aḥaqq is the predicate, meaning "more appropriate," "more deserving," or "most fitting." The phrase means: "Then the designation 'Al-Mithlān' is most appropriate for them."

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Mithlān (المِثْلَانِ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Mithl (مثل) means "like," "similar," or "identical." The dual form mithlān means "two identical things."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: Two letters that are identical in both their point of articulation (makhraj) and their inherent attributes (ṣifāt).

Examples of Al-Mithlān

Since the Arabic alphabet consists of distinct letters, the only way two letters can be identical in both makhraj and ṣifāt is if they are the same letter. Examples include:

- ب (bāʾ) followed by ب (bāʾ)
- ت (tāʾ) followed by ت (tāʾ)
- م (mīm) followed by م (mīm)
- ن (nūn) followed by ن (nūn)
- ل (lām) followed by ل (lām)

— ر (rā') followed by ر (rā')

The Ruling for Al-Mithlān

When two identical letters meet, the ruling depends on whether they are in the same word or in two separate words, and whether the first is sākin or mutaḥarrik.

- Case 1: The first letter is sākin, the second is mutaḥarrik (This is the most common case for Tajweed rules).
- Ruling: Obligatory Idghām (Assimilation). This is called Idghām Mithlayn Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation of Identicals).
- Example: qad dakhala (قَدْ دَخَلَ) → qaddakhala (قَدَّخَلَ). The two dāls merge into a single geminated dāl.
- Special Case for Mīm and Nūn: If the identical letters are م (mīm) or ن (nūn), the idghām is accompanied by a two-count ghunnah (as per verse 17). Example: min nāṣirin (مِنْ نَاصِرٍ) → minnāṣirin.
- Special Case for other letters: The idghām is complete and without ghunnah. Example: qad dakhala → qaddakhala.
- Case 2: Both letters are mutaḥarrik (voweled).
- Ruling: Prohibited Idghām in the reading of Ḥaḍḥ. The two letters must be pronounced clearly (izhār).
- Example: 'alima (عَلِمَا) – the mīm and the following mīm? Actually, 'alima does not have two identical letters in sequence. A better example is shahru ramaḍāna (شَهْرُ رَمَضَانَ). The rā' in shahru is voweled (ḍammah), and the rā' in ramaḍāna is voweled (fathah). Ḥaḍḥ pronounces both clearly: shahru ramaḍāna. Other readers, like al-Sūsī, may apply idghām kabīr here: shahur-ramaḍāna.

The Phonetic Rationale

When two identical consonants meet, with the first being quiescent, the articulators are already in the perfect position for the second consonant. Re-articulating the consonant from scratch would require a momentary release and re-closure, which is phonetically inefficient and disrupts the flow of speech. Assimilation (idghām) is the natural, effortless solution: the closure is simply held for a longer duration, resulting in a geminated consonant. This is a universal phonetic tendency across languages.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

When idghām mithlayn ṣaghīr occurs, the first letter is written without a sukūn, and the second letter is written with a shaddah (ّ). Example: qad dakhala is written قَدْ دَخَّلَ.

Comparative Analysis with Ibn al-Jazārī

Ibn al-Jazārī's Muqaddimah states:

إِنَّ فِي الصِّفَاتِ وَالْمَخَارِجِ اتَّفَقَ ... حَرَفَانِ فَلِثَلَاثٍ فِيهِمَا أَحَقُّ

"If two letters agree in attributes and articulation points, then 'Al-Mithlān' is most deserving for them."

Al-Jamzūrī's verse is identical. Both poets then proceed to define the other categories. The tripartite classification (mithlayn, mutajānisayn, mutaḳāribayn) is standard in advanced Tajweed texts and forms the theoretical basis for understanding all assimilation phenomena.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: IDGHĀM MITHLAYN WITH DĀL (د)

Āyah: ﴿قَدْ دَخَلُوا بِالْكَفْرِ وَهُمْ قَدْ خَرَجُوا بِهِ﴾ [المائدة: 61]

Transliteration: Qaḍ dakhalū bi-l-kufri...

Translation: "They had indeed entered with disbelief, and they had gone out with it."

Application: The phrase is قَدْ دَخَلُوا (qaḍ dakhalū). The first dāl is sākinah. The second dāl is voweled with a faṭḥah. They are identical (mithlān). The dāl sākinah is completely assimilated into the second dāl, which becomes geminated: qaddakhalū. The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the second dāl: قد دخلوا.

EXAMPLE 2: IDGHĀM MITHLAYN WITH MĪM (م) AND GHUNNAH

Āyah: ﴿وَلَهُمْ مَا يَشْتَهُونَ﴾ [الأنبياء: 102]

Transliteration: Wa-lahum mā yashtahūn

Translation: "And they will have whatever they desire."

Application: The phrase is لَهُمْ مَا (lahum mā). The first mīm is sākinah. The second mīm is voweled with a faṭḥah. They are identical (mithlān). The mīm sākinah is assimilated into the second mīm. Because mīm is a nasal letter, the assimilation is accompanied by a two-count ghunnah: lahum mā. This is also an example of the rule for mīm sākinah (verse 21). The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the second mīm: لهم ما.

EXAMPLE 3: IDGHĀM MITHLAYN WITH NŪN (ن) AND GHUNNAH

Āyah: ﴿مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ فَمِنَ اللَّهِ﴾ [النحل: 53]

Transliteration: Min ni'matin fa-mina llāh

Translation: "Whatever blessing you have, it is from Allah."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ (min ni'matin). The first nūn is sākinah. The second nūn is voweled with a kasrah. They are identical (mithlān). The nūn sākinah is assimilated with a two-count ghunnah: minni'matin. This is also an example of idghām bi-ghunnah for the nūn

sākinah (verse 10). The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the second nūn: مِنْ نَعْمَةٍ.

VERSE 31

Al-Mutaqāribayn – The Two Proximate

ARABIC TEXT

وَأِنْ يَكُونَا مَخْرَجًا تَقَارِبًا
وَفِي الصِّفَاتِ اخْتِلَافًا يُلَقَّبَا

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-in yakūnā makhrajan taqārabā

wa-fi ṣ-ṣifāti khtalafā yulaqqabā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَأِنْ	<i>wa-in</i>	And if
يَكُونَا	<i>yakūnā</i>	they are
مَخْرَجًا	<i>makhrajan</i>	in point of articulation
تَقَارِبًا	<i>taqārabā</i>	(they are) proximate
وَفِي	<i>wa-fi</i>	and in
الصِّفَاتِ	<i>aṣ-ṣifāti</i>	the attributes
اِخْتِلَافًا	<i>khtalafā</i>	they differ
يُلَقَّبَا	<i>yulaqqabā</i>	they are called

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And if they are proximate in [their] point of articulation, but differ in [their] attributes, they are called [by a specific term, to be given in the next verse]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-in yakūnā makhrajan taqārabā: This is a conditional clause similar to the previous verse. Yakūnā is the dual jussive verb from kāna. Makhrajan is an accusative of specification (tamyīz) or a circumstantial qualifier (hāl), meaning "with respect to the point of articulation." Taqārabā is a perfect verb meaning "they are proximate" or "they are close to each other."
2. Wa-fi ṣ-ṣifāti khtalafā: Khtalafā is a perfect verb meaning "they differ." The condition is that the two letters must be close in makhraj but different in ṣifāt.
3. Yulaqqabā: This is a passive verb in the jussive or indicative mood, meaning "they are called" or "they are nicknamed." The actual name is withheld until the next verse, creating a sense of anticipation. The alif at the end is the alif al-iṭlāq for the rhyme.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Mutaqāribayn (الْمُتَقَارِبَانِ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Taqāriba means "to be near one another" or "to be close." Mutaqārib is the active participle, and the dual is mutaqāribayn, meaning "two proximate things."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: Two letters that are proximate (close) in their point of articulation (makhraj) but differ in their inherent attributes (ṣifāt).

Examples of Al-Mutaqāribayn

This category includes several important letter pairs that are frequently encountered in the Qur'ān:

First Letter Second Letter Why Mutaqāribayn?

ن (nūn) ل (lām) Both from tip of tongue. Nūn is nasal, lām is oral.

ن (nūn) ر (rā') Both from tip of tongue. Nūn is nasal, rā' is trilled.

ل (lām) ر (rā') Both from tip of tongue. Lām is lateral, rā' is trilled.

ق (qāf) ك (kāf) Both from back of tongue. Qāf is uvular/emphatic, kāf is velar/light.

The Ruling for Al-Mutaqāribayn

The ruling depends on the specific pair of letters and the qirā'ah. In the reading of Ḥaṣṣ 'an 'Āṣim:

- ن + ل (nūn sākinah + lām): Obligatory Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah (Complete assimilation without nasalization). This was covered in verse 12 (idghām in lām). Example: min ladunhu → milladunhu.
- ن + ر (nūn sākinah + rā'): Obligatory Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah. This was also covered in verse 12 (idghām in rā'). Example: min rabbiḥim → mirrabbiḥim.
- ل + ر (lām sākinah + rā'): Permissible Idghām in some readings, but Ḥaṣṣ reads with Iẓhār (clear pronunciation). Example: qul rabbi (قُلْ رَبِّ) – Ḥaṣṣ pronounces the lām clearly. This is an important point, as it distinguishes Ḥaṣṣ from other readings (like al-Sūsī, who would read qur-rabbi).
- ق + ك (qāf sākinah + kāf): Permissible Idghām in some readings, but Ḥaṣṣ reads with Iẓhār. Example: nakhluqkum (نَخْلُقْكُمْ) – Ḥaṣṣ pronounces the qāf clearly.

The Phonetic Rationale

Proximate letters share a similar articulatory posture. The transition from one to the other is smoother than between distant letters, making assimilation (idghām) phonetically tempting and often natural. The specific rules reflect the degree of proximity and the acoustic compatibility of the sounds. For nūn + lām/rāʾ, the proximity is so close that full assimilation is mandatory. For lām + rāʾ, the proximity is slightly less, and Ḥaḥṣ opts for clarity (iẓhār) to preserve the distinct identity of the lām.

Comparative Analysis

This category explains why certain letters cause idghām for nūn sākinah while others do not. The letters of idghām bi-lā ghunnah (ل and ر) are precisely those that are mutaḳārib with the nūn. The letters of idghām bi-ghunnah (ن، م، و، ي) include mithlayn (ن) and mutajānisayn (م) and mutaḳāribayn (و، ي). Understanding this classification provides the theoretical foundation for the practical rules already memorized.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MUTAQĀRIBAYN: NŪN SĀKINAH + LĀM (ل + ن)

Āyah: ﴿فَوَجَدَا عَبْدًا مِنْ عِبَادِنَا آتَيْنَاهُ رَحْمَةً مِنْ عِنْدِنَا وَعَلَّمْنَاهُ مِنْ لَدُنَّا عِلْمًا﴾ [الكهف: 65]

Transliteration: ...wa-‘allamnāhu min ladunnā ‘ilman

Translation: "...and We taught him from Us [certain] knowledge."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ لَدُنَّا (min ladunnā). The nūn is sākinah, and the following letter is ل (lām). They are proximate (mutaqāribayn). In Ḥaḥṣ, this triggers idghām bi-lā ghunnah: milladunnā.

EXAMPLE 2: MUTAQĀRIBAYN: NŪN SĀKINAH + RĀʾ (ر + ن)

Āyah: ﴿أُولَئِكَ عَلَىٰ هُدًى مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 5]

Transliteration: Ulāʾika ‘alā hudan min rabbihim...

Translation: "Those are upon [right] guidance from their Lord, and it is those who are the successful."

Application: The phrase is مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ (min rabbihim). The nūn is sākinah, and the following letter is ر (rāʾ). They are proximate (mutaqāribayn). In Ḥaḥṣ, this triggers idghām bi-lā ghunnah: mirrabbihim.

EXAMPLE 3: MUTAQĀRIBAYN WITH IẒHĀR IN ḤAḤṢ: LĀM SĀKINAH + RĀʾ (ر + ل)

Āyah: ﴿وَقُلْ رَبِّ أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ هَمَزَاتِ الشَّيَاطِينِ﴾ [المؤمنون: 97]

Transliteration: Qul rabbi a'ūdhu bika...

Translation: "And say, 'My Lord, I seek refuge in You from the incitements of the devils.'"

Application: The phrase is قُلْ رَبِّ (qul rabbi). The lām of the verb qul is sākinah. The following word begins with ر (rā'). These two letters are proximate (mutaqāribayn). Although some readings (qirā'āt) assimilate the lām into the rā' (qur-rabbi), the reading of Ḥafṣ is to pronounce the lām clearly (izhār): qul rabbi. This is a crucial point of practice for Ḥafṣ students.

VERSE 32

Al-Mutajānisayn – The Two Similar in Genus

ARABIC TEXT

مُتَقَارِبَيْنِ أَوْ يَكُونَا اتَّفَقَا
فِي مَخْرَجٍ دُونَ الصِّفَاتِ حَقَّقَا

TRANSLITERATION

Mutaqāribayni 'aw yakūnā ttafaqā

fī makhrajīn dūna ṣ-ṣifāti ḥuqqiqā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
مُتَقَارِبَيْنِ	<i>mutaqāribayni</i>	(They are called) "Al-Mutaqāribayn"
أَوْ	<i>'aw</i>	or
يَكُونَا	<i>yakūnā</i>	they are
اتَّفَقَا	<i>ttafaqā</i>	in agreement / identical
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
مَخْرَجٍ	<i>makhrajīn</i>	point of articulation
دُونَ	<i>dūna</i>	without / apart from
الصِّفَاتِ	<i>aṣ-ṣifāti</i>	the attributes

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
حَقَّقَا	<i>ḥuqqiqā</i>	(they are) verified / established as

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"[The previous verse defined them as] Al-Mutaqāribayn. Or, if they agree in [their] point of articulation but [differ] apart from the attributes [i.e., differ in attributes], they are established as [a separate category, namely] Al-Mutajānisayn."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Mutaqāribayni: This word is in the accusative case (maṣṣūb) as the predicate of an implied verb, meaning "[They are called] Al-Mutaqāribayn." It completes the definition from the previous verse.
2. 'Aw yakūnā ttafaqā fi makhrajīn: The particle 'aw introduces the alternative category. Yakūnā is the dual jussive verb. Ttafaqā is a perfect verb meaning "they agree" or "they are identical." The domain of agreement is specified by fi makhrajīn ("in the point of articulation").
3. Dūna ṣ-ṣifāti: Dūna is a locative adverb meaning "without," "apart from," or "excluding." It indicates that the agreement in makhraj is accompanied by a disagreement in ṣifāt. They share the same articulation point but have different inherent attributes.
4. Ḥuqqiqā: This is a passive verb in the perfect tense, meaning "they have been verified," "they are established," or "they are confirmed." The implied meaning is: "They are established as Al-Mutajānisayn (The Two Similar in Genus)." The name itself is not mentioned in this verse but is understood from the context and from the standard terminology of the science.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Mutajānisayn (الْمُتَجَانِسَانِ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Tajānasa means "to be of the same kind or genus." Mutajānis is the active participle, and the dual is mutajānisayn, meaning "two things of the same kind."
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: Two letters that agree in their point of articulation (makhraj) but differ in their inherent attributes (ṣifāt).

Examples of Al-Mutajānisayn

This category includes letters that emerge from the exact same spot in the vocal tract but have different qualities (e.g., one is voiced, the other is voiceless; one is emphatic, the other is light).

First Letter Second Letter Shared Makhraj Differing Ṣifāt

ط (ṭā') ت (tā') Tip of tongue & upper gums Ṭā' is emphatic, voiced, plosive; Tā' is light, voiceless, plosive.

د (dāl) ت (tā') Tip of tongue & upper gums Dāl is voiced; Tā' is voiceless.

ت (tā') د (dāl) Tip of tongue & upper gums Tā' is voiceless; Dāl is voiced.

ذ (dhāl) ظ (ẓā') Tip of tongue & upper teeth Dhāl is light; Ẓā' is emphatic.

ث (thā') ذ (dhāl) Tip of tongue & upper teeth Thā' is voiceless; Dhāl is voiced.

ب (bā') م (mīm) Lips (in close proximity) Bā' is oral; Mīm is nasal.

The Ruling for Al-Mutajānisayn

The ruling depends on the specific pair of letters. In the reading of Ḥaḥṣ 'an 'Āṣim:

- د + ت (dāl sākinah + tā'): Obligatory Idghām (complete assimilation). Example: qad tabayyana (قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ) → qattabayyana.
- ت + د (tā' sākinah + dāl): Obligatory Idghām. Example: 'ujibat da'watukumā (أُجِيبَتْ دَعْوَتُكُمْ) → 'ujibadda'watukumā.
- ذ + ظ (dhāl sākinah + ẓā'): Obligatory Idghām. Example: 'idh ẓalamū (إِذْ ظَلَمُوا) → 'izzalamū.
- ث + ذ (thā' sākinah + dhāl): Obligatory Idghām. Example: yalhath dhālika (يَلْهَثُ ذَلِكَ) → yalhaddhālika.
- ت + ط (tā' sākinah + ṭā'): Prohibited Idghām; Ḥaḥṣ reads with Iẓhār. Example: 'aḥaṭtu (أَحَطْتُ) – the ṭā' and tā' are both pronounced clearly.
- م + ب (bā' sākinah + mīm): Prohibited Idghām; Ḥaḥṣ reads with Iẓhār. Example: iḍrib mā (اضْرِبْ مَا) – both letters are clear. (Note: Nūn sākinah before mīm undergoes iqlāb or idghām, but bā' does not).

The Phonetic Rationale

Because these letters share the same makhraj, the transition from one to the other involves only a change in the manner of articulation (e.g., switching voicing on or off, adding or removing emphasis) while the articulators remain in place. This makes assimilation (idghām) phonetically natural and easy for many pairs. However, for other pairs (like ṭā' + tā'), the difference in emphasis (isti'lā' vs. isti'fāl) is significant enough that Ḥaḥṣ chooses to preserve the distinction through clear pronunciation (iẓhār).

Comparison with Al-Mithlān and Al-Mutaqāribayn

Category Makhraj Şifāt Ruling Tendency

Al-Mithlān Identical Identical Idghām (if first is sākin)

Al-Mutajānisayn Identical Different Idghām or Iẓhār depending on pair

Al-Mutaqāribayn Proximate Different Idghām or Iẓhār depending on pair

This tripartite scheme elegantly accounts for all instances of idghām in the Qur'ān (aside from idghām shamsī, which is a specific case of idghām mithlayn or mutaqāribayn).

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MUTAJĀNISAYN: DĀL SĀKINAH + TĀ' (ت + ذ) – IDGHĀM

Āyah: ﴿قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ الرُّشْدُ مِنَ الْغَيِّ﴾ [البقرة: 256]

Transliteration: Qad tabayyana r-rushdu mina l-ghayy

Translation: "The right course has become clear from the wrong."

Application: The phrase is قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ (qad tabayyana). The dāl of qad is sākinah. The following letter is ت (tā'). They are mutajānisayn. Ḥaḥṣ reads with idghām: the dāl is completely assimilated into the tā', which becomes geminated: qattabayyana. The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the tā': قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ.

EXAMPLE 2: MUTAJĀNISAYN: TĀ' SĀKINAH + DĀL (د + ت) – IDGHĀM

Āyah: ﴿قَالُوا أُجِيبْتَ دَعْوَتُكَ﴾ [يونس: 89]

Transliteration: Qālū 'ujibat da'watukumā

Translation: "He said, 'Your supplication has been answered.'"

Application: The phrase is أُجِيبْتَ دَعْوَتُكَ ('ujibat da'watukumā). The tā' of 'ujibat is sākinah. The following letter is د (dāl). They are mutajānisayn. Ḥaḥṣ reads with idghām: the tā' is completely assimilated into the dāl, which becomes geminated: 'ujibadda'watukumā. The muṣḥaf has a shaddah on the dāl.

EXAMPLE 3: MUTAJĀNISAYN: ṬĀ' SĀKINAH + TĀ' (ط + ت) – IZHĀR IN ḤAḤṢ

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا كُنْتَ مُتَّخِذَ الْمُضِلِّينَ عِصْدًا وَيَوْمَ يَعْصِي الظَّالِمُ عَلَى يَدَيْهِ يَقُولُ يَا لَيْتَنِي اتَّخَذْتُ مَعَ الرَّسُولِ سَبِيلًا يَا وَيْلَتَى لَيْتَنِي لَمْ أَتَّخِذْ فَلَانًا خَلِيلًا لَقَدْ أَضَلَّنِي عَنِ الذِّكْرِ بَعْدَ إِذْ جَاءَنِي وَكَانَ الشَّيْطَانُ لِلْإِنْسَانِ خَذُولًا وَقَالَ الرَّسُولُ يَا رَبِّ إِنَّ قَوْمِي اتَّخَذُوا هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ مَهْجُورًا وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَا لِكُلِّ نَبِيٍّ عَدُوًّا مِنَ الْمَجْرُمِينَ وَكَفَى بِرَبِّكَ هَادِيًا وَنَصِيرًا وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَوْلَا نُزِّلَ عَلَيْهِ الْقُرْآنُ جُمْلَةً وَاحِدَةً كَذَلِكَ لِنُثَبِّتَ بِهِ فُؤَادَكَ وَرَتَّلْنَاهُ تَرْتِيلًا وَلَا يَأْتُونَكَ بِمَثَلٍ إِلَّا جِئْنَاكَ بِالْحَقِّ وَأَحْسَنَ تَفْسِيرًا الَّذِينَ يَحْشَرُونَ عَلَى وُجُوهِهِمْ إِلَى جَهَنَّمَ أُولَئِكَ شَرٌّ مَكَانًا وَأَضَلُّ سَبِيلًا﴾ [الفرقان: 34-27]

Better Example: ﴿أَحْطْتُ بِمَا لَمْ تُحِطْ بِهِ﴾ [النمل: 22]

Transliteration: 'Aḥaṭtu bimā lam tuḥiṭ bih

Translation: "I have encompassed [in knowledge] that which you have not encompassed."

Application: The word is أَحْطْتُ ('aḥaṭtu). The ṭā' of the root is sākinah. The following letter is ت (tā') of the first-person singular perfect suffix. They are mutajānisayn. Despite sharing the same makhraj, Ḥaḥṣ reads this with Izhār: the ṭā' is pronounced clearly, followed by the tā'. The sound is 'aḥaṭ-tu. This is an important exception to the general tendency of idghām for mutajānisayn.

VERSE 33

Al-Idghām al-Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation)

ARABIC TEXT

بِالْمُتَجَانِسَيْنِ ثُمَّ إِنْ سَكَنَ
أَوَّلُ كُلِّ فَالصَّغِيرِ سَمِيانَ

TRANSLITERATION

Bi-l-mutajānisayni thumma in sakan

ʾawwalu kullin fa-ṣ-ṣaghīra sammiyan

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
بِالْمُتَجَانِسَيْنِ	bi-l-mutajānisayni	With "Al-Mutajānisayn" (the previous verse is completed)
ثُمَّ	thumma	Then / Furthermore
إِنْ	in	if
سَكَنَ	sakan	is quiescent
أَوَّلُ	ʾawwalu	the first
كُلِّ	kullin	of each [pair]
فَالصَّغِيرِ	fa-ṣ-ṣaghīra	then "Small" (Ṣaghīr)
سَمِيانَ	sammiyan	call (it)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"[They are called] Al-Mutajānisayn. Furthermore, if the first of each [of these pairs—Mithlayn, Mutajānisayn, or Mutaqāribayn] is quiescent, then call [the resulting assimilation] Ṣaghīr (Small)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Bi-l-mutajānisayni: This is the completion of the previous verse's definition. The bā' is for apposition or connection: "[They are called] Al-Mutajānisayn."
2. Thumma in sakan ʾawwalu kullin: Thumma introduces a new, overarching rule. In is conditional. Sakan is a perfect verb in the jussive, meaning "is quiescent." ʾAwwalu kullin means "the first of each [of the three pairs]." The phrase refers back to the three categories just defined: Al-Mithlān, Al-Mutajānisayn, and Al-Mutaqāribayn.

3. Fa-ṣ-ṣaghīra sammiyan: The response to the condition. Fa-ṣ-ṣaghīra is the accusative object of the imperative verb sammiyan. Sammiyan is an imperative verb reinforced with the light energetic nūn (nūn al-tawkīd al-khafīfah), meaning "you must call it!" Aṣ-Ṣaghīr means "the Small." The full meaning is: "If the first letter of any of these three types of pairs is quiescent, then you must call the resulting assimilation Idghām Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation)."

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Idghām Ṣaghīr (Small Assimilation)

- Technical Definition: Idghām Ṣaghīr is the assimilation of a quiescent letter (sākin) into a voweled letter (mutaḥarrik). The first letter is "weak" (lacking a vowel), and it is absorbed into the "strong" second letter.

Why is it Called "Small" (Ṣaghīr)?

It is called "small" because it is phonetically easy and light. Since the first letter is already quiescent, it lacks the full acoustic energy of a voweled letter. Assimilating it requires less articulatory effort. The change is minimal: the first letter simply disappears, and the second letter is prolonged. This is contrasted with Idghām Kabīr (Large Assimilation), which will be defined in the next verse.

Application to the Three Categories

This rule provides the unified terminology for all the cases of assimilation we have studied so far, provided the first letter is sākin:

Category Example First Letter Second Letter Resulting Idghām Type

Mithlān qad dakhala د (sākin) ذ (mutaḥarrik) Idghām Mithlayn Ṣaghīr

Mutajānisayn qad tabayyana ت (sākin) ب (mutaḥarrik) Idghām Mutajānisayn Ṣaghīr

Mutaqāribayn min rabbiḥim ن (sākin) ر (mutaḥarrik) Idghām Mutaqāribayn Ṣaghīr

All the mandatory idghām rules for nūn sākinah, mīm sākinah, and lām al-taʿrīf (which involve a sākin first letter) fall under the umbrella of Idghām Ṣaghīr.

Pedagogical Importance

Understanding this terminology helps the student see the unity underlying the various idghām rules. Instead of memorizing disparate cases, they recognize a single principle: a quiescent letter is assimilated into a following voweled letter when they are identical, similar, or proximate. This is the core phonetic logic of idghām in Qurʾānic recitation.

VERSE 34

Al-Idghām al-Kabīr (Large Assimilation)

ARABIC TEXT

أَوْ حُرِّكَ الْحَرْفَانِ فِي كُلِّ قَوْلٍ

كُلُّ كَبِيرٌ وَافْهَمَهُ بِالْمَثَلِ

TRANSLITERATION

'Aw ḥurrika l-ḥarfāni fi kullin fa-qul

kullun kabīrun wa-fhamanhu bi-l-muthul

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَوْ	'aw	Or
حُرِّكَ	ḥurrika	are voweled
الْحَرْفَانِ	al-ḥarfāni	the two letters
فِي	fī	in
كُلِّ	kullin	each [of the three pairs]
فَقُلْ	fa-qul	then say
كُلُّ	kullun	each [such assimilation]
كَبِيرٌ	kabīrun	(is) "Large" (Kabīr)
وَافْهَمَهُ	wa-fhamanhu	and understand it
بِالْمَثَلِ	bi-l-muthul	through examples

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Or, if the two letters in each [of these pairs] are voweled, then say: 'Each [such assimilation] is Kabīr (Large).' And understand it through examples."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. 'Aw ḥurrika l-ḥarfāni fi kullin: 'Aw introduces the alternative condition. Ḥurrika is a passive perfect verb meaning "they have been voweled" or "they are voweled." Al-ḥarfāni is the dual subject, meaning "the two letters." Fī kullin means "in each [of the three pairs]."
2. Fa-qul kullun kabīrun: The response to the condition. Fa-qul is an imperative: "then say!" Kullun is the subject, meaning "each [instance of such assimilation]." Kabīrun is the predicate, meaning "is Large." The phrase means: "Then say, 'It is Idghām Kabīr (Large Assimilation).'"

3. Wa-fhamanhu bi-l-muthul: Wa-fhamanhu is an imperative verb reinforced with the light energetic nūn: "and you must understand it!" The pronoun -hu refers to this rule. Bi-l-muthul means "through examples" (muthul is the plural of mathal). The poet acknowledges that this rule is more abstract and directs the student to learn it through concrete examples from the Qur'ān and the teacher's instruction.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Idghām Kabīr (Large Assimilation)

- Technical Definition: Idghām Kabīr is the assimilation of a voweled letter (mutaḥarrik) into another voweled letter (mutaḥarrik). Because both letters have vowels, the first letter must first be stripped of its vowel (taskīn) before it can be assimilated.

Why is it Called "Large" (Kabīr)?

It is called "large" because it is phonetically heavy and more complex. Removing a vowel from a letter and then assimilating it requires more articulatory manipulation and is considered a more significant change to the word's structure. It is a feature of more advanced or accelerated styles of recitation.

The Ruling for Ḥaḥṣ 'an 'Āṣim

Crucially, the reading of Ḥaḥṣ 'an 'Āṣim does NOT apply Idghām Kabīr. In Ḥaḥṣ, whenever two letters from these categories meet and both are voweled, they must be pronounced clearly and separately (Izhār). This is a fundamental distinguishing feature of Ḥaḥṣ's recitation, which tends toward clarity (takhfīf and tabyīn).

Examples of Idghām Kabīr (in other Qirā'āt)

- Al-Mithlān Kabīr: 'alima (عَلِمَا) – the mīm and the following mīm? Actually, a better example is fihi hudan (فِيهِ هُدًى). The hā' in fihi has a kasrah, and the following hā' in hudan has a ḍammah. In Ḥaḥṣ, they are pronounced clearly: fihi hudan. In the reading of al-Sūsī (from Abū 'Amr), idghām kabīr is applied: the first hā' is made sākin, and it is assimilated into the second hā': fih-hudā (with a geminated hā').
- Al-Mutajānisayn Kabīr: ya'lamu mā (يَعْلَمُ مَا). The mīm in ya'lamu has a ḍammah, and the following mīm in mā has a fathḥah. Ḥaḥṣ reads clearly: ya'lamu mā. Al-Sūsī may read: ya'lam mā.
- Al-Mutaqāribayn Kabīr: al-ḥamdu lillāhi (الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ). The dāl in al-ḥamdu has a ḍammah, and the lām in lillāhi has a kasrah. Ḥaḥṣ reads clearly: al-ḥamdu lillāhi. Al-Sūsī may read: al-ḥamlillāhi.

Pedagogical Note for Ḥaḥṣ Students

For the student of Ḥaḥṣ, this verse is primarily informational. It completes the theoretical classification of idghām. The practical takeaway is a warning: Do NOT apply Idghām Kabīr. When you see two voweled letters from these categories, pronounce them both clearly. Do not be confused if you hear a reciter like al-Sūsī applying idghām kabīr; simply know that it is a valid feature of another canonical reading, but not of Ḥaḥṣ.

Comparative Analysis with Ibn al-Jazarī

Ibn al-Jazarī's Muqaddimah states:

أَوْ حَرَكَ الْحَرْفَانِ فِي كُلِّ فَقْلٍ ... كُلُّ كَبِيرٌ وَافْهَمَهُ بِالْمَثَلِ

"Or if the two letters are voweled in each [pair], then say: 'Each is Kabīr.' And understand it through examples."

The verse is identical. Both poets include this definition for the sake of theoretical completeness, even though their primary audience (students of Ḥafṣ) will not apply the rule in practice. It is part of the broader education of a reciter to be aware of the variants in the qirā'āt.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS (FOR ḤAFṢ STUDENTS – IZHĀR)

EXAMPLE 1: MITHLĀN KABĪR CONTEXT – ḤAFṢ READS WITH IZHĀR

Āyah: ﴿فِيهِ هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ﴾ [البقرة: 2]

Transliteration: Fīhi hudan li-l-muttaqīn

Translation: "In it is guidance for the righteous."

Application: The phrase is فِيهِ هُدًى (fīhi hudan). The first hā' (in fīhi) has a kasrah. The second hā' (in hudan) has a ḍammah. They are identical (mithlān) and both are voweled. This is a context for idghām kabīr. Ḥafṣ reads with Izhār: both hā's are pronounced clearly: fī-hi hu-dan. There is no gemination. The student of Ḥafṣ must be careful not to say fih-hudā.

EXAMPLE 2: MUTAJĀNISAYN KABĪR CONTEXT – ḤAFṢ READS WITH IZHĀR

Āyah: ﴿يَعْلَمُ مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَمَا خَلْفَهُمْ﴾ [البقرة: 255]

Transliteration: Ya'lamu mā bayna 'aydihim...

Translation: "He knows what is before them and what is behind them."

Application: The phrase is يَعْلَمُ مَا (ya'lamu mā). The first mīm (in ya'lamu) has a ḍammah. The second mīm (in mā) has a fathah. They are identical (mithlān) and both voweled. Ḥafṣ reads with Izhār: ya'la-mu mā. The mīm of ya'lamu is clear, and then the mīm of mā is pronounced. No gemination.

EXAMPLE 3: MUTAQĀRIBAYN KABĪR CONTEXT – ḤAFṢ READS WITH IZHĀR

Āyah: ﴿الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ﴾ [الفاتحة: 2]

Transliteration: Al-ḥamdu lillāhi rabbi l-'ālamīn

Translation: "Praise be to Allah, Lord of the worlds."

Application: The phrase is **الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ** (al-ḥamdu lillāhi). The dāl in al-ḥamdu has a ḍammah. The lām in lillāhi has a kasrah. They are proximate (mutaqāribayn) and both voweled. Ḥafṣ reads with Iẓhār: al-ḥam-du lil-lāh. The dāl is clear, and then the lām is pronounced. The student must not say al-ḥamlillāh.

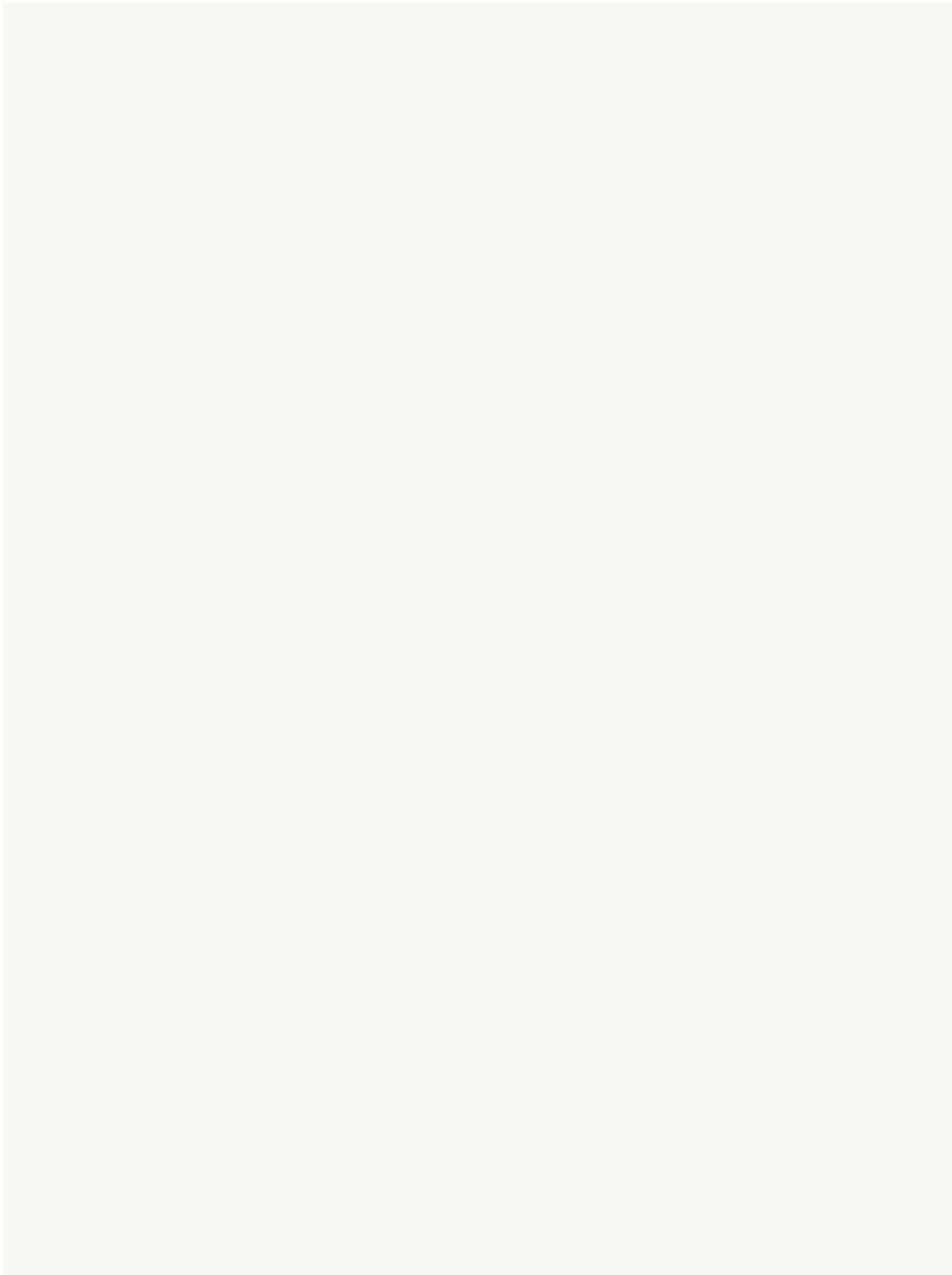
A Critical English Edition of *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fi Tajwīd al-Qurʾān*

PART VII

الْبَابُ السَّابِعُ

The Rules of Madd (Prolongation) (Verses 35–57)





Overview

The section on madd (prolongation) is the most extensive in the Tuḥfah, comprising twenty-three verses (35–57). This reflects the complexity and importance of madd in Qur’ānic recitation. Madd governs the duration of long vowels and their interaction with following hamzahs and quiescent letters. Al-Jamzūrī meticulously classifies madd into its primary types—Aṣlī (Original/Natural) and Far’ī (Secondary/Branching)—and then subdivides Far’ī into Wājib (Obligatory), Jā’iz (Permissible), and Lāzim (Compulsory). He also covers the special case of Madd in the disconnected letters at the beginning of certain sūrahs (al-Ḥurūf al-Muqatta‘ah). This section forms the theoretical backbone for one of the most distinctive features of Qur’ānic cantillation.

VERSES 35–37

The Division of Madd and Al-Madd al-Aṣlī (The Original Prolongation)

ARABIC TEXT

وَالْمَدُّ أَصْلِيٌّ وَفَرَعِيٌّ لَهُ
وَسَمٌّ أَوَّلًا طَبِيعِيًّا وَهُوَ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-maddu ‘aṣliyyun wa-far’iyyun lah

wa-sammi ‘awwalan ṭabī’iyyan wa-hū

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالْمَدُّ	<i>wa-l-maddu</i>	And Madd (prolongation)
أَصْلِيٌّ	<i>‘aṣliyyun</i>	(is) Original
وَفَرَعِيٌّ	<i>wa-far’iyyun</i>	and Branching
لَهُ	<i>lah</i>	[belongs] to it
وَسَمٌّ	<i>wa-sammi</i>	and call
أَوَّلًا	<i>‘awwalan</i>	the first [type]
طَبِيعِيًّا	<i>ṭabī’iyyan</i>	"Natural"

وَهُوَ wa-hū and it...

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Madd (prolongation) is [divided into] Original (ʿAṣlī) and Branching (Farʿī), which is derived from it. And call the first [type] Natural (Ṭabīʿī). And it..."

ARABIC TEXT

مَا لَا تَوَقُّفُ لَهُ عَلَى سَبَبٍ
وَلَا بِدُونِهِ الْحُرُوفُ تُجْتَلَبُ

TRANSLITERATION

Mā lā tawaqqufun lahū ʿalā sabab

wa-lā bidūnihi l-ḥurūfu tujtalab

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
مَا	<i>mā</i>	(is) that which
لَا	<i>lā</i>	(has) no
تَوَقُّفٌ	<i>tawaqqufun</i>	dependence / stopping
لَهُ	<i>lahū</i>	for it
عَلَى	<i>ʿalā</i>	upon
سَبَبٍ	<i>sabab</i>	a cause
وَلَا	<i>wa-lā</i>	and not
بِدُونِهِ	<i>bi-dūnihi</i>	without it
الْحُرُوفُ	<i>al-ḥurūfu</i>	the letters (of madd)

تُجْتَلَبُ tujtalab are brought forth / can be produced

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"...[It is] that which has no dependence upon a cause (sabab), and without which the letters [of madd] cannot be produced."

ARABIC TEXT

بَلْ أَيْ حَرْفٍ غَيْرِ هَمْزٍ أَوْ سُكُونٍ
جَاءَ بَعْدَ مَدٍّ فَالطَّبِيعِيُّ يَكُونُ

TRANSLITERATION

Bal 'ayyu ḥarfin ghayri hamzin 'aw sukūn

jā ba'da maddin fa-ṭ-ṭabī'iyu yakūn

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
بَلْ	<i>bal</i>	Rather / In other words
أَيْ	<i>'ayyu</i>	any
حَرْفٍ	<i>ḥarfin</i>	letter
غَيْرِ	<i>ghayri</i>	other than
هَمْزٍ	<i>hamzin</i>	a hamzah
أَوْ	<i>'aw</i>	or
سُكُونٍ	<i>sukūn</i>	a sukūn (quiescent letter)
جَاءَ	<i>jā</i>	comes
بَعْدَ	<i>ba'da</i>	after
مَدٍّ	<i>maddin</i>	a madd letter
فَالطَّبِيعِيُّ	<i>fa-ṭ-ṭabī'iyu</i>	then the Natural (prolongation)
يَكُونُ	<i>yakūn</i>	it is

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"In other words: Any letter other than a hamzah or a sukūn that comes after a madd letter [results in] the Natural (Ṭabī'ī) prolongation."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-maddu 'aṣliyyun wa-far'iiyun lah: The subject is al-madd. The two predicates are 'aṣliyyun and far'iiyun. The phrase lah ("to it") indicates that the far'ī (branching) type is derived from and dependent upon the 'aṣlī (original) type. This establishes a logical hierarchy.
2. Wa-sammi 'awwalan ṭabī'iiyan: The poet provides the alternative, more common name for al-madd al-'aṣlī: Al-Madd al-Ṭabī'ī (The Natural Prolongation). Ṭabī'ī comes from ṭabī'ah (nature), indicating that this prolongation is inherent to the letters themselves and does not require an external trigger.
3. Wa-hū mā lā tawaqqufun lahū 'alā sabab: This is the first part of the definition. Mā is a relative pronoun ("that which"). Lā tawaqqufun lahū is a nominal sentence meaning "it has no dependence." The definition states that Natural Madd does not depend on an external cause (sabab) like a following hamzah or sukūn. It is self-sufficient.
4. Wa-lā bidūnihi l-ḥurūfu tuḡtalab: Lā is a negative particle. Bi-dūnihi means "without it." Al-ḥurūfu means "the letters," referring specifically to the three letters of madd (alif, wāw, yā'). Tuḡtalab is a passive verb meaning "are brought" or "are produced." The phrase means: "And without this [natural prolongation], the madd letters cannot be produced [correctly]." In other words, the two-count prolongation is an intrinsic part of the identity of these letters; without it, they would not be the madd letters. This is a profound phonetic observation: a long vowel in Arabic is not just a short vowel held longer; it is a distinct phoneme, and its duration is a defining feature.
5. Bal 'ayyu ḥarfin ḡhayri hamzin 'aw sukūn...: Bal is a particle of emendation, meaning "rather" or "in other words." It introduces a simpler, more operational definition. 'Ayyu ḥarfin means "any letter." The phrase ḡhayri hamzin 'aw sukūn ("other than a hamzah or a sukūn") specifies the condition. If the letter following a madd letter is not a hamzah and not a quiescent letter, then the madd is Natural. This is a perfect, practical rule for students.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Madd (المَدّ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Madd (مَدّ) means "to extend," "to stretch," "to prolong." It is the act of making something longer.
- Technical Definition in Tajweed: Madd is the prolongation of the sound of one of the three madd letters (ا - alif, و - wāw, ي - yā') for a specific duration, typically measured in vowel counts (ḥarakāt).

The Three Letters of Madd (Ḥurūf al-Madd)

The letters of madd are three, and they must meet specific conditions:

Letter Name Condition Example

ا alif Must be sākinah (quiescent) and preceded by a faṭḥah (َ). قَالَ (qāla)

و wāw Must be sākinah (quiescent) and preceded by a ḍammah (ُ). يَقُولُ (yaqūlu)

ي yā' Must be sākinah (quiescent) and preceded by a kasrah (ِ). قِيلَ (qīla)

Al-Jamzūrī will explicitly state these conditions in a later verse (verse 40). For now, the definition of Natural Madd applies to any of these three letters when they are not followed by a hamzah or a sukūn.

Definition of Al-Madd al-Aṣlī / Al-Madd al-Ṭabīʿī (The Original / Natural Prolongation)

- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter for a duration of exactly two vowel counts (ḥarakatayn), without any increase or decrease. It is "natural" because it is the inherent length of these letters, and it does not depend on any external cause (sabab). It is "original" because all other types of madd are built upon it by adding extra counts.

The Two Causes of Secondary Madd (Sababā al-Madd al-Farʿī)

The definition in verse 37 explicitly mentions the two causes that prevent a madd from being Natural. These are the two causes of Secondary Madd (al-Madd al-Farʿī):

1. Hamzah (ء): A glottal stop. If a madd letter is followed by a hamzah, the madd becomes either Madd Muttasil (Connected) or Madd Munfaṣil (Separated).
2. Sukūn (◌ْ): A quiescent letter. If a madd letter is followed by a sukūn, the madd becomes either Madd Lāzim (Compulsory) or Madd ʿArid li-l-Sukūn (Temporary due to Pause).

If neither of these two causes is present, the madd is, by default, Natural (Ṭabīʿī).

Duration of Natural Madd: Two Ḥarakāt

A ḥarakah (حَرَكَه) is the standard unit of time in Tajweed, defined as the time it takes to pronounce a single short vowel (a faṭḥah, ḍammah, or kasrah). It is roughly equivalent to the time it takes to open or close a finger in a relaxed manner. Natural madd is prolonged for exactly two ḥarakāt. This is non-negotiable; shortening it to one ḥarakah or extending it to three or more is an error (lahn).

The Phonetic Rationale

The long vowels in Arabic are phonemic. The difference between qala (قَالَ) and qāla (قَالَ) is not just a matter of emphasis; the duration of the vowel distinguishes meaning. The two-ḥarakah length is the standard, unmarked duration. The secondary madds represent marked durations triggered by specific phonetic environments (the glottal catch of hamzah or the articulatory hold of a sukūn).

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Concept of Ḥarakah: English does not use vowel length phonemically in the same way. The student must internalize the two-count rhythm. A helpful method is to tap twice lightly while reciting: qā (tap tap) la.
- Drill: Practice قَالَ (qāla). Say "qaa-la," ensuring the "aa" is exactly twice as long as the "la." Do not say "qa-la" (short) or "qaaa-la" (overly long). Use a metronome or finger-tapping to maintain consistency.
- Distinguishing Madd Letters: Alif is always a madd letter. Wāw and yā' can also be madd letters if they meet the conditions. If a wāw is sākin and preceded by a faṭḥah (e.g., yawm يوم), it is not a madd letter; it is a ḥarf layyin (soft letter/diphthong). This distinction is crucial.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: NATURAL MADD WITH ALIF (ا)

Āyah: ﴿قَالَ رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي﴾ [طه: 25]

Transliteration: Qāla rabbi shraḥ lī ṣadrī

Translation: "[Moses] said, 'My Lord, expand for me my chest.'"

Application: The word is قَالَ (qāla). It contains an alif that is sākinah and preceded by a fathḥah on the qāf. The following letter is a voweled lām (ل). There is no hamzah and no sukūn after the alif. Therefore, the alif is prolonged for exactly two ḥarakāt: qā-la.

EXAMPLE 2: NATURAL MADD WITH WĀW (و)

Āyah: ﴿يَقُولُ رَبِّ لِمَ حَشَرْتَنِي أَعْمَى وَقَدْ كُنْتُ بَصِيرًا﴾ [طه: 125]

Transliteration: Yaqūlu rabbi lima ḥashartanī 'a'mā...

Translation: "He will say, 'My Lord, why have you raised me blind while I was [once] seeing?'"

Application: The word is يَقُولُ (yaqūlu). It contains a wāw that is sākinah and preceded by a ḍammah on the qāf. The following letter is a voweled lām (ل). There is no hamzah or sukūn after the wāw. The wāw is prolonged for exactly two ḥarakāt: ya-qū-lu.

EXAMPLE 3: NATURAL MADD WITH YĀ' (ي)

Āyah: ﴿وَقِيلَ يَا أَرْضُ ابْلَعِي مَاءَكِ وَيَا سَمَاءُ أَقْلِعِي﴾ [هود: 44]

Transliteration: Wa-qīla yā 'arḍu bla'ī mā'aki...

Translation: "And it was said, 'O earth, swallow your water, and O sky, withhold [your rain].'"

Application: The word is قِيلَ (qīla). It contains a yā' that is sākinah and preceded by a kasrah on the qāf. The following letter is a voweled lām (ل). There is no hamzah or sukūn after the yā'. The yā' is prolonged for exactly two ḥarakāt: qī-la.

VERSE 38

The Cause of Secondary Madd (Al-Madd al-Far'ī)

ARABIC TEXT

وَالْآخِرُ الْفَرْعِيُّ مَوْقُوفٌ عَلَى

سَبَبٌ كَهَمْزٍ أَوْ سُكُونٍ مُسْجَلًا

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-ʾākharu l-farʿiyyu mawqūfun ʾalā

sabab ka-hamzin ʾaw sukūnin musjalā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالْآخَرُ	<i>wa-l-ʾākharu</i>	And the other
الْفَرْعِيُّ	<i>al-farʿiyyu</i>	the Branching (Farʿī)
مَوْقُوفٌ	<i>mawqūfun</i>	(is) dependent / contingent
عَلَى	<i>ʾalā</i>	upon
سَبَبٌ	<i>sabab</i>	a cause
كَهَمْزٍ	<i>ka-hamzin</i>	like a hamzah
أَوْ	<i>ʾaw</i>	or
سُكُونٍ	<i>sukūnin</i>	a sukūn (quiescent letter)
مُسْجَلًا	<i>musjalā</i>	absolute / unqualified

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The other [type], the Branching (Farʿī), is dependent upon a cause (sabab), such as a hamzah or an absolute sukūn."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-ʾākharu l-farʿiyyu: Al-ʾākharu refers back to the second division mentioned in verse 35. Al-farʿiyyu is an adjective meaning "the branching" or "the secondary." It is derived from the primary, natural madd.
2. Mawqūfun ʾalā sabab: Mawqūfun is a passive participle from waqafa (to stop, to depend). It means "dependent" or "contingent." The phrase ʾalā sabab ("upon a cause") specifies that this type of madd only occurs when triggered by an external factor.
3. Ka-hamzin ʾaw sukūnin musjalā: The kāf is for exemplification ("such as"). The two causes are explicitly named:

- Hamzah (ء): The glottal stop.
- Sukūn (◌ْ): A quiescent letter.

The word *musjalā* is an adverb (ḥāl) from *musjal* (مُسْجَلٌ), meaning "absolute," "unrestricted," or "unqualified." It modifies *sukūn*, indicating that any type of *sukūn*—whether it is an original part of the word (*sukūn ʾaṣlī*) or a temporary pause (*sukūn ʾarīḍ*)—can serve as a cause for secondary madd. This is an important clarification: the *sukūn* of a paused word (*waqf*) is just as valid a cause as the *sukūn* of a shaddah or a permanently quiescent letter.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of *Al-Madd al-Farʿī* (The Branching / Secondary Prolongation)

- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter for a duration greater than two ḥarakāt. This extra length is triggered by the presence of one of two specific causes (*sabab*) immediately following the madd letter: a hamzah or a sukūn.

The Two Causes in Detail

Cause Linguistic Name Example Resulting Madd Type

ء (hamzah) Hamz jāʾa (جَاءَ) Madd Muttasil (Connected)

ء (hamzah) Hamz ʾinnā ʾanzalnāhu (إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ) Madd Munfaṣil (Separated)

سُكُونٌ (sukūn) Sukūn ʾAṣlī (Original) al-ḥāqqah (الْحَاقَّةُ) Madd Lāzim (Compulsory)

سُكُونٌ (sukūn) Sukūn ʾArīḍ (Temporary) al-ʿālamīn (الْعَالَمِينَ) at pause Madd ʾArīḍ li-l-Sukūn (Temporary due to Pause)

The word *musjalā* is crucial. It tells the student that the *sukūn* of the definite article (*al-*), the *sukūn* of a shaddah (which contains a sākin letter), and the *sukūn* applied when stopping on a word are all valid causes for secondary madd. This unifies a wide range of phenomena under a single, elegant principle.

Types of *Al-Madd al-Farʿī*

Based on the cause, secondary madd is divided into several named types, which al-Jamzūrī will detail in the following verses:

Cause Sub-type Name Transliteration

Hamzah In same word مُتَّصِلٌ Muttasil (Connected)

Hamzah In next word مُنْفَصِلٌ Munfaṣil (Separated)

Sukūn Original (ʾaṣlī) لَازِمٌ Lāzim (Compulsory)

Sukūn Temporary (ʾarīḍ) عَارِضٌ لِّلْسُكُونِ ʾArīḍ li-l-Sukūn (Temporary due to Pause)

(Special) Hamzah precedes madd letter بَدَلٌ Badal (Substitution)

Each of these will be defined in the subsequent verses.

The Phonetic Rationale

- Hamzah: The hamzah is a glottal stop, requiring a complete closure of the vocal cords. The transition from a smooth, continuous vowel to an abrupt glottal stop creates a natural phonetic "break." To smooth this transition and maintain the flow of recitation, the vowel is prolonged, giving the articulators time to prepare for the glottal closure.
- Sukūn: A sukūn represents a consonant without a vowel. In connected speech, moving from a long vowel directly into another consonant without an intervening short vowel can create a heavy consonant cluster (iltiqā' al-sākinayn). To alleviate this heaviness and make the transition smoother, the long vowel is prolonged. This is especially evident in pause (waqf), where the final vowel is dropped, and the madd is lengthened to compensate and signal the ending.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Concept of "Cause": English speakers can think of the hamzah and sukūn as "triggers." When you see a madd letter followed by one of these triggers, you know the vowel must be held longer than the default two counts.
- The Word Musjalā: Emphasize that any sukūn counts. This is a common point of confusion for students who might think only a permanent sukūn (like in al-ḥāqqah) triggers secondary madd. The sukūn you make when you stop on al-ʿālamīn is equally valid.

VERSE 39

The Three Letters of Madd (Recap and Mnemonic)

ARABIC TEXT

حُرُوفُهُ ثَلَاثَةٌ فَعِيهَا
فِي لَفْظٍ وَائٍ وَهِيَ فِي نُوحِيهَا

TRANSLITERATION

Ḥurūfuhū thalāthatun fa-ʿihā

fī lafẓi wāyin wa-hiya fī nūḥihā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
حُرُوفُهُ	ḥurūfuhū	Its letters
ثَلَاثَةٌ	thalāthatun	(are) three

فَعِيهَا fa-ʿihā so understand them / be aware of them

فِي fi in

لَفْظٍ lafẓi (the) utterance of

وَايٍ wāyin "WĀY"

وَهِيَ wa-hiya and they are

فِي fi in

نُوحِيهَا nūḥihā "NŪḤĪHĀ" ("We reveal it")

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Its letters are three; so be aware of them! [They are found] in the utterance of وَايٍ (WĀY), and they are [exemplified] in [the word] نُوحِيهَا (NŪḤĪHĀ – 'We reveal it')."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Ḥurūfuhū thalāthatun: The pronoun -hū refers back to al-madd. The verse explicitly states that the letters of madd are three. This recaps the information for the student.
2. Fa-ʿihā: This is an imperative verb from waʿā (to be aware, to understand, to retain). It means "so understand them!" or "so retain them [in your memory]!"
3. The Mnemonic WĀY (وَايٍ): This is a simple mnemonic formed by the three madd letters themselves: و (wāw), ا (alif), ي (yāʾ). Pronouncing them in sequence—wāw, alif, yāʾ—gives the sound wāy.
4. The Example NŪḤĪHĀ (نُوحِيهَا): This is a brilliant pedagogical choice. The single word nūḥihā (from Sūrah al-Shūrā, verse 7, though the alif is added for poetic meter) contains all three madd letters in their proper conditions:
 - و (wāw) in نُو : sākinah, preceded by a ḍammah.
 - ي (yāʾ) in حِي : sākinah, preceded by a kasrah.
 - ا (alif) in هَا : sākinah, preceded by a fatḥah.

By providing this single word, the poet gives the student a complete, concrete example to memorize and refer to.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

The Three Letters Reiterated

This verse serves as a reinforcing summary. The three letters are:

- الألف (alif): ا
- الواو (wāw): و
- الياء (yāʾ): ي

The conditions for each are as previously stated and will be explicitly given in the next verse.

The Mnemonic WĀY

Mnemonics like WĀY are essential tools in traditional Islamic pedagogy. They transform an abstract list into a pronounceable, memorable "word." When a student recites wāy, they are literally vocalizing the three letters of madd in sequence.

The Example NŪḤĪHĀ

The word nūḥīhā is derived from the verb 'awḥā (to reveal). The first-person plural imperfect form is nūḥī (نُوحِي). Al-Jamzūrī adds the object pronoun -hā (هَا), resulting in nūḥīhā. This addition provides the alif needed to complete the set of three madd letters. The word itself means "We reveal it." This is a beautiful example of how the poet weaves together technical instruction with the language of the Qur'an.

VERSE 40

The Conditions for the Madd Letters

ARABIC TEXT

وَالْكَسْرُ قَبْلَ الْيَا وَقَبْلَ الْوَاوِ ضَمٌّ
شَرْطٌ وَفَتْحٌ قَبْلَ أَلْفٍ يُلْتَزَمُ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-kasru qabla l-yā wa-qabla l-wāwi ḍam

sharṭun wa-faṭḥun qabla 'alfin yultazam

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالْكَسْرُ	<i>wa-l-kasru</i>	And the kasrah
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	before
الْيَا	<i>al-yā</i>	the yā'
وَقَبْلَ	<i>wa-qabla</i>	and before
الْوَاوِ	<i>al-wāwi</i>	the wāw
ضَمٌّ	<i>ḍam</i>	a ḍammah
شَرْطٌ	<i>sharṭun</i>	(is) a condition

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَفَتْحٍ	<i>wa-fatḥun</i>	and a fatḥah
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	before
أَلِفٍ	<i>'alfin</i>	an alif

يُلْتَزَمُ yultazam is mandatory / must be adhered to

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"A kasrah before the yā', and a ḍammah before the wāw, is a condition [for them to be madd letters]. And a fatḥah before an alif is mandatory."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-kasru qabla l-yā... sharṭun: The verse consists of two parallel nominal sentences. The subject of the first is al-kasru ("the kasrah"), and the predicate is sharṭun ("a condition"). The phrase qabla l-yā ("before the yā'") specifies the context. The second subject is ḍam ("a ḍammah"), and it shares the predicate sharṭun.
2. Wa-fatḥun qabla 'alfin yultazam: The third subject is fatḥun ("a fatḥah"). Its predicate is the passive verb yultazam, which means "is adhered to," "is mandatory," or "is required." The use of a stronger verb (yultazam instead of sharṭun) emphasizes that the fatḥah before the alif is an inviolable rule; an alif never occurs without a preceding fatḥah.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

The Conditions Explicitly Stated

This verse provides the precise, technical conditions that distinguish a madd letter from a regular consonant or a diphthong (ḥarf layyin).

Madd Letter Preceding Vowel Condition Example

ي (yā') كَسْرَةً (kasrah) Must be sākinah قَبْلَ (qīla)

و (wāw) ضَمَّةً (ḍammah) Must be sākinah يَقُولُ (yaqūlu)

ا (alif) فَتْحَةً (fatḥah) Must be sākinah قَالَ (qāla)

The Importance of the Conditions

- For Yā' and Wāw: If a yā' or wāw is sākinah but preceded by a fatḥah, it is not a madd letter. It is a Ḥarf Layyin (Soft Letter / Diphthong). Examples: yawm (يَوْم) – the wāw is preceded by a fatḥah; bayt (بَيْت) – the yā' is preceded by a fatḥah. These diphthongs are pronounced with a quick glide, not a two-count prolongation. They are governed by different rules (specifically, Madd Layyin, which al-Jamzūrī will address in the next verse).
- For Alif: The condition is absolute. An alif in Arabic is always sākinah and is always preceded by a fatḥah. There is no exception. This is why alif is the quintessential madd letter.

The Phonetic Basis

The conditions reflect a principle of vowel harmony. The madd letter is, in essence, a prolongation of the short vowel that precedes it.

- Kasrah (ـِ) is the short vowel corresponding to the long vowel ī (ي).
- Dammah (ـُ) is the short vowel corresponding to the long vowel ū (و).
- Fathah (ـَ) is the short vowel corresponding to the long vowel ā (أ).

The madd letter is the long, pure version of the preceding short vowel. This phonetic relationship is why the conditions are so strict.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Contrast Drill: Practice the difference between a madd letter and a diphthong.
- Madd Wāw: يَقُولُ (yaqūlu). Hold the "oo" sound for two counts.
- Diphthong Wāw: يَوْمَ (yawm). The "aw" sound is quick, like the "ow" in "how."
- Madd Yā': قِيلَ (qīla). Hold the "ee" sound for two counts.
- Diphthong Yā': يَتَ (bayt). The "ay" sound is quick, like the "ay" in "day."

VERSE 41

The Soft Letters (Ḥurūf al-Līn)

ARABIC TEXT

وَاللّٰیْنِ مِنْهَا اِلٰیَّا وَاَوْ سَكَا
اِنْ اَنْفَتَحَ قَبْلَ كُلِّ اَعْلٰنَا

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-līnu minhā l-yā wa-wāwun sukinā

'ini nfitāḥun qabla kullin 'u'linā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَاللّٰیْنِ	<i>wa-l-līnu</i>	And the Soft Letters
مِنْهَا	<i>minhā</i>	from them (the madd letters)
اِلٰیَّا	<i>al-yā</i>	(are) the yā'
وَاَوْ	<i>wa-wāwun</i>	and the wāw

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
سُكِّنَا	<i>sukinā</i>	when they are quiescent
إِنْ	<i>'ini</i>	if
انْفِتَاحٌ	<i>nfitāḥun</i>	a fatḥah
قَبْلَ	<i>qabla</i>	precedes
كُلِّ	<i>kullin</i>	each [of them]
أُعْلِنَا	<i>'u'linā</i>	is declared / made known

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And the Soft Letters (Ḥurūf al-Līn)—from among them [the madd letters]—are the yā' and the wāw when they are quiescent, if a fatḥah precedes each [of them], as has been made known."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-līnu minhā l-yā wa-wāwun: Al-līn means "softness" or "flexibility." The verse identifies a subset of the madd letters: the yā' and the wāw. The alif is excluded; it is never a soft letter.
2. Sukinā: This is a passive perfect verb in the dual form, meaning "they (both) have been made quiescent" or "when they are quiescent." The alif at the end is the alif al-iṭlāq.
3. 'Ini nfitāḥun qabla kullin 'u'linā: This is the defining condition. 'In is conditional. Infitāḥun means "a fatḥah" (literally, "an opening"). Qabla kullin means "before each of them." The phrase means: "if a fatḥah precedes each of them." The passive verb 'u'linā ("is declared" or "has been made known") serves as the predicate, emphasizing that this rule is established and well-known.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Ḥurūf al-Līn (The Soft Letters / Diphthongs)

- Technical Definition: The ḥurūf al-līn are the two letters و (wāw) and ي (yā') when they are quiescent (sākinah) and are preceded by a fatḥah (ـَ).

Comparison with Ḥurūf al-Madd

Feature Ḥurūf al-Madd Ḥurūf al-Līn

Letters ي، و، ي only

Preceding Vowel kasrah for ي، ḍammah for و، fatḥah for | Always fatḥah (for both و and ي)

State Always sākin Always sākin

Prolongation Prolonged two counts (Ṭabī'ī) Not prolonged in continuous recitation (waṣl)

Prolongation in Pause Can become ‘Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn Can have Madd Layyin (2, 4, or 6 counts)

Pronunciation of Ḥurūf al-Līn in Waṣl (Continuous Recitation)

In the flow of recitation, the ḥurūf al-līn are not prolonged. They are pronounced as quick diphthongs:

- و (preceded by fathah) = the diphthong /aw/, as in yawm (يَوْمٌ) or khawf (خَوْفٌ).
- ي (preceded by fathah) = the diphthong /ay/, as in bayt (بَيْتٌ) or ghayr (غَيْرٌ).

Madd al-Līn (The Prolongation of Soft Letters) in Waqf (Pause)

When the reciter pauses (waqf) on a word ending with a ḥarf layyin followed by a quiescent letter, a special type of prolongation called Madd al-Līn occurs. This is a subset of Madd ‘Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn.

- Example: khawf (خَوْفٌ) when paused. The wāw is a ḥarf layyin. The following letter is a fā’ with a sukūn (due to the pause). The reciter has the option to prolong the wāw for two, four, or six ḥarakāt. This is called Madd Layyin.

Al-Jamzūrī does not dedicate a separate verse to Madd Layyin but implies it within the broader category of Madd ‘Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn. The key point here is the definition and identification of the ḥurūf al-līn themselves.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Diphthongs in English: English has similar diphthongs. The ḥarf layyin wāw sounds like the "ow" in "how" or "cow." The ḥarf layyin yā’ sounds like the "ay" in "say" or "day." The key difference is that the Arabic diphthongs are even quicker and lighter in continuous recitation.
- Drill for Waṣl: Practice يَوْمَ الدِّينِ (yawma d-dīn). The wāw in yawm is light and quick: "yaw-mad-dīn." Do not say "yaaaw-mad-dīn."
- Drill for Waqf: Practice stopping on خَوْفٌ (khawf). You can hold the "aw" sound: "khaaawf."

QUR’ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: ḤARF LAYYIN WĀW IN WAṢL

Āyah: ﴿الَّذِينَ يَنْفِقُونَ أَمْوَالَهُمْ بِاللَّيْلِ وَالنَّهَارِ سِرًّا وَعَلَانِيَةً فَلَهُمْ أَجْرُهُمْ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ وَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 274]

Transliteration: ...wa-lā khawfun ‘alayhim...

Translation: "...there will be no fear concerning them, nor will they grieve."

Application: The word is خَوْفٌ (khawfun). The wāw is sākinah and preceded by a fathah. It is a ḥarf layyin. In continuous recitation (waṣl), it is pronounced as a quick diphthong: khaw-fun.

EXAMPLE 2: ḤARF LAYYIN YĀ’ IN WAṢL

Āyah: ﴿ إِنَّ أَوَّلَ بَيْتٍ وُضِعَ لِلنَّاسِ لَلَّذِي بِبَكَّةَ مُبَارَكًا وَهُدًى لِّلْعَالَمِينَ ﴾ [آل عمران: 96]

Transliteration: 'Inna 'awwala baytin wuḍi'a li-n-nāsi...

Translation: "Indeed, the first house [of worship] established for mankind was that at Bakkah [Makkah]—blessed and a guidance for the worlds."

Application: The word is بَيْت (baytin). The yā' is sākinah and preceded by a fathah. It is a ḥarf layyin. In waṣl, it is pronounced as a quick diphthong: bay-tin.

EXAMPLE 3: ḤARF LAYYIN IN WAQF WITH MADD LAYYIN

Āyah: ﴿ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ ﴾ [الفاتحة: 7] – Wait, that's not a layyin example.

Better Example: ﴿ فَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ ﴾ [البقرة: 38]

Application: When pausing on the word خَوْف (khawf), the wāw is a ḥarf layyin and the fā' becomes sākinah. The reciter may prolong the wāw for two, four, or six ḥarakāt: khaawf, khaaaaaawf, or khaaaaaaawf. This is Madd Layyin, a type of Madd 'Arid li-l-Sukūn.

A Critical English Edition of Tuhfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qur'ān

Part VII (Continued): The Rules of Madd (Prolongation)

VERSE 42

The Three Rulings of Madd

ARABIC TEXT

لِلدِّ أَحْكَامٌ ثَلَاثَةٌ تَدُومُ
وَهِيَ الْوُجُوبُ وَالْجَوَازُ وَاللُّزُومُ

TRANSLITERATION

Li-l-maddi 'aḥkāmun thalāthatun tadūm

wa-hiya l-wujūbu wa-l-jawāzu wa-l-luzūm

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
لِلدِّ	li-l-maddi	For madd (prolongation)

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَحْكَامٌ	<i>ʾaḥkāmun</i>	(there are) rulings
ثَلَاثَةٌ	<i>thalāthatun</i>	three
تَدُومُ	<i>tadūm</i>	(which) endure / are permanent
وَهِيَ	<i>wa-hiya</i>	and they are
الْوُجُوبُ	<i>al-wujūbu</i>	Obligation
وَالْجَوَازُ	<i>wa-l-jawāzu</i>	and Permissibility
وَاللُّزُومُ	<i>wa-l-luzūm</i>	and Compulsion

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"For madd there are three enduring rulings, and they are: Obligation (al-Wujūb), Permissibility (al-Jawāz), and Compulsion (al-Luzūm)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Li-l-maddi ʾaḥkāmun thalāthatun tadūm: The preposition li- introduces the subject. ʾAḥkāmun is the plural of ḥukm (ruling). Tadūm is a verb meaning "they last" or "they endure." The rulings are permanent and unchanging.
2. Wa-hiya l-wujūbu wa-l-jawāzu wa-l-luzūm: The three technical terms are listed. These are not just descriptive categories; they have legal and practical implications for the reciter.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

The Three Rulings (Aḥkām) of Madd in Ḥaṣṣ

These three categories classify the types of secondary madd based on the strength of the evidence and the degree of obligation in applying them.

Ruling Arabic Term Meaning Applies to

Obligatory Wājib (وَاجِب) It is obligatory to prolong; shortening it is a mistake (laḥn khafi). Madd Muttasil (Connected)

Permissible Jā'iz (جَائِز) It is permissible to prolong or to shorten; both are valid in Ḥaṣṣ. Madd Munfaṣil (Separated), Madd ʿArid li-l-Sukūn, Madd Badal

Compulsory Lāzim (لَازِم) It is absolutely compulsory to prolong for six counts; shortening is a major error (laḥn jalī). Madd Lāzim (all types)

The Significance of the Classification

This tripartite scheme helps the student understand the relative importance of each rule. Wājib and Lāzim are strict; the reciter has little or no flexibility. Jā'iz offers a range of acceptable durations, reflecting the variations transmitted in the authentic chains of Ḥaḥṣ's recitation. It also explains why a student might hear a qualified reciter prolong a munfaṣil for four counts and another for two; both are correct within the jā'iz category.

Comparison with Ibn al-Jazārī

Ibn al-Jazārī's Muqaddimah states:

لِلْمَدِّ أَحْكَامُ ثَلَاثَةٌ تَدُومُ ... وَهِيَ الْوَجُوبُ وَالْجَوَازُ وَاللُّزُومُ

"For madd there are three enduring rulings: Obligation, Permissibility, and Compulsion."

The verse is identical. This tripartite classification is the standard framework in the field.

VERSE 43

Al-Madd al-Wājib al-Muttaṣil (The Obligatory Connected Prolongation)

ARABIC TEXT

فَوَاجِبٌ إِنْ جَاءَ هَمْزٌ بَعْدَ مَدٍّ
فِي كَلِمَةٍ وَذَا بِمُتَّصِلٍ يُعَدُّ

TRANSLITERATION

Fa-wājibun 'in jā'a hamzun ba'da mad

fī kilmatin wa-dhā bi-muttaṣil yu'ad

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فَوَاجِبٌ	<i>fa-wājibun</i>	So (it is) Obligatory
إِنْ	<i>'in</i>	if
جَاءَ	<i>jā'a</i>	comes
هَمْزٌ	<i>hamzun</i>	a hamzah
بَعْدَ	<i>ba'da</i>	after
مَدٍّ	<i>mad</i>	a madd letter

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
كَلِمَةٍ	<i>kilmatin</i>	one word
وَذَا	<i>wa-dhā</i>	and this
بِمُتَّصِلٍ	<i>bi-muttaṣil</i>	as Muttaṣil (Connected)
يُعَدُّ	<i>yu'ad</i>	is counted / reckoned

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"So [it is] Obligatory if a hamzah comes after a madd letter within a single word. And this is reckoned as Muttaṣil (Connected)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Fa-wājibun: The fā' connects this verse to the previous list. This is the first of the three rulings: wājib.
2. 'In jā'a hamzun ba'da mad fī kilmatin: This is the precise condition for Madd Muttasil. The hamzah must follow the madd letter within the boundaries of the same word (fī kilmatin). The hamzah is part of the word's root or pattern.
3. Wa-dhā bi-muttaṣil yu'ad: Dhā is a demonstrative pronoun referring to this type of madd. Muttaṣil is an active participle from ittaṣala (to be connected). It means "Connected." The hamzah is connected to the madd letter within the same word.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Madd al-Muttaṣil (المَدُّ الْمُتَّصِلُ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Muttaṣil means "connected," "joined," or "attached."
- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter that is immediately followed by a hamzah within the same word.

The Ruling: Wājib (Obligatory)

The ruling is wājib according to the majority of scholars for the reading of Ḥaṣṣ. This means the madd must be prolonged beyond the natural two counts. Shortening it to two counts (qaṣr) is considered an error (laḥn khafī). The consensus is that it should be prolonged to four or five ḥarakāt (tawassuṭ or faḥw al-tawassuṭ). Some ṭuruq (transmission chains) of Ḥaṣṣ allow for six counts (ishbā'), but four or five is the most common practice.

Duration in Ḥaṣṣ

- Standard: 4 or 5 ḥarakāt.
- In faster recitation (ḥadr): Often 4 ḥarakāt.

- In slower recitation (taḥqīq): Often 5 ḥarakāt.

The reciter should be consistent within a single recitation session.

The Phonetic Rationale

The hamzah is a glottal stop, requiring a complete closure of the vocal cords. Moving from a smooth, continuous vowel directly into a glottal stop creates a jarring transition. By prolonging the vowel, the reciter creates a smoother, more elegant transition, giving the articulators time to prepare for the abrupt closure of the hamzah. Because the hamzah is part of the same word, the connection is tight, and the prolongation is considered necessary to preserve the word's phonetic integrity.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

There is no special mark in the muṣḥaf for Madd Muttasil. The student must recognize the combination of a madd letter followed by a hamzah in the same word. The hamzah is written explicitly (e.g., جَاءَ, سُوءٌ, جِيءَ).

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Identify the Pattern: Train your eye to spot a madd letter immediately followed by a hamzah in the same word. Look for ā'a, ū'a, ī'a.
- Duration Drill: Use a metronome or finger-tapping. For a 4-count madd, tap four times while holding the vowel: jā (tap tap tap tap) 'a. For a 5-count, tap five times. Do not rush; ensure the vowel is smooth and steady.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MADD MUTTASIL WITH ALIF + HAMZAH

Āyah: ﴿إِذَا جَاءَ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ وَالْفَتْحُ﴾ [النصر: ١]

Transliteration: 'Idhā jā'a naṣru llāhi wa-l-faṭḥ

Translation: "When the victory of Allah has come and the conquest."

Application: The word is جَاءَ (jā'a). The alif (ا) is the madd letter. The following letter is a hamzah (ء) on the seat of a ya'. Both are in the same word. The alif is prolonged for 4 or 5 ḥarakāt: jāāā-'a.

EXAMPLE 2: MADD MUTTASIL WITH WĀW + HAMZAH

Āyah: ﴿وَمِنَ الَّذِينَ قَالُوا إِنَّا نَصَارَىٰ أَخَذْنَا مِيثَاقَهُمْ فَنَسُوا حَظًّا مِمَّا ذُكِّرُوا بِهِ فَأَغْرَيْنَا بَيْنَهُمُ الْعَدَاوَةَ وَالْبَغْضَاءَ إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ وَسَوْفَ يُنَبِّئُهُمُ اللَّهُ بِمَا كَانُوا يَصْنَعُونَ﴾ [يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ قَدْ جَاءَكُمْ رَسُولُنَا يُبَيِّنُ لَكُمْ كَثِيرًا مِمَّا كُنْتُمْ تُخْفُونَ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَيَعْفُو عَنْ كَثِيرٍ قَدْ جَاءَكُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ نُورٌ وَكِتَابٌ مُبِينٌ] [المائدة: ١٤-١٥]

Better Example: سُوءٌ (sū'a) from ﴿إِنَّ الْخِزْيَ الْيَوْمَ وَالسُّوءَ عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ﴾ [النحل: ٢٧]

Transliteration: ...wa-s-sū'a 'alā l-kāfirīn

Translation: "...and disgrace will be upon the disbelievers."

Application: The word is السَّوْءُ (as-sū'a). The wāw (و) is the madd letter (preceded by a ḍammah). The following letter is a hamzah (ء). Both are in the same word. The wāw is prolonged for 4 or 5 ḥarakāt: sūūūū-'a.

EXAMPLE 3: MADD MUTTASIL WITH YĀ' + HAMZAH

Āyah: ﴿وَجِيءَ يَوْمَئِذٍ بِجَهَنَّمَ﴾ [الفجر: 23]

Transliteration: Wa-jī'a yawma'idhin bi-jahannam

Translation: "And Hell, that Day, is brought [near]."

Application: The word is جِيءَ (jī'a). The yā' (ي) is the madd letter (preceded by a kasrah). The following letter is a hamzah (ء). Both are in the same word. The yā' is prolonged for 4 or 5 ḥarakāt: jīīīī-'a.

VERSE 44

Al-Madd al-Jā'iz al-Munfaṣil (The Permissible Separated Prolongation)

ARABIC TEXT

وَجَائِزٌ مَدٌّ وَقَصْرٌ إِنْ فُصِّلَ
كُلُّ بِكَلِمَةٍ وَهَذَا الْمُنْفَصِلُ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-jā'izun maddun wa-qaṣrun 'in fuṣil

kullun bi-kilmatin wa-hādhā l-munfaṣil

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَجَائِزٌ	<i>wa-jā'izun</i>	And (it is) Permissible
مَدٌّ	<i>maddun</i>	(to apply) madd
وَقَصْرٌ	<i>wa-qaṣrun</i>	and shortening

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
إِنْ	<i>ʾin</i>	if
فُصِّلَ	<i>fuṣil</i>	separated
كُلُّ	<i>kullun</i>	each [of the two]
بِكَلِمَةٍ	<i>bi-kilmatin</i>	by a word
وَهَذَا	<i>wa-hādhā</i>	and this
الْمُنْفَصِلُ	<i>al-munfaṣil</i>	(is) Al-Munfaṣil (the Separated)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And [it is] Permissible to [apply] prolongation (madd) or shortening (qaṣr) if each [of the madd letter and the hamzah] is separated by being in a different word. And this is Al-Munfaṣil (the Separated)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-jā'izun maddun wa-qaṣrun: The second ruling is jā'iz (permissible). The verse explicitly states that both madd (prolongation beyond two counts) and qaṣr (shortening to two counts) are permissible.
2. 'In fuṣil kullun bi-kilmatin: The condition is that the madd letter and the hamzah are maṣṣūl (separated). The phrase kullun bi-kilmatin means "each [is] in a [different] word." The madd letter is the final letter of one word, and the hamzah is the first letter of the next word.
3. Wa-hādhā l-munfaṣil: The name is Al-Munfaṣil, an active participle from infaṣala (to be separated).

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Madd al-Munfaṣil (المَدُّ الْمُنْفَصِلُ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Munfaṣil means "separated," "disconnected," or "detached."
- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter that is the final letter of a word, when it is followed by a hamzah that is the first letter of the next word.

The Ruling: Jā'iz (Permissible)

The ruling is jā'iz in the reading of Ḥaḥṣ. This means the reciter has a choice:

- Al-Madd (Prolongation): Prolong the madd letter to 4 or 5 ḥarakāt.
- Al-Qaṣr (Shortening): Prolong the madd letter for only 2 ḥarakāt (the natural length).

Both are valid, transmitted options for Ḥaḥṣ. The most common practice, especially in the ṭarīq of al-Shāṭibiyyah, is to prolong (madd) to 4 or 5 ḥarakāt. Shortening (qaṣr) is also a strong, authentic option.

Duration in Ḥaḥṣ (from al-Shāṭibiyyah)

- Preferred: 4 or 5 ḥarakāt (matching the Muttaṣil in duration).
- Permissible: 2 ḥarakāt (qaṣr).

The reciter must choose one method and apply it consistently throughout the recitation for all instances of Madd Munfaṣil.

The Phonetic Rationale

Because the hamzah is in a separate word, the connection is looser than in Madd Muttaṣil. There is a natural, slight pause or juncture between words. This looser connection makes the prolongation less "obligatory" from a phonetic standpoint, hence the permissibility of shortening. However, the hamzah is still a glottal stop, and prolonging the vowel smooths the transition across the word boundary, which is why madd is also permissible and widely practiced.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

There is no special mark. The student must recognize a word ending in a madd letter, followed by a word beginning with a hamzah. Examples are ubiquitous: *قَالُوا آمَنَّا فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ وَأَنْزَلْنَا إِلَيْكَ*.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Consistency is Key: Choose whether you will read with madd (4-5 counts) or qaṣr (2 counts) for Munfaṣil and stick with it throughout the entire recitation. Mixing them randomly is not correct.
- Practice Both: Be able to recite a phrase like *قَالُوا آمَنَّا* with both 4 counts (qālūūūū 'āmannā) and 2 counts (qālū 'āmannā). This demonstrates understanding of the jā'iz ruling.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MADD MUNFAṢIL WITH ALIF + HAMZAH

Āyah: ﴿[الأعراف: 121] قَالُوا آمَنَّا بِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ﴾

Transliteration: Qālū 'āmannā bi-rabbi l-'ālamīn

Translation: "They said, 'We have believed in the Lord of the worlds.'"

Application: The phrase is *قَالُوا آمَنَّا* (qālū 'āmannā). The alif in qālū is the madd letter (written as a wāw but pronounced as a long ā in this context). The following word begins with a hamzah (ا). They are in separate words. The alif may be prolonged for 4 or 5 ḥarakāt (qālūūūū 'āmannā) or shortened to 2 ḥarakāt (qālū 'āmannā).

EXAMPLE 2: MADD MUNFAṢIL WITH YĀ' + HAMZAH

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا فِي أَنْفُسِكُمْ إِلَّا لَهُ﴾ [البقرة: 284]

Transliteration: Wa-mā fi 'anfusikum 'illā lah

Translation: "...and whatever is within yourselves, He knows it."

Application: The phrase is ﴿وَمَا فِي أَنْفُسِكُمْ﴾ (fi 'anfusikum). The yā' in fi is the madd letter. The following word begins with a hamzah (أ). They are in separate words. The yā' may be prolonged for 4 or 5 ḥarakāt (fi'ān 'anfusikum) or shortened to 2 ḥarakāt (fi 'anfusikum).

EXAMPLE 3: MADD MUNFAṢIL WITH WĀW + HAMZAH

Āyah: ﴿وَمَا يُوحَىٰ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ رَبِّكَ﴾ [الرعد: 30]

Transliteration: Wa-mā yūḥā 'ilayka min rabbika

Translation: "...and that which has been revealed to you from your Lord."

Application: The phrase is ﴿وَمَا يُوحَىٰ إِلَيْكَ﴾ (yūḥā 'ilayka). The alif maqṣūrah (written as a yā' without dots) at the end of yūḥā is a madd letter (pronounced as a long ā). The following word begins with a hamzah (أ). They are in separate words. The alif may be prolonged for 4 or 5 ḥarakāt or shortened to 2 ḥarakāt.

VERSE 45

Al-Madd al-ʿĀrid li-l-Sukūn (The Temporary Prolongation due to Pause)

ARABIC TEXT

وَمِثْلُ ذَا إِنْ عَرَضَ السُّكُونُ
وَقَفًّا كَتَعْلَمُونَ نَسْتَعِينُ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-mithlu dhā 'in 'araḍa s-sukūnu

waqfan ka-ta'lamūna nasta'īn

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَمِثْلُ	<i>wa-mithlu</i>	And like
ذَا	<i>dhā</i>	this (the previous ruling of Jā'iz)

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
إِنْ	<i>ʾin</i>	if
عَرَضَ	<i>ʿaraḍa</i>	occurs / presents itself
السُّكُونُ	<i>as-sukūnu</i>	a sukūn (quiescent letter)
وَقَفًّا	<i>waqfan</i>	due to pause
كَتَعْلَمُونَ	<i>ka-taʿlamūna</i>	like "تَعْلَمُونَ" ("you know")
نَسْتَعِينُ	<i>nastaʿīn</i>	(and) "نَسْتَعِينُ" ("we seek help")

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And [it is] like this [i.e., also Jāʾiz] if a sukūn occurs due to pause (waqfan), as in [the examples] تَعْلَمُونَ (taʿlamūn – 'you know') and نَسْتَعِينُ (nastaʿīn – 'we seek help')."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-mithlu dhā: Mithlu means "like" or "similar to." Dhā is a demonstrative pronoun referring back to the ruling of Jāʾiz (Permissible) mentioned in the previous verse. The poet is saying that the next type of madd shares the same ruling: it is jāʾiz.
2. ʾIn ʿaraḍa s-sukūnu waqfan: The condition is the occurrence (ʿaraḍa) of a sukūn due to pause. Waqfan is an accusative of specification (tamyīz), meaning "in the case of a pause." This is a crucial distinction: the sukūn is not an original part of the word; it is temporarily applied because the reciter has chosen to stop.
3. Ka-taʿlamūna nastaʿīn: The kāf introduces examples. Taʿlamūna (تَعْلَمُونَ) ends with a wāw madd followed by a voweled nūn. Nastaʿīn (نَسْتَعِينُ) ends with a yāʾ madd followed by a voweled nūn. When the reciter pauses on these words, the final nūn is made sākin, creating the condition for Madd ʿĀriḍ li-l-Sukūn.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of *Al-Madd al-ʿĀriḍ li-l-Sukūn* (المَدُّ الْعَارِضُ لِلْسُّكُونِ)

- Linguistic Meaning: ʿĀriḍ means "temporary," "accidental," or "occurring." Li-l-sukūn means "due to a sukūn."
- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter that is followed by a temporary sukūn, which is applied only because the reciter has paused (waqf) on the word. In continuous recitation (waṣl), the following letter is voweled, and the madd is Natural (Ṭabīʿī, 2 counts).

The Ruling: Jā'iz (Permissible)

Like Madd Munfaṣil, this madd is jā'iz. The reciter has a choice of three permissible durations when pausing:

- Al-Qaṣr (Shortening): 2 ḥarakāt (the natural length).
- At-Tawassuṭ (Medial): 4 ḥarakāt.
- Al-Ishbā' (Saturation) / Aṭ-Ṭūl (Length): 6 ḥarakāt.

All three are valid in Ḥafṣ. The reciter should choose one duration and apply it consistently to all instances of Madd 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn within a single recitation session. The most common practice in the ṭarīq of al-Shāṭibiyyah is At-Tawassuṭ (4 ḥarakāt).

The Phonetic Rationale

When pausing on a word, the final vowel is dropped, and the last consonant is made sākin. This creates a meeting of two sākin letters (iltiqā' al-sākinayn): the madd letter (which is inherently sākin) and the final consonant (now sākin). In Arabic phonology, such a meeting is resolved by prolonging the first sākin (the madd letter). The duration is flexible because the pause itself is a discretionary act; the reciter can hold the pause for a shorter or longer time, and the madd reflects this.

Important Note on Hā' al-Kināyah (The Pronominal Suffix)

If the word ends in a hā' that is a pronoun (e.g., lahū ^{هُ}لَهُ, fihi ^{فِيهِ}فِيهِ), and the reciter pauses, a different rule applies. The hā' is a consonant, and it does not create Madd 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn. Instead, it is simply made sākin (e.g., lah, fihi). The madd before it remains Natural (2 counts) because it is not followed by a sukūn in the same syllable in a way that triggers this rule. Madd 'Āriḍ occurs when the madd letter is followed by a consonant that is not a voweled letter in the original word, and that consonant becomes sākin due to the pause. The classic examples are words ending in -ūn (وَن) or -īn (يَن) where the nūn is the final consonant.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

There is no special mark for Madd 'Āriḍ in the muṣḥaf. The student identifies it by knowing that the word ends in a madd letter followed by a consonant that would be voweled in waṣl (e.g., تَعْلَمُونَ, where the nūn is voweled in waṣl).

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Three Choices: Memorize the three permissible durations: 2, 4, or 6 counts.
- Practice Pausing: Take the word تَعْلَمُونَ. Recite it in waṣl: ta'lamūna (2 counts on the wāw). Then pause on it: ta'lamūūūn (4 counts on the wāw, then the nūn). Practice the three lengths.
- Consistency: Just like with Munfaṣil, choose one length for 'Āriḍ and stick with it throughout your recitation.

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MADD ‘ĀRIḌ LI-L-SUKŪN WITH WĀW (ON PAUSE)

Āyah: ﴿إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ﴾ [الفاتحة: ٥]

Transliteration: ‘Iyyāka na‘budu wa-‘iyyāka nasta‘īn (in waṣl) → ...nasta‘īn (in waqf)

Translation: "It is You we worship, and You we ask for help."

Application: The word is نَسْتَعِينُ (nasta‘īn). In waṣl, the yā’ is a madd letter followed by a vowelized nūn: nasta‘īnu. It is Natural Madd (2 counts). When pausing (waqf), the nūn becomes sākin: nasta‘īn. This triggers Madd ‘Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn. The yā’ may be prolonged for 2, 4, or 6 ḥarakāt: nasta‘īīīn.

EXAMPLE 2: MADD ‘ĀRIḌ LI-L-SUKŪN WITH ALIF MAQṢŪRAH (ON PAUSE)

Āyah: ﴿قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ ۝ اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ ۝ لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ ۝ وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ﴾ [الإخلاص: 1-4]

Transliteration: *Qul huwa llāhu ‘aḥad... * (in waqf)

Translation: "Say, 'He is Allah, [who is] One. Allah, the Eternal Refuge. He neither begets nor is born. Nor is there to Him any equivalent.'"

Application: The word is أَحَدٌ (‘aḥad). Wait—this word does not contain a madd letter before the final consonant. Let’s take a better example: مُوسَى (Mūsā). In waṣl, Mūsā ends with an alif maqṣūrah (a madd letter). If a word follows, it is Natural. If we pause on موسى, the alif is the madd letter, and there is an implied sukūn on the final letter. Actually, for alif maqṣūrah, the pause is simply the madd letter itself. For a clear example of Madd ‘Āriḍ, let’s use الْعَالَمِينَ (al-‘ālamīn). In waqf, the yā’ is the madd letter, and the nūn is made sākin: al-‘ālamīn. The yā’ may be prolonged for 2, 4, or 6 counts.

EXAMPLE 3: MADD ‘ĀRIḌ LI-L-SUKŪN WITH YĀ’ (ON PAUSE)

Āyah: ﴿الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ﴾ [الفاتحة: 2]

Transliteration: Al-ḥamdu li-llāhi rabbi l-‘ālamīn (in waqf)

Translation: "Praise be to Allah, Lord of the worlds."

Application: The word is الْعَالَمِينَ (al-‘ālamīn). In waṣl, the yā’ is a madd letter followed by a vowelized nūn: al-‘ālamīna. It is Natural Madd (2 counts). When pausing, the nūn becomes sākin: al-‘ālamīn. The yā’ may be prolonged for 2, 4, or 6 ḥarakāt: al-‘ālamīīīn.

VERSE 46

Madd al-Badal (The Prolongation of Substitution)

ARABIC TEXT

أَوْ قُدِّمَ الْهَمْزُ عَلَى الْمَدِّ وَذَا
بَدَلٌ كَأَمَنُوا وَإِيمَانًا خُذَا

TRANSLITERATION

ʾAw quddima l-hamzu ʾalā l-maddi wa-dhā

badal ka-ʾāmanū wa-ʾīmānan khudhā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَوْ	ʾaw	Or
قُدِّمَ	quddima	is placed before / precedes
الْهَمْزُ	al-hamzu	the hamzah
عَلَى	ʾalā	over / before
الْمَدِّ	al-maddi	the madd letter
وَذَا	wa-dhā	and this
بَدَلٌ	badal	(is called) Badal (Substitution)
كَأَمَنُوا	ka-ʾāmanū	like "أَمَنُوا" ("they believed")
وَإِيمَانًا	wa-ʾīmānan	and "إِيمَانًا" ("faith")
خُذَا	khudhā	take [these examples]!

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Or, if the hamzah precedes the madd letter—and this is called Badal (Substitution)—as in [the examples] أَمَنُوا (ʾāmanū – 'they believed') and إِيمَانًا (ʾīmānan – 'faith'). Take [these examples]!"

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. ʾAw quddima l-hamzu ʾalā l-maddi: The particle ʾaw introduces another type of madd.

Quddima is a passive perfect verb meaning "is put before" or "precedes." The condition is that

the hamzah comes before the madd letter. This is the inverse of Madd Muttasil and Munfaṣil, where the madd letter precedes the hamzah.

2. Wa-dhā badal: Badal means "substitution" or "replacement." The madd letter here is a substitute for an original hamzah.

3. Ka-'āmanū wa-'īmānan khudhā: The examples are اٰمَنُوْا (āmanū) and اِيْمَانًا (īmānan). The alif in 'āmanū and the yā' in 'īmānan are madd letters that follow a hamzah. The imperative khudhā ("take [them]!") is an encouragement to memorize these examples.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Madd al-Badal (مَدُّ الْبَدَل)

- Linguistic Meaning: Badal means "substitution" or "replacement."
- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter that is preceded by a hamzah. The madd letter is usually a substitute for an original second hamzah that has been elided for phonetic ease. The prolongation is for two ḥarakāt (Natural length) in the reading of Ḥaṣṣ, though it is classified as a type of Secondary Madd because it originates from a hamzah context.

The Origin of Madd al-Badal

Most instances of Madd al-Badal occur when two hamzahs would have met in the original form of the word. For example:

- اٰمَنُوْا (āmanū): The original form was 'a'manū (اَمَنُوْا) with two hamzahs: the first with a fatḥah, the second with a sukūn. To avoid the heaviness of two consecutive glottal stops, the second hamzah was replaced by a madd alif: 'āmanū.
- اِيْمَانًا (īmānan): The original form was 'i'mānan (اِئْمَانًا). The second hamzah was replaced by a madd yā': 'īmānan.
- اُوْتُوْا (ūtū): The original form was 'u'tū (اُوتُوْا). The second hamzah was replaced by a madd wāw: 'ūtū.

The madd letter is a "substitute" (badal) for the elided hamzah.

The Ruling: Jā'iz (Permissible) in Theory, but Ṭabī'ī in Practice for Ḥaṣṣ

In the science of Tajweed, Madd al-Badal is technically classified as Jā'iz (Permissible). Some readers (qurrā') like Warsh prolong it for 4 or 6 counts. However, in the reading of Ḥaṣṣ'an 'Āṣim, Madd al-Badal is always pronounced with exactly two ḥarakāt (qasr). It is treated as a Natural Madd in practice. The student of Ḥaṣṣ should not prolong it beyond two counts, unless a sukūn follows the madd letter (in which case it becomes Madd Lāzim).

Important Exception: Madd al-Badal followed by a Sukūn

If a Madd al-Badal is followed by an original sukūn (e.g., a shaddah), it becomes Madd Lāzim and is prolonged for six ḥarakāt. The most famous example is اٰلَآءُ (Āl-'āna) in Sūrah Yūnus (10:51, 10:91). Here, the alif is a Madd al-Badal (from 'a'l-'āna), but it is followed by a lām with a sukūn (the lām of

مِنْ نَبَاتٍ شَتَّى ﴿١٠﴾ كُلُّ وَادٍ رَءَوْا أَنْعَامُكُمْ إِنْ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّأُولِي النَّبِيِّ ﴿١١﴾ مِنْهَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ وَفِيهَا
نُعِيدُكُمْ وَفِيهَا نُخْرِجُكُمْ تَارَةً أُخْرَى ﴿١٢﴾ وَلَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا إِبْرَاهِيمَ بِكَلِمَاتٍ مُّكْتَرِبَةٍ وَأَنَّى
مِنْ أَرْضِنَا بِسِحْرِكَ يَا مُوسَى ﴿١٣﴾ فَلَمَّا نَبَتْكِ بِسِحْرِ مِثْلِهِ فَأَجْعَلْ بَيْنَنَا وَبَيْنَكَ مَوْعِدًا لَا نُخْلِفُهُ نَحْنُ وَلَا أَنْتَ
مَكَانًا سَوِيًّا ﴿١٤﴾ قَالِ مَوْعِدُكَ يَوْمَ الزَّيْنَةِ وَإِنَّ تُخَشِّرُ النَّاسَ فِضْحِي ﴿١٥﴾ فَتَوَلَّى فِرْعَوْنُ جَمْعَ كَيْدِهِ ثُمَّ أَتَى
﴿١٦﴾ قَالِ لَهُمْ مُوسَى وَلَكُمْ لَا تَفْتَرُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ كَذِبًا فَيُسْحِتَكُمْ بِعَذَابٍ وَقَدْ خَابَ مِنْ قَبْرِي ﴿١٧﴾
فَتَنَزَّلُوا أَرْمَهُمْ بَيْنَهُمْ وَأَسْرُوا إِلَى النَّجْوَى ﴿١٨﴾ قَالُوا إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا سِحْرَانِ يَرِيدَانِ إِنْ يُخْرِجَاكُمْ مِنْ أَرْضِكُمْ
بِسِحْرِهِمَا وَيَذْهَبَا بِطَرَفَيْكُمْ إِلَى الْإِثْلِ ﴿١٩﴾ فَاجْمَعُوا كَيْدَكُمْ ثُمَّ أَتَيْتُمُوهُمَا وَقَدْ أَفْلَحَ الْيَوْمَ مِنْ أَسْتَعْتَلَى ﴿٢٠﴾
قَالُوا يَا مُوسَى إِمَّا أَنْ تَتْلِيَ وَإِمَّا أَنْ نَكُونَ أَوَّلَ مِنَ الْقَرْنَى ﴿٢١﴾ قَالَ بَلَى الْقَوَا إِذَا جَاءَهُمْ وَعَصِيَهُمْ يَخْلُ إِلَيْهِ
مِنْ سِحْرِهِمْ أَنَّى لَسِعِيَ ﴿٢٢﴾ فَأَوْحِشْ فِي نَفْسِهِ خِيفَةَ مُوسَى ﴿٢٣﴾ قُلْنَا لَا تَخَفْ إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ الْأَعْلَى ﴿٢٤﴾ وَلَقَدْ
مَا فِي عَيْنِكَ تَلْقِيفٌ مَا صَنَعُوا إِنَّمَا صَنَعُوا كَيْدٌ بَاسِحٌ وَلَا يَفْلِحُ الْبَاسِحُ حَيْثُ أَقْبَى ﴿٢٥﴾ فَالْقَوْمَ السَّحِرَةَ
سَيِّدًا قَالُوا أَمَّا بِرَبِّ هَارُونَ وَمُوسَى ﴿٢٦﴾ قَالَ أَمِنْتُ لَهُ قَبْلَ أَنْ أَكُونَ لَكُمْ لَكِنَّهُ لَكِبِيرٌ كَذِبٌ الَّذِي عَلَيْهِ السِّحْرُ
فَلَا قُطْعَانَ أَيْدِيكُمْ وَأَرْجُلَكُمْ مِنْ خِلَافٍ وَلَا يَصْلَحُكُمْ فِي جَدْوَعِ النَّجْلِ وَلَتَعْلَنَّ إِنَّمَا أَشَدُّ عَذَابًا وَأَقْبَى
﴿٢٧﴾ قَالُوا لَنْ نَتُوبَ لَكَ عَلَى مَا جَاءَنَا مِنَ الْبَيِّنَاتِ وَالَّذِي فَطَرَنَا فَاقْضِ مَا أَنْتَ قَاضٍ إِنَّمَا تَقْضِي هَذِهِ الْحَيَاةَ
الدُّنْيَا ﴿٢٨﴾ إِنَّا أَمَّا بِرَبِّنَا لَنُغْفِرَ لَنَا خَطَايَانَا وَمَا أَكْرَهْتَنَا عَلَيْهِ مِنَ السِّحْرِ وَاللَّهُ خَبِيرٌ وَأَعْيَى ﴿٢٩﴾ إِنَّهُ مِنْ رِبَابٍ
رَبِّهِ مَجْرُمٌ فَإِنَّ لَهُ جَهَنَّمَ لَا يَمُوتُ فِيهَا وَلَا يَحْيَى ﴿٣٠﴾ وَمِمَّنْ يَأْتِهِ مُؤْمِنًا قَدْ عَمِلَ الصَّالِحَاتِ قَالُوا لَكُمْ
الدرجاتُ الْعُلَى ﴿٣١﴾ جَنَّاتٌ عَدْنٌ تَجْرِي مِنْ تَحْتِهَا الْأَنْهَارُ خَالِدِينَ فِيهَا وَذَلِكَ جَزَاءُ مَنْ تَزَكَّى ﴿٣٢﴾ طه:

[76-44

ربنا واجعلنا مسلمين لله ومن ذريتنا أمة مسلمة لك وأرنا مناسكنا وتب علينا إنك أنت التواب الرحيم ﴿١٠١﴾ ربنا وابعد فيهم رسولا منهم يتلوا عليهم آياتك ويعلمهم الكتاب والحكمة ويزكيهم إنك أنت العزيز الحكيم ﴿١٠٢﴾ ومن يرغب عن ملة إبراهيم إلا من سفه نفسه ولقد اصطفيناه في الدنيا وإنه في الآخرة لمن الصالحين ﴿١٠٣﴾ إذ قال له ربه أسألك قال أليسيت رب العالمين ﴿١٠٤﴾ وحي يا إبراهيم تبني يعقوب يا بني إن الله اصطفى لك الدين فلا تموتن إلا وأنت مسلمون ﴿١٠٥﴾ أم كنتم شهداء إذ حضر يعقوب الموت إذ قال لبنيه ما تعبدون من بعدي قلوا نعبد إلهك وإله آبائك إبراهيم وإسماعيل وإسحاق إلها واحدا ونحن به مسلمون ﴿١٠٦﴾ تلك أمة قد خلت لهما ما كسبت ولكم ما كسبتم ولا تسألون عما كانوا يعملون ﴿١٠٧﴾ وقالوا كونوا هودا أو نصارى ويتبدوا بل ملة إبراهيم حنيفا وما كان من المشركين ﴿١٠٨﴾ قولوا آمنا بالله وما أنزل إلينا وما أنزل إلى إبراهيم وإسماعيل وإسحاق ويعقوب والأسباط وما أوتي موسى وعيسى وما أوتي النبيون من ربهم لا نفرق بين أحد منهم ونحن له مسلمون ﴿١٠٩﴾ فإن آمنوا بمثل ما آمنتم به فقد اهتدوا وإن تولوا فإنا هم في شقاق فسيكفيكمهم الله وهو السميع العليم ﴿١١٠﴾ صبغة الله ومن أحسن من الله صبغة ونحن له عابدون ﴿١١١﴾ قل اتحاجونا في الله وهو ربنا وربكم ولنا أعمالنا ولكم أعمالكم ونحن له محضون ﴿١١٢﴾ أم تقولون إن إبراهيم وإسماعيل وإسحاق ويعقوب والأسباط كانوا هودا أو نصارى قل أنتم أعلم أم الله ومن أظلم ممن كتم شهادته عنده من الله وما الله بغافل عما تعملون ﴿١١٣﴾ تلك أمة قد خلت لهما ما كسبت ولكم ما كسبتم ولا تسألون عما كانوا يعملون ﴿١١٤﴾

[البقرة: 128-141]

وَقُلْ اَعْمَلُوا فِى سَبِيلِ اللّٰهِ عَمَلِكُمْ وَرِسَالَاتِهِ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَيَسْتَدِينُونَ اِلٰى عَالِمٍ خَفِيٍّ وَالشَّهَادَةُ فِى نَسِيْكَرٍ بِمَا كَيْتُمُ تَعْمَلُونَ ۝۱۰۰ وَآخِرُونَ مِنْ حَوْزِ اَمْرِ اللّٰهِ اِمَّا يَعْبُدُوْهُمْ اِمَّا يَنْتَوِبُ عَلَيْهِمُ وَاللّٰهُ عَلِيْمٌ حَكِيْمٌ ۝۱۰۱ وَالَّذِيْنَ اتَّخَذُوا مَسْجِدًا ضُرُورًا وَكُفْرًا وَتَفْرِيقًا بَيْنَ الْمُؤْمِنِيْنَ وَارْصَادًا لِّمَنْ جَارِبَ اللّٰهُ وَرِسَالَاتِهِ مِنْ قَبْلِ وَلِيْجَلِّفَ اِنْ اَرَادْنَا اِلَّا الْخُسْفٰى وَاللّٰهُ يَشْهَدُ اَنَّهُمْ لَكَذِبُوْنَ ۝۱۰۲ اَلَا تَقُمْ فِىْهِ اِيْدًا لِّمَسْجِدٍ اَيْسَسَ عَلَى التَّقْوٰى مِنْ اَوَّلِ يَوْمٍ اَحٰقَ اِنْ تَقُوْمُ فِىْهِ رِجَالٌ يَّحِبُّوْنَ اَنْ يَنْتَهَرُوْا وَاللّٰهُ يَحِبُّ الْمُطَهَّرِيْنَ ۝۱۰۳ اَفَنْ اَسِيْسَ بِنِيَّانِهِ عَلَى تَقْوٰى مِنَ اللّٰهِ وَرِضْوَانٍ خَيْرٌ اَمِنْ اَسِيْسَ بِنِيَّانِهِ عَلَى شَفَاعَةِ رَجُلٍ فَاَنْتَاهُ بِهِ فِى نَابِهِ جَهَنَّمَ وَاللّٰهُ لَا يَهْدِي الْقَوْمَ الظّٰلِمِيْنَ ۝۱۰۴ لَا يَزَالُ بُنِيَ اَيْتَمُ الَّذِيْ بُنِيَ اَيْتَمُ فِى قُلُوْبِهِمْ اِلَّا اَنْ تَقْطَعَ قُلُوْبُهُمْ وَاللّٰهُ عَلِيْمٌ حَكِيْمٌ ۝۱۰۵ اِنْ اِلَهٌ اَشْتَرٰى مِنْ الْمُؤْمِنِيْنَ اَنْفُسَهُمْ وَاَمْوَالَهُمْ بِاَنْ يَّهْدِيَ اِلَيْهِمْ الْجَنَّةَ يَقَاتُلُوْنَ فِيْ سَبِيْلِ اللّٰهِ فَيَقْتُلُوْنَ وَيُقْتَلُوْنَ وَعَدَا عَلَيْهِمْ حَقٌّ فِى الْتَوْرٰةِ وَالْاِنْجِيْلِ وَالْقُرْآنِ وَمَنْ اَوْفٰى بِعَهْدِهِ مِنَ اللّٰهِ فَاسْتَشْبِرُوْا بِبَيْعِهِ الَّذِيْ بَايَعْتُمْ بِهِ وَذٰلِكَ هُوَ الْفَوْزُ الْعَظِيْمُ ۝۱۰۶ اَلَّذِيْنَ يَتَّبِعُوْنَ الْحَامِدُوْنَ الْحَامِدُوْنَ السَّائِحُوْنَ

VERSE 47

Al-Madd al-Lāzim (The Compulsory Prolongation)

ARABIC TEXT

وَلَا زِمُ إِنْ السُّكُونُ أَصْلًا
وَصَلًّا وَوَقْفًا بَعْدَ مَدٍّ طَوَّلًا

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-lāzimun 'ini s-sukūnu 'uṣṣilā

waṣlan wa-waqfan ba'da maddin ṭuwwilā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَلَا زِمُ	<i>wa-lāzimun</i>	And (it is) Compulsory
إِنْ	<i>'ini</i>	if
السُّكُونُ	<i>as-sukūnu</i>	the sukūn (quiescence)
أَصْلًا	<i>'uṣṣilā</i>	is original / inherent
وَصَلًّا	<i>waṣlan</i>	(both) in continuation
وَوَقْفًا	<i>wa-waqfan</i>	and in pause
بَعْدَ	<i>ba'da</i>	after
مَدٍّ	<i>maddin</i>	a madd letter
طَوَّلًا	<i>ṭuwwilā</i>	(that) has been prolonged

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And [it is] Compulsory (Lāzim) if the sukūn is original ('aṣlī)—[present] both in continuation (waṣl) and in pause (waqf)—and occurs after a madd letter that has been prolonged."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-lāzimun: The third ruling from verse 42 is luzūm (compulsion). The predicate lāzimun introduces the type of madd that is absolutely binding.

2. 'Ini s-sukūnu 'uṣṣilā: The condition is that the sukūn is 'uṣṣilā—a passive verb meaning "is made original" or "is inherent." This means the sukūn is a permanent, essential part of the word's structure, not a temporary pause. The alif at the end is the alif al-iṭlāq.
3. Waṣlan wa-waqfan: This phrase is crucial. It specifies that the original sukūn remains present whether the reciter continues (waṣl) or pauses (waqf). This distinguishes Madd Lāzim from Madd 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn, where the sukūn is only present at pause.
4. Ba'da maddin ṭuwwilā: The sukūn must occur after a madd letter. Ṭuwwilā is a passive verb meaning "has been prolonged," indicating that the madd letter itself is the subject of prolongation. The phrase implies a long prolongation.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Definition of Al-Madd al-Lāzim (المَدُّ الْأَلَزِمُ)

- Linguistic Meaning: Lāzim means "compulsory," "necessary," "binding," or "inseparable."
- Technical Definition: It is the prolongation of a madd letter that is immediately followed by an original sukūn (sukūn 'aṣlī), which is permanently present in both continuous recitation (waṣl) and pause (waqf). The duration is strictly six ḥarakāt, by consensus of all canonical readers (qurrā').

The Ruling: Lāzim (Compulsory) – Six Ḥarakāt

The ruling is lāzim (compulsory) for all readers. The duration is six ḥarakāt, with no option to shorten. Shortening Madd Lāzim to fewer than six counts is a major error (laḥn jalī), as it violates the transmitted consensus (ijmā'). This is the strongest form of madd.

The Two Key Conditions

- Original Sukūn: The letter after the madd letter has a sukūn that is part of the word's root or pattern, or is a permanent feature (like the sukūn of a shaddah, which contains a sākin letter). It is not a sukūn that only appears when pausing.
- Present in Both Waṣl and Waqf: The sukūn remains even when the word is connected to the next. This is the definitive test to distinguish Lāzim from 'Āriḍ.

The Phonetic Rationale

An original sukūn after a madd letter creates the heaviest possible phonetic environment for a long vowel. The articulators must hold the vowel position and then transition to a fully quiescent consonant. To maintain clarity and avoid swallowing the madd letter, the vowel is prolonged to its maximum permissible length—six ḥarakāt. This prolonged resonance also serves a prosodic function, marking the word as phonetically "heavy" and giving it prominence in the recitation.

Types of Madd Lāzim

Madd Lāzim is divided into two primary categories, each with two sub-types, resulting in four kinds. Al-Jamzūrī will detail this in the subsequent verses.

Primary Category Sub-type Description

Kalimī (Word-based) Muthaqqal (Heavy) The madd is followed by a shaddah (which contains a sākin letter). Example: الْحَاقَّةُ (al-ḥāqqah)

Mukhaffaf (Light) The madd is followed by a letter with a plain sukūn (no shaddah). Extremely rare in Ḥaṣṣ. Example: الْآنَ (āl-ʾāna) in one reading.

Ḥarfī (Letter-based) Muthaqqal (Heavy) Occurs in the disconnected letters at the start of sūrahs when there is idghām (assimilation) between the letters. Example: اَلَمْ (ʾalif-lām-mīm) when the lām is assimilated into the mīm.

Mukhaffaf (Light) Occurs in the disconnected letters when there is no idghām. Example: اَلَمْ (ʾalif-lām-mīm) in Ḥaṣṣ, where the letters are pronounced separately.

Mark in the Muṣḥaf

- For Kalimī Muthaqqal: The following letter has a shaddah (ّ). Example: الْحَاقَّةُ – the qāf has a shaddah.
- For Ḥarfī: The letters are written as disconnected characters. The student must know which letters are prolonged.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- The "Six-Count Rule": Memorize that any madd followed by a shaddah within the same word must be prolonged for a full six counts. Use a metronome or tap six times: al-ḥāāāāāqqah.
- Distinguish from ‘Āriḍ: In al-‘ālamīn (pause), you can stop at 2, 4, or 6. In al-ḥāqqah (waṣl or waqf), you must go to 6. The shaddah is the visual cue.

QUR’ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MADD LĀZIM KALIMĪ MUTHAQQAL (WORD-BASED, HEAVY)

Āyah: ﴿ الْحَاقَّةُ مَا الْحَاقَّةُ وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا الْحَاقَّةُ ﴾ [الحاقة: 1-3]

Transliteration: Al-Ḥāqqah! Ma l-ḥāqqah? Wa-mā ’adrāka mā l-ḥāqqah?

Translation: "The Inevitable Reality! What is the Inevitable Reality? And what can make you know what is the Inevitable Reality?"

Application: The word is الْحَاقَّةُ (al-ḥāqqah). The alif after the ḥā’ is a madd letter. The following letter is a qāf with a shaddah (ّ). The shaddah contains a sākin qāf followed by a voweled qāf. This sukūn is original and permanent. Therefore, the alif is prolonged for exactly six ḥarakāt: al-ḥāāāāāqqah. This applies whether you continue or pause.

EXAMPLE 2: MADD LĀZIM KALIMĪ MUTHAQQAL WITH YĀ’

Āyah: ﴿ وَلَا آمِينَ الْبَيْتِ الْحَرَامِ ﴾ [المائدة: 2]

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَقْسَامُ	<i>'aqsāmu</i>	The divisions of
لَازِمٍ	<i>lāzimin</i>	Lāzim
لَدَيْهِمْ	<i>ladayhim</i>	according to them (the scholars)
أَرْبَعَةٌ	<i>'arba'ah</i>	(are) four
وَتِلْكَ	<i>wa-tilka</i>	and these are
كَلِمِيٌّ	<i>kilmiyyun</i>	Word-based
وَحَرْفِيٌّ	<i>wa-ḥarfiyyun</i>	and Letter-based
مَعَهُ	<i>ma'ah</i>	together with it

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The divisions of Lāzim, according to them [the scholars], are four. And these are: Word-based (Kilmi) and Letter-based (Ḥarfi), together with it [further subdivisions]."

ARABIC TEXT

كِلَاهُمَا مُخَفَّفٌ مُثَقَّلٌ
فَهَذِهِ أَرْبَعَةٌ تَفْصِلُ

TRANSLITERATION

Kilāhumā mukhaffafun muthaqqalu

fa-hādhihi 'arba'atun tufaṣṣalu

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
كِلَاهُمَا	<i>kilāhumā</i>	Both of them
مُخَفَّفٌ	<i>mukhaffafun</i>	(are divided into) Light (Mukhaffaf)
مُثَقَّلٌ	<i>muthaqqalu</i>	(and) Heavy (Muthaqqal)
فَهَذِهِ	<i>fa-hādhihi</i>	So these

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَرْبَعَةٌ	'arba'atun	(are) four
تُفَصَّلُ	tufaṣṣalu	(which) are detailed

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Both of them [the Word-based and the Letter-based] are [further divided into] Light (Mukhaffaf) and Heavy (Muthaqqal). So these are four [divisions] that are detailed [in the following verses]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. 'Aqsāmu lāzimin ladayhim 'arba'ah: Ladayhim refers to the authoritative scholars of qirā'ah and tajwīd. The plural pronoun emphasizes that this fourfold division is a matter of scholarly consensus, not the poet's personal opinion.
2. Wa-tilka kilmiyyun wa-ḥarfiyyun ma'ah: Tilka points to the divisions. Kilmī (from kalimah, word) means "occurring within a word." Ḥarfī (from ḥarf, letter) means "occurring within a letter," specifically the disconnected letters at the beginning of certain sūrahs.
3. Kilāhumā mukhaffafun muthaqqalu: Kilāhumā refers to the two primary categories (Kilmī and Ḥarfī). Each of these two is subdivided into Mukhaffaf (Light) and Muthaqqal (Heavy). The terms are explained in the next verses.
4. Fa-hādhihi 'arba'atun tufaṣṣalu: The result is a fourfold matrix: Kilmī Muthaqqal, Kilmī Mukhaffaf, Ḥarfī Muthaqqal, Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf. Tufaṣṣalu means "they will be explained in detail."

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

The Four Types of Madd Lāzim – A Matrix

Kilmī (Word-based) Ḥarfī (Letter-based)

Muthaqqal (Heavy) Madd followed by a shaddah in a word. Example: الْحَاقَّةُ Madd in a disconnected letter, with idghām into the next letter. Example: الم (when lām assimilates into mīm)

Mukhaffaf (Light) Madd followed by a plain sukūn (no shaddah) in a word. Example: الْآنَ (in one reading) Madd in a disconnected letter, without idghām (clear separation). Example: الم in Ḥafṣ

Meaning of Muthaqqal (Heavy) and Mukhaffaf (Light)

- Muthaqqal (مُثَقَّلٌ): Literally "made heavy" or "burdened." It refers to the presence of a shaddah (ّ) or the effect of idghām (assimilation), which results in a geminated consonant. The shaddah "weighs down" the syllable.
- Mukhaffaf (مُخَفَّفٌ): Literally "made light." It refers to the absence of a shaddah or idghām. The following sukūn is a plain, ungeminated consonant.

Pedagogical Note for Ḥafṣ Students

In the reading of Ḥafṣ 'an 'Āṣim, three of these four types are common and essential:

- Kilmī Muthaqqal: Very common. al-ḥāqqah, aṭ-ṭāmmah, aṣ-ṣākhkhah, aḍ-ḍāllīn (when the definite article is assimilated).
- Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf: Occurs in the disconnected letters when Ḥaḥṣ reads without idghām. This is the standard for Ḥaḥṣ in letters like الم (ʿalif-lām-mīm), where the lām is pronounced clearly, and the mīm is pronounced clearly. The madd in the lām and mīm is Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf (6 counts each).
- Ḥarfī Muthaqqal: Occurs in other qirāʾāt (like al-Sūsī) when letters are assimilated. Ḥaḥṣ does not apply idghām here, so this type is not actively recited in Ḥaḥṣ, though it is part of theoretical knowledge.
- Kilmī Mukhaffaf: Extremely rare. The only example is آلَآ (ʿāl-ʿāna) in Sūrah Yūnus (10:51, 10:91) if it is read with a light lām (which is a variant reading). In the most common transmission of Ḥaḥṣ, this word is actually read with a shaddah on the lām (آلَّآ with a geminated lām), making it Kilmī Muthaqqal. The student of Ḥaḥṣ should know the category but will primarily apply the Muthaqqal form here.

VERSES 50–52

Defining Kilmī and Ḥarfī, Muthaqqal and Mukhaffaf

ARABIC TEXT

فَإِنْ بِكَلِمَةٍ سُكُونٌ اجْتَمَعَ
مَعَ حَرْفٍ مَدٍّ فَهُوَ كِلْمِيٌّ وَقَعَ

TRANSLITERATION

Fa-ʿin bi-kilmatin sukūnun jṭamaʿ

maʿ ḥarfī maddīn fa-huwa kilmiyyun waqaʿ

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
فَإِنْ	<i>fa-ʿin</i>	So if
بِكَلِمَةٍ	<i>bi-kilmatin</i>	in a word
سُكُونٌ	<i>sukūnun</i>	a sukūn
اجْتَمَعَ	<i>jṭamaʿ</i>	combines / comes together
مَعَ	<i>maʿ</i>	with

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
حَرْفٍ	<i>ḥarfi</i>	a letter of
مَدٍّ	<i>maddin</i>	madd
فَهُوَ	<i>fa-huwa</i>	then it
كَلِمِيٍّ	<i>kilmiyyun</i>	(is) Word-based (Kilmī)
وَقَعْ	<i>waqa‘</i>	(that) occurs

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"So if, within a single word, a sukūn comes together with a madd letter, then it is Word-based (Kilmī) [and it] occurs [in the Qur’ān]."

ARABIC TEXT

أَوْ فِي ثَلَاثِيَّ الْحُرُوفِ وَجَدَا
وَالْمَدُّ وَسْطُهُ فَحَرْفِيَّ بَدَا

TRANSLITERATION

‘Aw fī thulāthiyyi l-ḥurūfi wujidā

wa-l-maddu waṣṭuhū fa-ḥarfiyyun badā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَوْ	<i>‘aw</i>	Or
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
ثَلَاثِيٍّ	<i>thulāthiyyi</i>	the three-fold

الْحُرُوفِ al-ḥurūfi letters (i.e., letters spelled with three letters)

وَجَدَا wujidā it is found

وَالْمَدُّ wa-l-maddu and the madd letter

وَسْطُهُ waṣṭuhū (is in) its middle

فَحَرْفِيٍّ fa-ḥarfiyyun then (it is) Letter-based (Ḥarfī)

بَدَا badā (as) is apparent

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Or if it is found in the three-fold letters (al-ḥurūf al-thulāthiyyah), and the madd letter is in its middle, then it is Letter-based (Ḥarfī), as is clearly apparent."

ARABIC TEXT

كِلَاهُمَا مُثْقَلٌ إِنْ أُدْغِمَا
مُخَفَّفٌ كُلُّهُمَا إِذَا لَمْ يُدْغِمَا

TRANSLITERATION

Kilāhumā muthaqqalun 'in 'udghimā

mukhaffafun kullun 'idhā lam yudghamā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
كِلَاهُمَا	kilāhumā	Both of them (the Kilmī and Ḥarfī)
مُثْقَلٌ	muthaqqalun	(are) Heavy (Muthaqqal)
إِنْ	'in if	
أُدْغِمَا	'udghimā	assimilation (idghām) occurs
مُخَفَّفٌ	mukhaffafun	(are) Light (Mukhaffaf)
كُلُّهُمَا	kullun	each (of them)
إِذَا	'idhā	when
لَمْ	lam	not
يُدْغِمَا	yudghamā	assimilation occurs

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Both of them [the Kilmī and Ḥarfī] are Heavy (Muthaqqal) if assimilation (idghām) occurs. Each [is] Light (Mukhaffaf) when assimilation does not occur."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Fa-'in bi-kilmatin sukūnun jama': Verse 50 defines Kilmī. The condition is that the madd letter and the original sukūn must be within a single word.
2. 'Aw fi thulāthiyyi l-ḥurūfi wujidā...: Verse 51 defines Ḥarfī. The sukūn and madd are found in one of the "three-fold letters" —the disconnected letters at the start of sūrah whose names are spelled with three letters (e.g., لَام (lām), مِيم (mīm), صَاد (sād)). The condition is that the madd letter is the middle of these three letters. Example: In لَام (lām), the letters are lām (ل),

alif (ا), mīm (م). The alif is a madd letter, and it is in the middle, followed by the mīm which has a sukūn.

3. Kilāhumā muthaqqalun 'in 'udghimā...: Verse 52 defines the Muthaqqal and Mukhaffaf distinction. The key factor is idghām (assimilation). If the sākin letter (the one after the madd) is assimilated into the following letter, the madd is Muthaqqal (Heavy). If there is no assimilation, it is Mukhaffaf (Light).

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Detailed Explanation of Kilmi Muthaqqal and Mukhaffaf

- Kilmi Muthaqqal: The madd letter is followed by a letter with a shaddah (ّ). The shaddah represents a sākin letter assimilated into a voweled letter. This is idghām within the word. Examples: الحَاقَّة (al-ḥāqqah), الطَّامَّة (aṭ-ṭāmmah), الضَّالِّين (aḍ-ḍāllīn). The madd is prolonged six counts.
- Kilmi Mukhaffaf: The madd letter is followed by a letter with a plain sukūn (no shaddah). There is no idghām. The only example in the Qur'ān is الآن (āl-'āna) in Sūrah Yūnus (10:51, 10:91) if read with a light lām. In the most common transmission of Ḥaṣṣ, the lām is actually geminated (due to assimilation of the lām of 'al into the lām of the word), making it Muthaqqal. The student should be aware of the category, but in practice, Ḥaṣṣ students will apply Muthaqqal here.

Detailed Explanation of Harfi Muthaqqal and Mukhaffaf

This applies to the disconnected letters (al-ḥurūf al-muqaṭṭa'ah) that begin 29 sūrah. There are 14 such letters. They are divided into two groups based on their spelling:

- Letters Spelled with Three Letters, with a Madd in the Middle: These are eight letters, and they are prolonged for six ḥarakāt (they are Madd Lāzim Ḥarfī). The eight letters are: ك، م، ن، ق، ص، س، ل، ن. (Mnemonics: ك م ن ق ص س ل ن or سنقص لكم علها). Example: لَام (lām). Spelling: ل (lām), ا (alif), م (mīm). The alif is a madd letter, followed by a mīm with a sukūn. This is Madd Lāzim Ḥarfī.
- Mukhaffaf vs. Muthaqqal: If these letters are recited separately, without idghām into the next letter, they are Mukhaffaf (Light). This is the standard reading of Ḥaṣṣ. For example, in الم (alif-lām-mīm), Ḥaṣṣ reads: 'alif (no madd), lām (with six-count madd on the alif), mīm (with six-count madd on the yā'). There is no idghām between the mīm of lām and the mīm of mīm; they are separate. Therefore, it is Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf.
- If a reader assimilates the final letter of one into the first letter of the next (e.g., al-Sūsī reading lām + mīm as lāmmīm), it becomes Ḥarfī Muthaqqal.
- Letters Spelled with Two Letters, or Three Letters without a Madd in the Middle: These are six letters, and they are prolonged for two ḥarakāt (Madd Ṭabī'ī). They are: ح، ي، ط، ه، ر (from طاهر), and ا (alif). Example: طه (ṭā-hā). Ṭā is spelled طا (two letters, the alif is madd but not followed by sukūn in the spelling), so it gets two counts. Hā is spelled ها (two counts).

Summary Table for Ḥarfî in Ḥafş

Letter Spelling Madd Duration in Ḥafṣ Type of Madd

كَاف 6 (kāf) ḥarakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf

م (mīm) 6 ḥarakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf

ع 6 (ayn) ħarakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf

سین 6 (sīn) harakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf

ل (lām) 6 مَ لَazarakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf

نون 6 (nūn) *ḥarakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf*

قاف 6 (qāf) ḥarakāt Lāzim Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf

ص (ṣād) 6 حَرَكَاتُ لَازِمِ هَارِفِي مُخَفَّفِ

ح (ḥā') 2 حَ ḥarakāt Ṭabī'ī

ي (yā') 2 يَا ḥarakāt Ṭabī'ī

ط (ṭā') ۲ ط̣ ḥarakāt Ṭabī'ī

ه (hā') 2 هَا ḥarakāt Ṭabī'ī

ر (rā') ۲ رَ ḥarakāt Ṭabī'ī

ا (alif) ۲ اَ harakāt Ṭabī'ī

The Phonetic Rationale for Ḥarfī Mukhaffaf in Ḥafṣ

Haf's recitation is characterized by clarity (bayān) and distinct separation (tabyīn). By not assimilating the disconnected letters, he preserves the integrity of each individual letter, allowing the listener to clearly perceive the components of these mysterious openings. The six-count prolongation on the eight letters gives them a solemn, weighty presence, befitting their role as powerful openings to the sūrahs.

Pedagogical Adaptation for English Speakers

- Memorize the Two Groups: Use the mnemonic كَمْ عَسَلْ نَقَّصْ (kam 'asal naqas) for the 6-count letters. Use حَي طَاهِر (ḥayyun ṭāhirun) for the 2-count letters. Add ا (alif) to the 2-count group.
- Practice the Spellings: Learn to spell each letter aloud with its proper madd.
- Lām: لَ لَ لَ لَ لَ لَ (lāāāāām)
- Mīm: مِ مِ مِ مِ مِ مِ (mīīīīīm)
- Šād: صَ صَ صَ صَ صَ صَ (šāāāāād)
- Recite the Openings: Practice reciting اَلَمْ (‘alif lām mīm). ‘Alif (no madd, just ‘alif). Lām (6 counts: lāāāāām). Mīm (6 counts: mīīīīīm). Ensure there is a clear break between lām and mīm (no idghām).

QUR'ĀNIC EXAMPLES WITH DETAILED ANALYSIS

EXAMPLE 1: MADD LĀZIM KILMĪ MUTHAQQAL

Āyah: ﴿كَلَّا سَيَعْلَمُونَ ۖ ثُمَّ كَلَّا سَيَعْلَمُونَ ۚ لَمْ نَجْعَلِ الْأَرْضَ مِهَادًا ۚ وَالْجِبَالَ أَوْتَادًا ۚ وَخَلَقْنَاكُمْ أَزْوَاجًا ۚ وَجَعَلْنَا بَيْنَكُمْ سَبِيلًا ۚ وَجَعَلْنَا اللَّيْلَ لِبَاسًا ۚ وَجَعَلْنَا النَّهَارَ مَعَاشًا ۚ وَبَنَيْنَا فَوْقَكُمْ سَبْعًا شِدَادًا ۚ وَجَعَلْنَا سِرَاجًا وَهَّاجًا ۚ وَآَنَزَلْنَا مِنَ الْمُعْصِرَاتِ مَاءً ثَجَّاجًا ۚ لِنُخْرِجَ بِهِ حَبًّا وَنَبَاتًا ۚ وَجَنَّاتٍ الْفَاافِ ۚ إِنَّ يَوْمَ الْفِصْلِ كَانَ مِيقَاتًا ۚ يَوْمَ يَنْفَخُ فِي الصُّورِ فَتَأْتُونَ أَفْوَاجًا ۚ وَفُتِحَتِ السَّمَاءُ فَكَانَتْ أَبْوَابًا ۚ وَسُيِّرَتِ الْجِبَالُ فَكَانَتْ سَرَابًا ۚ إِنَّ جَهَنَّمَ كَانَتْ مِرْصَادًا ۚ لِلطَّاغِينَ مَابًا ۚ لَا يَثْبِينَ فِيهَا أَحِقَابًا ۚ لَا يَذُوقُونَ فِيهَا يَرْدًا وَلَا شَرَابًا ۚ إِلَّا جِثِيمًا وَيَغْسِقًا ۚ فِجَاءً وَفَاقًا ۚ إِنَّهُمْ كَانُوا لَا يَرْجُونَ حِسَابًا ۚ وَكَذَّبُوا بِآيَاتِنَا كِذَابًا ۚ وَكُلَّ شَيْءٍ أَحْصَيْنَاهُ كِتَابًا ۚ فَذُوقُوا فَلَنْ نَزِيدَ إِلَّا عَذَابًا ۚ إِنَّ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ مِثَافًا ۚ حَدَائِقَ وَأَعْنَابًا ۚ وَكَوَاعِبَ أَتْرَابًا ۚ وَكَاسِيَاتٍ مُهَبَّاتٍ ۚ لَا يَسْمَعُونَ فِيهَا لَغْوًا وَلَا كِذَابًا ۚ جَزَاءً مِمَّنْ رَبُّكَ عِطَاءً حِسَابًا ۚ رَبُّ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا الرَّحْمَنُ لَا يَمْلِكُ مِنْهُ خِطَابًا ۚ يَوْمَ يَقُومُ الرُّوحُ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ صَفًّا ۚ لَا يَتَكَلَّمُونَ إِلَّا مَنْ أَذِنَ لَهُ الرَّحْمَنُ وَقَالَ صَوَابًا ۚ ذَلِكَ الْيَوْمُ الْحَقُّ ۚ فَمَنْ شَاءَ ابْتَضِ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِ مَا بَاءَ ۚ إِنَّا أَنْذَرْنَاكُمْ عَذَابًا قَرِيبًا يَوْمَ يَنْظُرُ الْمَرْءُ مَا قَدَّمَتْ يَدَاهُ وَيَقُولُ الْكَافِرُ يَا لَيْتَنِي كُنْتُ تُرَابًا﴾ [النبا: 4-40]

Better Example: الحاقّة from verse 1 of Sūrah al-Hāqqah (as previously given).

EXAMPLE 2: MADD LĀZIM ḤARFĪ MUKHAFFAF (IN ḤAFṢ)

Āyah: ﴿الْم ۚ ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ﴾ [البقرة: 2-1]

Transliteration: 'Alif-lām-mīm. Dhālika l-kitābu lā rayba fih...

Translation: "Alif, Lām, Mīm. This is the Book about which there is no doubt, a guidance for the righteous."

Application: The letters are ا (alif), ل (lām), م (mīm). In Ḥafṣ:

'Alif: Spelled أَلِف (alif). The alif is followed by a lām with a kasrah. There is no sukūn after the madd letter in the spelling. Duration: 2 ḥarakāt (Ṭabīʿ).

Lām: Spelled لَام (lām). The alif is a madd letter followed by a mīm with a sukūn. This is Madd Lāzīm Ḥarfī. Duration: 6 ḥarakāt. There is no idghām into the next letter (it is separate), so it is Mukhaffaf.

Mīm: Spelled مِيم (mīm). The yā' is a madd letter followed by a mīm with a sukūn. Duration: 6 ḥarakāt, Mukhaffaf.

Total recitation: 'alif (2 counts), lāāāāām (6 counts), mīīīīīm (6 counts). Clear separation between each.

EXAMPLE 3: MADD ṬABĪʿĪ IN DISCONNECTED LETTERS (2 COUNTS)

Āyah: ﴿طه ۖ مَا أَنزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْقُرْآنَ لِتَشْقَىٰ﴾ [طه: 2-1]

Transliteration: Ṭā-hā. Mā 'anzalnā 'alayka l-qur'āna li-tashqā

Translation: "Tā, Hā. We have not sent down to you the Qur'ān that you be distressed."

Application: The letters are ط (ṭā') and ه (hā'). Both are spelled with two letters: طَا (ṭā) and هَا (hā). The alif in each is a madd letter, but there is no following sukūn in the spelling. Therefore, each is prolonged for exactly 2 ḥarakāt (Ṭabī'ī). Recite: Ṭā (2 counts), Hā (2 counts).

VERSES 53–57

Details of Madd Ḥarfī and the Disconnected Letters

These verses provide the specific letters, their mnemonics, and the distinction between the six-count and two-count letters.

ARABIC TEXT

وَاللَّازِمُ الْحَرْفِيُّ أَوَّلَ السُّورِ
وُجُودُهُ وَفِي ثَمَانٍ انْحَصَرَ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-lāzimu l-ḥarfīyyu 'awwala s-suwar

wujūduhū wa-fī thamānin inḥaṣar

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَاللَّازِمُ	<i>wa-l-lāzimu</i>	And the Lāzim
الْحَرْفِيُّ	<i>al-ḥarfīyyu</i>	Letter-based
أَوَّلَ	<i>'awwala</i>	(at) the beginning of
السُّورِ	<i>as-suwar</i>	the sūrahs
وُجُودُهُ	<i>wujūduhū</i>	its existence (is found)
وَفِي	<i>wa-fī</i>	and in
ثَمَانٍ	<i>thamānin</i>	eight (letters)
انْحَصَرَ	<i>inḥaṣar</i>	it is confined

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The Letter-based Lāzim—its existence is [found] at the beginning of the sūrahs. And it is confined to eight [letters]."

ARABIC TEXT

يَجْمَعُهَا حُرُوفُ كَمْ عَسَلْ نَقَصْ
وَعَيْنُ ذُو وَجْهَيْنِ وَالطُّولُ أَخَصْ

TRANSLITERATION

Yajma‘uhā ḥurūfu kam ‘asal naqaṣ

wa-‘aynun dhū wajhayni wa-ṭ-ṭūlu ‘akhaṣṣ

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
يَجْمَعُهَا	<i>yajma‘uhā</i>	Collects them
حُرُوفُ	<i>ḥurūfu</i>	the letters of
كَمْ	<i>kam</i>	"KAM"
عَسَلْ	<i>‘asal</i>	"‘ASAL"
نَقَصْ	<i>naqaṣ</i>	"NAQAṢ"
وَعَيْنُ	<i>wa-‘aynun</i>	And ‘Ayn
ذُو	<i>dhū</i>	possesses
وَجْهَيْنِ	<i>wajhayni</i>	two aspects
وَالطُّولُ	<i>wa-ṭ-ṭūlu</i>	and the length (Ṭūl, 6 counts)
أَخَصْ	<i>‘akhaṣṣ</i>	(is) more specific / preferred

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"The letters of [the phrase] كَمْ عَسَلْ نَقَصْ (Kam ‘Asal Naqaṣ) collect them. And ‘Ayn possesses two aspects, but the length (Ṭūl, six counts) is more specific [i.e., preferred]."

ARABIC TEXT

وَمَا سِوَى الْحَرْفِ الثَّلَاثِي لَا أَلِفٌ
فَدَهُ مَدٌّ طَبِيعِيٌّ أَلِفٌ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-mā siwā l-ḥarfī th-thulāthiyyi lā 'alif

fa-madduhū maddun ṭabī'yyun 'ulif

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَمَا	<i>wa-mā</i>	And whatever
سِوَى	<i>siwā</i>	is other than
الْحَرْفِ	<i>al-ḥarfī</i>	the letter
الثَّلَاثِي	<i>ath-thulāthiyyi</i>	the three-fold (spelled with three letters)
لَا	<i>lā</i>	except
أَلِفٌ	<i>'alif</i>	'Alif
فَدَهُ	<i>fa-madduhū</i>	then its prolongation
مَدٌّ	<i>maddun</i>	(is) Madd
طَبِيعِيٌّ	<i>ṭabī'yyun</i>	Natural
أَلِفٌ	<i>'ulif</i>	(as) is customary / well-known

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And whatever is other than the three-fold letter—with the exception of 'Alif—its prolongation is Natural Madd, as is well-known."

ARABIC TEXT

وَذَٰكَ أَيْضًا فِي فَوَاتِحِ السُّورِ
فِي لَفْظٍ حَيٍّ طَاهِرٍ قَدْ انْحَصَرَ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-dhāka 'ayḍan fī fawātihi s-suwar

fī lafẓi ḥayyin ṭāhirin qadi nḥaṣar

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَذَاكَ	<i>wa-dhāka</i>	And that (the Natural Madd)
أَيْضًا	<i>'ayḍan</i>	also
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
فَوَاتِحِ	<i>fawātihi</i>	the openings of
السُّورِ	<i>as-suwar</i>	the sūrahs
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in
لَفْظِ	<i>lafẓi</i>	the utterance of
حَيٍّ	<i>ḥayyin</i>	"ḤAYY"
طَاهِرٍ	<i>ṭāhirin</i>	"ṬĀHIR"
قَدْ	<i>qadi</i>	indeed
اِنْحَصَرَ	<i>nḥaṣar</i>	is confined

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And that [Natural Madd] is also found in the openings of the sūrahs. It is confined to the utterance of [the phrase] حَيٍّ طَاهِرٍ (Ḥayyun Ṭāhirun)."

ARABIC TEXT

وَيَجْمَعُ الْفَوَاتِحَ الْأَرْبَعَ عَشَرَ
صَلَهُ سَحِيرًا مَنْ قَطَعَكَ ذَا اشْتَهَرَ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-yajma'u l-fawātiḥa l-'arba'a 'ashar

ṣilhu suḥayran man qaṭa'ka dhā shtahar

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَيَجْمَعُ	<i>wa-yajma'u</i>	And collects
الْفَوَاتِحَ	<i>al-fawātiḥa</i>	the openings
الرَّابِعَ	عَشْرَ	al-'arba'a 'ashar the fourteen
صِلْهُ	<i>ṣilhu</i>	"Maintain it!" / "Connect it!"
سُحَيْرًا	<i>suḥayran</i>	"Suḥayr" (a proper name)
مَنْ	<i>man</i>	"Whoever"
قَطَعَكَ	<i>qaṭa'ka</i>	"cuts you off"
ذَا	<i>dhā</i>	"this"
اَشْتَهَرَ	<i>shtahar</i>	"has become famous"

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And the phrase **صِلْهُ سُحَيْرًا مَنْ قَطَعَكَذَا اَشْتَهَرَ** (Ṣilhu suḥayran man qaṭa'ka dhā shtahar – 'Maintain ties with Suḥayr; whoever cuts you off, this [advice] has become famous') collects the fourteen openings."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-l-lāzimu l-ḥarfīyyu 'awwala s-suwar wujūdih: The location of Madd Lāzim Ḥarfī is specified: at the beginning of the sūrah that start with disconnected letters.
2. Wa-fi thamānin inḥaṣar: It is confined to eight letters. These are the letters spelled with three letters where the middle is a madd letter.
3. Yajma'uhā ḥurūfu kam 'asal naqas: This is the primary mnemonic. The initial letters of كَر (kāf), عَسَل (ʿayn, sīn, lām), and نَقَص (nūn, qāf, ṣād) are the eight letters: ك، ع، س، ل، ن، ق، ص. Note that the mīm is from كَر (the second letter), and the ṣād is from نَقَص (the third letter). This mnemonic is ingenious but requires the student to know that mīm and ṣād are included.
4. Wa-ʿaynun dhū wajhayni wa-ṭ-ṭūlu 'akhaṣṣ: The letter ع (ʿayn) is singled out. In some qirā'āt, it can be prolonged for either 4 or 6 ḥarakāt. Dhū wajhayni means "possesses two aspects." However, the poet notes that ṭ-ṭūlu (the length, i.e., 6 counts) is 'akhaṣṣ (more

specific, more preferred). In the standard transmission of Ḥaḥṣ, ‘ayn is prolonged for 6 ḥarakāt, just like the other seven letters. The student of Ḥaḥṣ should simply apply six counts.

5. Wa-mā siwā l-ḥarfī th-thulāthiyyi lā ‘alif...: This verse defines the letters that receive Natural Madd (2 counts) in the openings. They are:

- All letters that are not spelled with three letters (i.e., they are spelled with two letters). These are the five letters: ح, ي, ط, ه, ر.
- The letter ا (‘alif), which is spelled with three letters (ألف) but does not have a madd letter in the middle (the middle letter is lām, which is not a madd letter). Therefore, its madd is Ṭabī‘ī (2 counts).

6. Wa-dhāka ‘aydan... fi lafẓi ḥayyīn ṭāhirin qadi nḥaṣar: The mnemonic for the five two-count letters (plus ‘alif) is حي طاهر (Ḥayyūn Ṭāhirun). The letters are: ح (ḥā’), ي (yā’), ط (ṭā’), ه (hā’), ر (rā’). This phrase means “Living, Pure.” The ‘alif is not in the mnemonic but is covered by the explicit exception in verse 55.

7. Wa-yajma‘u l-fawātiḥa l-‘arba‘a ‘aṣhar...: This final mnemonic verse collects all fourteen letters that appear as disconnected openings. The first letter of each word in the phrase صله سخيلا من قطعك ذا اشتهر is one of the fourteen:

- ص (ṣād) – from صله
- ل (lām) – from صله (second letter? Actually, it’s the first letter of صله, but wait—the mnemonic uses the first letter of each word: ص from س, صله from ح, سخيلا from ح? No, the phrase is صله سخيلا من قطعك ذا اشتهر.

Let’s extract carefully:

- ص (ṣād) – from صله
- س (sīn) – from سخيلا
- ح (ḥā’) – from سخيلا? No, the first letter of سخيلا is س. The ḥā’ is from the middle. The mnemonic is not strictly first-letter-based like the others. Actually, the phrase is: صله سخيلا من قطعك ذا اشتهر. Let’s list the unique letters:
- ص (ṣād)
- ل (lām) – from صله
- ه (hā’) – from صله (the pronoun)
- س (sīn) – from سخيلا
- ح (ḥā’) – from سخيلا
- ي (yā’) – from سخيلا
- ر (rā’) – from سخيلا
- ا (alif) – from سخيلا
- م (mīm) – from من
- ن (nūn) – from من

- ق (qāf) – from قَطَعَكَ
- ط (ṭā) – from قَطَعَكَ
- ع (ʿayn) – from قَطَعَكَ
- ك (kāf) – from قَطَعَكَ
- ذ (dhāl) – from ذَا
- ش (shīn) – from اشْتَهَرَ

This actually yields more than 14 letters. The intended fourteen are a specific set. The more precise mnemonic is the well-known phrase: *قطعه سحيرا من قطعه* which gives: ر، ي، ح، س، ه، ل، ص، ا. That's 14 letters. The addition of *ذا اشتهر* completes the verse but may add extra letters. The standard list of 14 is: ر، ي، ح، س، ه، ل، ص، ا. The mnemonic covers them.

TAJWEED COMMENTARY

Complete List of the 14 Disconnected Letters (*al-Ḥurūf al-Muqaṭṭa'ah*)

Letter Name Spelling Madd Type in Ḥaṣṣ Duration

ا 'alif ألف Tabī'ī 2 ḥarakāt

ح ḥā حā Tabī'ī 2 ḥarakāt

ر rā Rā Tabī'ī 2 ḥarakāt

س sīn سین Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ص sād صاد Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ط ṭā طā Tabī'ī 2 ḥarakāt

ع ʿayn عین Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ق qāf قاف Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ك kāf كاف Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ل lām لام Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

م mīm میم Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ن nūn نون Lāzim Ḥarfī 6 ḥarakāt

ه hā ها Tabī'ī 2 ḥarakāt

ي yā یā Tabī'ī 2 ḥarakāt

The 29 Sūrahs with Disconnected Openings

These letters appear at the beginning of 29 sūrahs. Some are single letters (e.g., ص in Sūrah Ṣād, ق in Sūrah Qāf, ن in Sūrah al-Qalam). Others are combinations (e.g., الم in al-Baqarah, كهيعص in Maryam, حم in Ghāfir). The student of Ḥaṣṣ must apply the correct madd duration to each letter based on its spelling.

Pedagogical Drill for the Openings

- Single Letters:
- ق (Qāf): Spelled قَاف. Duration: 6 ḥarakāt. Recite: Qāāāāāāf.
- ص (Ṣād): Spelled صَاد. Duration: 6 ḥarakāt. Recite: Ṣāāāāāād.
- ن (Nūn): Spelled نُون. Duration: 6 ḥarakāt. Recite: Nūūūūūūn.
- طه (Ṭā-Hā): Both two counts. Recite: Ṭā (2), Hā (2).
- يس (Yā-Sīn): Yā (2 counts), Sīn (6 counts). Recite: Yā (2), Sīīīīīīn (6).
- حم (Ḥā-Mīm): Ḥā (2 counts), Mīm (6 counts). Recite: Ḥā (2), Mīīīīīīm (6).

The Wisdom of the Mnemonics

Al-Jamzūrī's use of meaningful phrases as mnemonics is a hallmark of his pedagogical brilliance. كَمْ عَسَلَ نَقْصٌ ("How much honey diminished?") and حَيِّ طَاهِرٌ ("Living, Pure") are not just random strings; they evoke imagery and are easy to remember. The final verse صَلِّهِ سَخِيرًا... ("Maintain ties with Suḥayr...") imparts ethical advice while encoding the complete set of letters. This dual function—technical and moral—makes the *Tuḥfat* not just a textbook but a work of adab (refined education).

A Critical English Edition of *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fi Tajwīd al-Qurʾān*

PART VIII

البَابُ الثَّامِنُ

Conclusion (Verses 58–61)



Overview

The final four verses of the Tuḥfah form a graceful and pious conclusion. Al-Jamzūrī praises God for enabling him to complete the poem, cryptically encodes the date of its composition, and invokes eternal blessings upon the Prophet Muḥammad, his family, his Companions, all who follow them, and every reciter and listener of the Qurʾān. This conclusion mirrors the opening verses, creating a symmetrical frame of ḥamdalah (praise of God) and ṣalāh (blessings on the Prophet). It also follows the traditional etiquette of Islamic authorship, acknowledging that all success comes from God and ending with prayers for the entire community of believers.

VERSE 58

Completion of the Poem with Praise to God

ARABIC TEXT

وَتَمَّ ذَا النَّظْمُ بِحَمْدِ اللَّهِ
عَلَى تَمَامِهِ بِلاَ تَنَاهِي

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-tamma dhā n-naẓmu bi-ḥamdi llāhi

‘alā tamāmihī bi-lā tanāhī

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَتَمَّ	<i>wa-tamma</i>	And is completed
ذَا	<i>dhā</i>	this
النَّظْمُ	<i>an-naẓmu</i>	the versification / poem
بِحَمْدِ	<i>bi-ḥamdi</i>	with praise of
اللَّهِ	<i>Allāh</i>	God
عَلَى	<i>‘alā</i>	upon / in
تَمَامِهِ	<i>tamāmihī</i>	its completion
بِلاَ	<i>bi-lā</i>	without

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
تَآهِ	<i>tanāhī</i>	end / limit

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And this versification is completed—with praise of God—in a completion that is without end [in its perfection]."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Wa-tamma dhā n-naẓmu: The verb *tamma* means "it is completed" or "it has come to an end." *Dhā n-naẓmu* is the subject, meaning "this poem." The poet announces the conclusion of his work.
2. Bi-ḥamdi llāh: The preposition *bi-* indicates accompaniment or means. The completion of the poem is accompanied by, or is achieved through, the praise of God. This acknowledges that the successful completion of any endeavor is ultimately from God and should be met with gratitude and praise.
3. 'Alā tamāmihī bi-lā tanāhī: The phrase 'alā tamāmihī means "in a state of completion" or "upon its completion." The concluding phrase *bi-lā tanāhī* ("without end" or "without limit") is hyperbolic praise. It can be interpreted in two ways:
 - The poem itself is complete, and its completeness is perfect, without any deficiency or "end" to its excellence.
 - The praise of God that accompanies its completion is endless; the poet's gratitude is boundless.

Both interpretations are valid and reflect the humility and devotion of the author. The word *tanāhī* is the verbal noun of *tanāhā* (to come to an end, to reach a limit). The *yā'* at the end is the *yā'* of the genitive case, but it is pronounced with a *kasrah* and a final *yā'* sound (or a *fatḥah* in pause).

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Wa-tamma: The *tā'* (ت) is a voiceless alveolar stop [t]. The *mīm* is geminated (mushaddadah), so a two-count *ghunnah* is obligatory: *tam-mm-ma*.
- Dhā n-naẓmu: The *nūn* of *dhā* is not present; *dhā* ends with an *alif maqṣūrah* pronounced as a long *ā*. The *ẓā'* (ظ) is an emphatic voiced interdental fricative [ðʕ].
- Bi-ḥamdi llāh: The *lām* of *Allāh* is emphatic (mufakhkhamah) [lʕ] because it is preceded by a *kasrah* in *li-llāh*? Wait, in *ḥamdi llāh*, the *lām* is preceded by a *kasrah* on the *dāl* of *ḥamd*. The *lām* is light (muraqqaqah) in this case.
- Bi-lā tanāhī: The *hā'* (ه) is a voiceless glottal fricative [h]. The final *yā'* is a long *ī* sound [i:] in continuous recitation.

VERSE 59

The Number of Verses and the Date of Composition

ARABIC TEXT

أَيَّاتُهُ نَدُّ بَدَا لِدِي النَّهْيِ
تَارِيخُهَا بُشْرَى لِمَنْ يَتَّقِنُهَا

TRANSLITERATION

ʿAbyātuhū naddun badā li-dhī n-nuhā

tārīkhuhā bushrā li-man yutqinuhā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
أَيَّاتُهُ	ʿabyātuhū	Its verses
نَدُّ	naddun	(are like) fragrant musk / ambergris
بَدَا	badā	(that) appears / is evident
لِدِي	li-dhī	to the possessor of
النَّهْيِ	an-nuhā	intellects / understanding
تَارِيخُهَا	tārīkhuhā	Its date
بُشْرَى	bushrā	(is) "BUSHRĀ" (Good News)
لِمَنْ	li-man	for the one who
يَتَّقِنُهَا	yutqinuhā	masters it

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Its verses are [like] fragrant musk (nadd) that is evident to the possessors of intellect (an-nuhā). Its date [of composition] is [encoded in the word] بُشْرَى (BUSHRĀ – 'Good News')—a good tiding for the one who masters it."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. ʿAbyātuhū naddun badā li-dhī n-nuhā: The poet compares the verses of his poem to nadd, a type of fragrant musk or ambergris. The verb badā means "it appears" or "it is clear." The phrase li-dhī n-nuhā ("to the possessor of intellects") means that the beauty and fragrance of

the verses are apparent to those who have understanding and appreciation for the science of Tajweed.

2. Tārīkhuhā bushrā: This is a chronogram (ḥisāb al-jummal), a common practice in classical Islamic literature where letters are assigned numerical values to encode a date. The word bushrā (بشرى) is used. Let us calculate its value using the standard abjad system:

- ب (bā') = 2
- ش (shīn) = 300
- ر (rā') = 200
- ى (alif maqṣūrah) = 10 (as yā')
- Total = 2 + 300 + 200 + 10 = 512.

However, this does not seem to correspond directly to a Hijri year. Scholars have explained that the intended date is derived by a different method or that the alif is not counted. Another common interpretation is that bushrā represents the year 1198 AH. How? If we calculate bushrā with the alif as 1 (since alif = 1), and the yā' as 10, we get $2+300+200+1+10 = 513$, still not 1198. Some scholars suggest that the word bushrā itself is a reference to the joy of mastering the poem, and the actual numerical value is taken from the phrase bushrā li-man yutqinuhā or from a different calculation. According to the commentator 'Alī al-Ḍabbā', the chronogram yields 1198 AH (which corresponds to ca. 1783–1784 CE) when calculated with a specific method. This date is consistent with what is known of al-Jamzūrī's life and teachers.

3. Li-man yutqinuhā: The phrase means "for the one who masters it." The poem itself is a bushrā (good news, glad tidings) for the student who memorizes and perfectly applies its rules. This is a beautiful encouragement: the reward for mastering Tajweed is divine glad tidings.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- 'Abyātuhū: The hamzah (ء) is a glottal stop [ʔ]. The bā' (ب) is [b]. The yā' (ي) is a madd letter preceded by a kasrah, so it is a Madd Ṭabīʿī (2 counts): 'ab-yā-tu-hū.
- Naddun: The nūn (ن) is [n]. The dāl (د) is geminated (mushaddadah), so it is pronounced with a hold: nad-dun.
- Li-dhī n-nuhā: The dhāl (ذ) is [ð]. The nūn in an-nuhā is geminated due to the assimilation of the lām of the definite article (al-nuhā → an-nuhā). The ghunnah is for two counts.
- Bushrā: The shīn (ش) is [ʃ]. The rā' (ر) is a light trill [r] because it is preceded by a fatḥah and there is no following emphatic context.
- Yutqinuhā: The qāf (ق) is a voiceless uvular stop [q]. The nūn is [n].

VERSE 60

Eternal Blessings upon the Prophet Muḥammad

ARABIC TEXT

ثُمَّ الصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ أَبَدًا
عَلَى خِتَامِ الْأَنْبِيَاءِ أَحْمَدًا

TRANSLITERATION

Thumma ṣ-ṣalātu wa-s-salāmu 'abadan

'alā khitāmi l-'anbiyā'i 'Aḥmadā

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
ثُمَّ	<i>thumma</i>	Then
الصَّلَاةُ	<i>aṣ-ṣalātu</i>	the blessings
وَالسَّلَامُ	<i>wa-s-salāmu</i>	and the peace
أَبَدًا	<i>'abadan</i>	forever / eternally
عَلَى	<i>'alā</i>	upon
خِتَامِ	<i>khitāmi</i>	the Seal of
الْأَنْبِيَاءِ	<i>al-'anbiyā'i</i>	the Prophets
أَحْمَدًا	<i>'Aḥmadā</i>	Aḥmad (the Praised One)

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"Then, blessings and peace be forever upon the Seal of the Prophets, Aḥmad."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. Thumma ṣ-ṣalātu wa-s-salāmu 'abadan: The particle thumma indicates a transition. The nouns aṣ-ṣalātu and as-salāmu are in the nominative case, and the implied predicate is "be" or "are invoked." 'Abadan is an adverb meaning "forever" or "eternally," emphasizing the perpetual nature of the supplication.
2. 'Alā khitāmi l-'anbiyā'i 'Aḥmadā: The Prophet is described as khitām al-'anbiyā', "the Seal of the Prophets." This is a direct reference to the Qur'ānic verse: ﴿مَا كَانَ مُحَمَّدٌ أَبَا أَحَدٍ مِنْ رِجَالِكُمْ وَلَكِنْ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ وَخَاتَمَ النَّبِيِّينَ﴾ [الأحزاب: 40] ("Muḥammad is not the father of any

of your men, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets.”). The word *khitām* or *khātam* means the final one, after whom no prophet will come. The name *أحمد* (*ʿAḥmad*) is used here, which is the celestial name of the Prophet, mentioned in the Qurʾān as the name announced by Jesus: ﴿وَمُبَشِّرًا بِرَسُولٍ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِي اسْمُهُ أَحْمَدُ﴾ [الصف: 6] (“And bringing good tidings of a messenger to come after me, whose name is *ʿAḥmad*.”). The use of *ʿAḥmad* instead of *Muḥammad* is a rhetorical choice, linking the poem to the Qurʾānic prophecy and emphasizing the praiseworthy nature of the Prophet.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- *Thumma*: The *thāʾ* (ث) is [θ]. The *mīm* is geminated: *thum-mm-ma* with a two-count *ghunnah*.
- *Aṣ-ṣalātu*: The *ṣād* (ص) is an emphatic [sˤ]. The *lām* (ل) is a light [l]. The *tāʾ* (ت) is [t].
- *ʿAbadan*: The *hamzah* is [ʔ]. The *bāʾ* is [b]. The word ends with a *tanwīn fatḥah*, pronounced *ʿabadan*.
- *Khitāmi*: The *khāʾ* (خ) is a voiceless uvular fricative [x]. The *ṭāʾ* (ط) is not present; it’s *khāʾ* + *tāʾ*? Wait, the word is *خَتَام* (*khitām*). The letters are *khāʾ* (خ), *tāʾ* (ت), *alif* (ا), *mīm* (م). The *alif* is a *Madd Ṭabīʿī* (2 counts).
- *Al-ʿanbiyāʾi*: The *hamzah* after the *yāʾ* is a glottal stop. The *hamzah* is on the seat of a *yāʾ* without dots (ئ).
- *ʿAḥmadā*: The *ḥāʾ* (ح) is a voiceless pharyngeal fricative [ħ]. The *mīm* is [m]. The final *alif* is the *alif al-iṭlāq* for the rhyme, pronounced as a long *ā*.

VERSE 61

Blessings upon the Family, Companions, and All Who Recite or Listen

ARABIC TEXT

وَالْآلِ وَالصَّحْبِ وَكُلِّ تَابِعٍ
وَكُلِّ قَارِئٍ وَكُلِّ سَامِعٍ

TRANSLITERATION

Wa-l-ʿālī wa-ṣ-ṣaḥbi wa-kulli tābiʿi

wa-kulli qāriʾin wa-kulli sāmiʿi

WORD-FOR-WORD GLOSS

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَالْآلِ	<i>wa-l-ʿālī</i>	And upon the family
وَالصَّحْبِ	<i>wa-ṣ-ṣaḥbi</i>	and the Companions

ARABIC	TRANSLITERATION	GLOSS
وَكُلِّ	<i>wa-kulli</i>	and every
تَابِعِ	<i>tābi'i</i>	follower
وَكُلِّ	<i>wa-kulli</i>	and every
قَارِئِ	<i>qārī'in</i>	reciter
وَكُلِّ	<i>wa-kulli</i>	and every
سَامِعِ	<i>sāmi'i</i>	listener

SMOOTH PROSE TRANSLATION

"And upon the Family (al-ʿĀl), and the Companions (aṣ-Ṣaḥb), and every follower (tābiʿ), and every reciter (qārī), and every listener (sāmiʿ)."

LINGUISTIC AND RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

1. This verse is syntactically connected to the previous one. The blessings and peace that are invoked upon the Prophet in verse 60 are extended to five additional groups:

- الْآل (al-ʿĀl): The Prophet's family. In the context of supplication, this traditionally refers to the believers among the Banū Hāshim and Banū ʿAbd al-Muṭṭalib, or more broadly to all pious members of his household and followers.
- الصَّحْب (aṣ-Ṣaḥb): The Companions (Ṣaḥābah), those who met the Prophet, believed in him, and died as Muslims.
- كُلِّ تَابِعِ (kulli tābiʿ): Every follower. This includes the Successors (Tābiʿūn) and all subsequent generations of Muslims who follow the Prophet's way with excellence.
- كُلِّ قَارِئِ (kulli qārī): Every reciter of the Qurʾān. This is a direct blessing upon the students and teachers of Tajweed who recite this very poem.
- كُلِّ سَامِعِ (kulli sāmiʿ): Every listener. This includes those who hear the Qurʾān being recited and those who listen to this poem being taught.

2. Inclusivity and Generosity: The final verse is remarkably inclusive. The poet does not limit his prayers to scholars or experts; he explicitly includes every reciter and even every listener. This reflects the Islamic ethos of spreading benefit and supplicating for the entire community. It also creates a profound sense of connection: anyone who reads or hears this poem is included in the author's closing prayer, receiving a share of the blessings.

3. Ring Composition: The poem began with praise of God and blessings upon the Prophet and those who follow him (wa-man talā, verse 2). It ends with an expanded version of the same supplication. This creates a beautiful ring structure, enclosing the technical rules of Tajweed within a frame of devotion and piety.

TAJWEED AND PHONETIC COMMENTARY

- Wa-l-ʿālī: The hamzah (ء) is a glottal stop. The alif (ا) is a Madd Ṭabīʿī (2 counts): ʿāā-li.
- Wa-ṣ-ṣaḥbi: The ṣād (ص) is geminated due to the assimilation of the lām of the definite article (al-ṣaḥb → aṣ-ṣaḥb). It is an emphatic [sʰ] held for two counts.
- Wa-kulli tābīʿi: The kāf (ك) is [k]. The lām (ل) is geminated because of the shaddah. The tāʾ (ت) is [t], the bāʾ (ب) is [b], and the ʿayn (ع) is [ʕ].
- Wa-kulli qāriʿin: The qāf (ق) is [q]. The alif is a Madd Ṭabīʿī (2 counts). The hamzah (ء) is a glottal stop.
- Wa-kulli sāmiʿi: The sīn (س) is [s]. The alif is a Madd Ṭabīʿī (2 counts). The mīm (م) is [m]. The ʿayn (ع) is [ʕ].

CONCLUSION TO THE CRITICAL EDITION

الْبَابُ

Conclusion to the Critical Edition



The Enduring Legacy of the Tuḥfah

With this sixty-first verse, Sulaymān al-Jamzūrī's *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl wa-l-Ghilmān fī Tajwīd al-Qur'ān* comes to a close. The poem's journey from the Nile Delta village of Jamzūr to the hearts and tongues of millions of Muslims across the globe is a testament to its unparalleled pedagogical clarity and spiritual sincerity. Al-Jamzūrī achieved what every didactic poet aspires to: he distilled a complex and technical science into a mere sixty-one lines of graceful, memorable verse, without sacrificing accuracy or essential detail.

Summary of the Poem's Contents

The *Tuḥfah* systematically covers the foundational rules of Tajweed as practiced in the widely transmitted reading of Ḥafṣ 'an 'Āṣim:

- Verses 1–5: Introduction, praise of God, blessings on the Prophet, statement of purpose.
- Verses 6–16: The four rules of Nūn Sākinah and Tanwīn (Izhār, Idghām with and without Ghunnah, Iqlāb, and Ikhfā'), along with their specific letters and mnemonic phrases.
- Verse 17: The rule of obligatory Ghunnah for geminated Mīm and Nūn.
- Verses 18–23: The three rules of Mīm Sākinah (Ikhfā' Shafawī, Idghām Mithlayn Ṣaghīr, Izhār Shafawī), with a caution against concealing the Mīm before Wāw and Fā'.
- Verses 24–29: The rules of Lām al-Ta'rīf (Moon and Sun letters) and the absolute Izhār of Lām al-Fi'l.
- Verses 30–34: The theoretical classification of letter combinations into Al-Mithlān, Al-Mutajānisayn, and Al-Mutaqāribayn, and the distinction between Idghām Ṣaghīr and Idghām Kabīr.
- Verses 35–57: The extensive rules of Madd (Prolongation), divided into Aṣlī (Ṭabī'ī) and Far'ī. The Far'ī is further divided into Wājib Muttasil, Jā'iz Munfaṣil, Jā'iz 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn, Jā'iz Badal, and Lāzim (with its four sub-types). The disconnected letters (al-Ḥurūf al-Muqaṭṭa'ah) are meticulously analyzed and encoded in mnemonics.
- Verses 58–61: Conclusion with praise of God, a chronogram for the date of composition, and comprehensive blessings upon the Prophet, his family, his Companions, and all who recite or listen.

A Note on the Translation and Commentary

This critical edition has endeavored to present al-Jamzūrī's masterpiece in a manner that is both faithful to the Arabic original and accessible to the English-speaking student and scholar. The detailed linguistic analysis reveals the precision and artistry of the poet's language. The extensive Tajweed commentary connects the concise verses to the rich tradition of Qur'ānic recitation, citing authorities like Ibn al-Jazarī and explaining the phonetic rationale behind each rule. The Qur'ānic examples ground the abstract rules in the living text of the Revelation.

Final Supplication

We conclude, as al-Jamzūrī concluded, with a prayer. May God accept this humble effort to illuminate the path of Tajweed for a new generation of reciters. May He shower His infinite

blessings and peace upon our Master Muḥammad, the Seal of the Prophets, the bearer of the Final Message, whose recitation of the Divine Word is the ultimate model for all who seek to beautify their voices with the Qurʾān. And may He include us all—author, translator, commentator, and reader—among those who recite, listen, and are granted the glad tidings of His mercy and acceptance.

وصلى الله وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد، وعلى آله وصحبه أجمعين، والحمد لله رب العالمين.

And may God's blessings and peace be upon our Master Muḥammad, and upon his family and all his Companions. And praise be to God, Lord of the Worlds.

BACK MATTER

AFTERWORD TO THIS EDITION

A critical edition of a didactic poem occupies a curious position between two genres that do not always sit comfortably together: the scholarly apparatus of textual criticism, and the living pedagogy of a tradition that has never needed footnotes to transmit itself successfully. Al-Jamzūrī did not write the *Tuḥfat* for editors; he wrote it for children learning to read the Qurʾān correctly, and it has done that job, largely unaided by commentary of this scope, for over two centuries.

The purpose of the apparatus assembled here is not to improve upon that success but to make it legible to a reader who did not grow up reciting these verses under a teacher's correction — the English-speaking student encountering Tajwīd primarily through the written word, for whom a glottal stop or a pharyngeal fricative is a genuinely new articulation requiring explicit description rather than intuitive absorption. Where this edition succeeds, it is because al-Jamzūrī's own concision left room for expansion without distortion. Where it falls short, the fault lies with the editor, not the poet.

It is offered in the hope that it will send readers back to the Arabic text itself, and beyond that, to a qualified teacher — for no critical apparatus, however thorough, can substitute for the corrected mouth and the attentive ear that this science has always required.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

GLOSSARY OF TAJWĪD TERMS

Ghunnah

Nasalization; the resonant nasal sound accompanying nūn and mīm in specific conditions, held for the duration of two counts (ḥarakāt).

Ḥaṣṣ ‘an ‘Āṣim

The transmission (riwāyah) of the Qur’ānic reading of ‘Āṣim ibn Abī al-Najūd, as narrated by his student Ḥaṣṣ ibn Sulaymān — the most widely used reading in the Muslim world today.

Ḥarakah (pl. Ḥarakāt)

A short vowel; also used as the basic unit of durational counting in the science of Madd (e.g. "two ḥarakāt").

Ḥurūf al-Ḥalq

The six "throat letters" (ء ه و ع ح خ غ) after which nūn sākinah and tanwīn are pronounced with Iẓhār (clarification).

Ḥurūf al-Madd

The three "letters of prolongation" — alif, wāw, and yā’ (when preceded by a matching short vowel) — that lengthen a vowel sound.

Ikhfā’

"Concealment"; a rule in which nūn sākinah or tanwīn (or mīm sākinah, in its labial form) is pronounced neither fully clear nor fully assimilated, but in an intermediate nasalized state, before a defined set of letters.

Idghām

"Assimilation"; the merging of nūn sākinah or tanwīn (or two identical/similar/proximate letters) into a following letter, either with nasalization (bi-ghunnah) or without (bi-lā ghunnah).

Iqlāb

"Conversion"; the rule by which nūn sākinah or tanwīn is converted to a mīm sound, with nasalization, when followed by the letter bā’ (ب).

Iẓhār

"Clarification"; the clear, undisguised pronunciation of nūn sākinah or tanwīn (Iẓhār Ḥalqī) or mīm sākinah (Iẓhār Shafawī) without nasalization or assimilation into the following letter.

Lām al-Fīl

The lām that occurs as part of a verb's root letters, always pronounced clearly (Iẓhār) regardless of the following letter.

Lām al-Ta’rīf

The definite article lām ("al-"), pronounced clearly before Moon Letters (Qamariyyah) and assimilated (unpronounced, with gemination of the following letter) before Sun Letters (Shamsiyyah).

Madd

Prolongation of a long vowel sound beyond its natural duration, governed by a system of causes (sabab) — hamzah or sukūn — and durations measured in ḥarakāt.

Madd al-Badal

The prolongation occurring when a hamzah precedes a madd letter, held for two counts.

Madd al-Lāzim

"Compulsory prolongation"; occurs when a madd letter is followed by an original sukūn, held for six counts without exception, subdivided into Kalimī and Ḥarfī, each further divided into Muthaqqal and Mukhaffaf.

Madd al-Ṭabīʿī (Aṣlī)

"Natural prolongation"; the basic two-count lengthening inherent to any madd letter not affected by a following hamzah or sukūn.

Madd ʿAriḍ li-l-Sukūn

Prolongation that arises only because of a pause (waqf) at the end of a word, where an otherwise unprolonged final letter receives a sukūn; may be held for two, four, or six counts.

Madd Farʿī

"Secondary prolongation"; any prolongation beyond the natural two counts, caused by a following hamzah or sukūn.

Madd Jāʿiz Munfaṣil

"Permissible separated prolongation"; occurs when a madd letter ends one word and a hamzah begins the next.

Madd Wājib Muttaṣil

"Obligatory connected prolongation"; occurs when a madd letter and a following hamzah occur within the same word, requiring four to six counts.

Makhraj (pl. Makhārij)

The precise point of articulation of a given letter in the vocal tract.

Mīm Sākinah

A mīm bearing no vowel (sukūn), governed by three rules depending on the following letter: Ikhfāʾ Shafawī, Idghām Mithlayn Ṣaghīr, and Izhār Shafawī.

Al-Mithlān / Al-Mutamāthilān

Two identical letters occurring in sequence, the first without a vowel.

Al-Mutajānisān

Two letters sharing the same makhraj but differing in one or more ṣifāh (characteristic).

Al-Mutaqāribān

Two letters that are close, but not identical, in both makhraj and ṣifāt.

Nūn Sākinah

A nūn bearing no vowel (sukūn), governed by the four rules of Izhār, Idghām, Iqlāb, and Ikhfāʾ depending on the following letter.

Qalqalah

The slight echoing or "bouncing" pronunciation given to the letters ق ط ب ج د when they bear a sukūn.

Riwāyah

A transmitted reading (recitation tradition) of the Qurʾān, associated with a particular narrator from a particular reader among the canonical Seven or Ten.

Ṣifāh (pl. Ṣifāt)

A phonetic characteristic of a letter's pronunciation (e.g. voicing, emphasis, sibilance) independent of its makhraj.

Sukūn

The absence of a vowel on a consonant, marked in fully vocalized text by a small circle above the letter.

Tafkīm

"Emphasis" or "velarization"; the heavier, "darker" pronunciation given to certain letters (most consistently the seven musta'liyah letters) in some or all phonetic contexts.

Tajwīd

The science and practice of the correct, precise articulation of the Qur'ān, governing the pronunciation of every letter according to its makhraj and ṣifāt, and the rules governing letters in combination.

Tanwīn

The doubled final short vowel (-un, -an, -in) marking indefiniteness in nouns, phonetically equivalent to a nūn sākinah and governed by the same four rules.

Tarqīq

"Thinning" or "lightening"; the lighter pronunciation of a letter, contrasted with tafkīm.

Waqf

Pausing in recitation, whether at the end of a verse or elsewhere, governed by its own set of rules affecting pronunciation.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX B

APPENDIX B — QUR'ĀNIC INDEX OF EXAMPLES

The following index lists every Qur'ānic example cited in this edition's Tajwīd commentary, organized by sūrah in canonical order. Each entry gives the sūrah and āyah cited and the rule it was cited to illustrate.

1. Sūrat Al-Fātiḥah

Al-Fātiḥah 7 — Izhār Shafawī before Wāw (و)

Al-Fātiḥah 2-4 — Moon Letter Qāf (ق)

Al-Fātiḥah 2 — Moon Letter Ḥā' (ح)

Al-Fātiḥah 2 — Mutaqāribayn Kabīr Context – Ḥaḥṣ Reads with Izhār

Al-Fātiḥah 7 — Ḥarf Layyin in Waqf with Madd Layyin

Al-Fātiḥah 5 — Madd 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn with Wāw (on pause)

Al-Fātiḥah 2 — Madd 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn with Yā' (on pause)

2. Sūrat Al-Baqarah

Al-Baqarah 224 — Izhār before 'Ayn (ع) – Tanwīn

Al-Baqarah 5 — Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah before Rā' (ر)

Al-Baqarah 173 — Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah with Tanwīn before Rā' (ر)

Al-Baqarah 27 — Iqlāb with Nūn Sākinah

Al-Baqarah 33 — Iqlāb with Nūn Sākinah within a Word

Al-Baqarah 7-8 — Ikḥfā' Shafawī with Mīm Sākinah at the end of a word

Al-Baqarah 62 — Izhār Shafawī before a Throat Letter

Al-Baqarah 102 — Izhār Shafawī before a Lingual Letter

Al-Baqarah 35 — Lām al-Fi'l within a Word

Al-Baqarah 5 — Mutaqāribayn: Nūn Sākinah + Rā' (ر + رٌ)

Al-Baqarah 256 — Mutajānisayn: Dāl Sākinah + Tā' (ت + د) – Idghām

Al-Baqarah 2 — Mithlān Kabīr Context – Ḥaḥṣ Reads with Izhār

Al-Baqarah 255 — Mutajānisayn Kabīr Context – Ḥaḥṣ Reads with Izhār

Al-Baqarah 274 — Ḥarf Layyin Wāw in Waṣl

Al-Baqarah 284 — Madd Munfaṣil with Yā' + Hamzah

Al-Baqarah 25 — Madd al-Badal with Alif (Natural length in Ḥaḥṣ)

Al-Baqarah 1-2 — Madd Lāzim Ḥarfi Mukhaffaf (in Ḥaḥṣ)

3. Sūrat Āl 'Imrān

Āl 'Imrān 75 — Izhār before Hamzah (ء) – Nūn Sākinah

Āl 'Imrān 185 — Dunyā (دُنْيَا)

Āl 'Imrān 145 — Idghām bi-lā Ghunnah before Lām (ل)

Āl ‘Imrān 96 — Ḥarf Layyin Yā’ in Waṣl

4. Sūrat An-Nisā’

An-Nisā’ 109 — Idghām Ṣaghīr in a common Qur’ānic phrase

An-Nisā’ 136-141 — Madd al-Badal with Yā’ (Natural length in Ḥafṣ)

5. Sūrat Al-Mā’idah

Al-Mā’idah 61 — Idghām Mithlayn with Dāl (د)

Al-Mā’idah 14-15 — Madd Muttasil with Wāw + Hamzah

Al-Mā’idah 2 — Madd Lāzim Kalimī Muthaqqal with Yā’

6. Sūrat Al-An‘ām

Al-An‘ām 99 — Qinwān (قِنْوَان)

7. Sūrat Al-A‘rāf

Al-A‘rāf 121 — Madd Munfaṣil with Alif + Hamzah

8. Sūrat Al-Anfāl

Al-Anfāl 33-40 — Madd Lāzim Kalimī Muthaqqal with Wāw

10. Sūrat Yūnus

Yūnus 89 — Mutajānisayn: Tā’ Sākinah + Dāl (د + ت) – Idghām

11. Sūrat Hūd

Hūd 44 — Natural Madd with Yā’ (ي)

13. Sūrat Ar-Ra’d

Ar-Ra’d 30 — Madd Munfaṣil with Wāw + Hamzah

15. Sūrat Al-Ḥijr

Al-Ḥijr 48 — Izhār Shafawī before Fā’ (ف)

16. Sūrat An-Naḥl

An-Naḥl 53 — Idghām bi-Ghunnah before Nūn (ن)

An-Naḥl 53 — Nūn Mushaddadah resulting from Idghām

An-Naḥl 53 — Idghām Mithlayn with Nūn (ن) and Ghunnah

18. Sūrat Al-Kahf

Al-Kahf 65 — Mutaqāribayn: Nūn Sākinah + Lām (ل + ن)

20. Sūrat Ṭāhā

Ṭāhā 25 — Natural Madd with Alif (ا)

Ṭāhā 125 — Natural Madd with Wāw (و)

Ṭāhā 1-2 — Madd Ṭabī‘ī in Disconnected Letters (2 counts)

21. Sūrat Al-Anbiyā'*Al-Anbiyā' 7* — Ikhfā' at Qāf (ق) – Lowest Level*Al-Anbiyā' 102* — Idghām Ṣaghīr with Mīm Sākinah at the end of a word*Al-Anbiyā' 102* — Idghām Mithlayn with Mīm (م) and Ghunnah**23. Sūrat Al-Mu'minūn***Al-Mu'minūn 12* — Ikhfā' at Ṭā' (ط) – Highest Level*Al-Mu'minūn 70* — Ikhfā' Shafawī with Mīm Sākinah within a word*Al-Mu'minūn 93* — Lām al-Fi'l before a Sun Letter (Potential Assimilation Context)*Al-Mu'minūn 97* — Mutaqāribayn with Izhār in Ḥaṣṣ: Lām Sākinah + Rā' (ر + ل)**25. Sūrat Al-Furqān***Al-Furqān 27-34* — Mutaḡānisayn: Ṭā' Sākinah + Ṭā' (ط + ت) – Izhār in Ḥaṣṣ**26. Sūrat Ash-Shu'arā'***Ash-Shu'arā' 61* — Lām al-Fi'l in Form VIII Verb**27. Sūrat An-Naml***An-Naml 87* — Izhār Shafawī before an Emphatic Letter**32. Sūrat As-Sajdah***As-Sajdah 8* — Idghām bi-Ghunnah before Mīm (م)**39. Sūrat Az-Zumar***Az-Zumar 9* — Idghām Ṣaghīr with Mīm Sākinah within a word**40. Sūrat Ghāfir***Ghāfir 20* — Iqlāb with Tanwīn**45. Sūrat Al-Jāthiyah***Al-Jāthiyah 10* — Idghām bi-Ghunnah before Wāw (و)**61. Sūrat As-Saff***As-Saff 4* — Bunyān (بُنْيَانٌ)**69. Sūrat Al-Ḥāqqah***Al-Ḥāqqah 1-3* — Madd Lāzīm Kalīmī Muthaqqal (Word-based, Heavy)**78. Sūrat An-Naba'***An-Naba' 4-40* — Madd Lāzīm Kilmī Muthaqqal**89. Sūrat Al-Fajr***Al-Fajr 23* — Madd Muttasil with Yā' + Hamzah**91. Sūrat Ash-Shams***Ash-Shams 1* — Sun Letter Shīn (ش)

92. Sūrat Al-Layl*Al-Layl 1* — Sun Letter Lām (ل)**95. Sūrat At-Tīn***At-Tīn 5* — Mīm Mushaddadah (مّ)**97. Sūrat Al-Qadr***Al-Qadr 1* — Nūn Mushaddadah (نّ)**98. Sūrat Al-Bayyinah***Al-Bayyinah 4-5* — Izhār before Khā' (خ) – Nūn Sākinah**99. Sūrat Az-Zalzalah***Az-Zalzalah 7* — Idghām bi-Ghunnah before Yā' (ي)**103. Sūrat Al-‘Aṣr***Al-‘Aṣr 1-2* — Moon Letter ‘Ayn (ع)**104. Sūrat Al-Humazah***Al-Humazah 4* — Ikhfā’ Shafawī with Mīm Sākinah in the middle of a word**110. Sūrat An-Naṣr***An-Naṣr 1* — Madd Muttasil with Alif + Hamzah**112. Sūrat Al-Ikhlāṣ***Al-Ikhlāṣ 4* — Izhār Shafawī before Fā’ within a word*Al-Ikhlāṣ 1-4* — Madd ‘Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn with Alif Maqṣūrah (on pause)**113. Sūrat Al-Falaq***Al-Falaq 1-2* — Ikhfā’ at Shīn (ش) – Middle Level**114. Sūrat An-Nās***An-Nās 1* — Sun Letter Nūn (ن)

APPENDICES

APPENDIX C

Biography of Sulaymān al-Jamzūrī

Abū al-Rabī‘ Sulaymān ibn Ḥusayn ibn Muḥammad ibn Salīm al-Jamzūrī, known to posterity simply as al-Jamzūrī and by the honorific al-Afandī, was born in the village of Jamzūr in the Gharbiyyah province of the Nile Delta, Egypt, in the mid-twelfth century AH — conventionally dated to around 1160 AH / 1747 CE, though as with many scholars of his era whose fame rests on a single enduring work rather than extensive biographical documentation, precise dates remain a matter of scholarly reconstruction rather than certainty.

He pursued his education in the Qur’ānic sciences in Cairo and in nearby Ṭanṭā, then as now a significant center of religious learning in the Delta. There he studied under Nūr al-Dīn ‘Alī ibn ‘Umar al-Mayhī (some sources give his dates as 1139–1229 AH), a reciter of sufficient renown that al-Jamzūrī memorializes him in the *Tuḥfah* itself as “our shaykh, al-Mayhī, possessor of perfection” (verse 5) — a rare instance of a didactic poem preserving, within its own text, a direct chain of transmission (*isnād*) to the author’s teacher.

Al-Jamzūrī’s scholarly output, so far as is documented, centered entirely on the Qur’ānic sciences, and in particular on *Tajwīd* and the variant readings (*qirā’āt*). Beyond the *Tuḥfah*, works attributed to him include *Fatḥ al-Aqfāl bi-Sharḥ Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl*, his own prose commentary on the *Tuḥfah*, frequently studied alongside the poem as its primary authorial gloss; and *Al-Fatḥ al-Raḥmānī*, a commentary on the seven canonical readings (*qirā’āt*) — though bibliographical sources are not fully consistent on the exact list and titles of his minor works, and later attributions should be treated with appropriate caution. (Note: the celebrated *Kanz al-Ma‘ānī fī Sharḥ Ḥirz al-Amānī* is the classical commentary on al-Shāṭibiyyah by Abū Shāmah al-Maqdisī, d. 665 AH — a distinct scholar writing roughly five centuries before al-Jamzūrī — and should not be confused with any of al-Jamzūrī’s own works.)

Al-Jamzūrī’s exact death date is not securely recorded; the last confirmed evidence of his activity is 1208 AH, the year in which he completed *Al-Fatḥ al-Raḥmānī*, and he is conventionally said to have died not long after, around the turn of the 13th century AH. What distinguishes his legacy from that of many contemporaries working in the same field is not the volume of his output but its extraordinary pedagogical success: the *Tuḥfah* has been continuously taught, memorized, and recited in Qur’ānic schools from Morocco to Indonesia for well over two centuries, making al-Jamzūrī, by any reasonable measure, one of the most widely read Arabic authors in history — a distinction owed entirely to sixty-one lines of *rajaz* verse composed for children.

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ABOUT THE EDITOR

Ahmad Sulaimiy is the editor, translator, and annotator of this edition, and the founder of Al-Mulk International University, Texas. His work focuses on making classical Islamic texts accessible to English-speaking students without sacrificing scholarly precision. This critical edition of *Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl* reflects that commitment: a text that has shaped Qur'ānic recitation for over two centuries, presented with the linguistic, rhetorical, and phonetic apparatus that a serious student of Tajwīd deserves — and checked, verse by verse, against the primary sources before publication.

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FUTURE PUBLICATIONS

Further volumes in the Critical Editions in Qur'ānic Studies series, and revised printings of this edition incorporating further review and reader feedback, will be announced through AL-MULK INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY.

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COLOPHON

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APPENDIX D

COMPANION QUICK-REFERENCE GUIDE

A Clear and Simple Guide to Tajwīd

What follows is a considerably shorter and simpler treatment of the same poem — offered here as a companion to the critical edition preceding it, not a replacement for it. Where the critical edition provides full linguistic, rhetorical, and phonetic analysis of every verse, this guide distills each rule to its essentials: what it is, when it applies, and one practical example.

Readers new to Tajwīd may find it useful to begin here before tackling the fuller critical edition; readers who have already worked through the critical edition may find it a convenient quick-reference summary for review.

Nūn Sākinah and Tanwīn (the four rules: Iẓhār, Idghām, Iqlāb, Ikhfā')

Mīm Sākinah (the three rules: Ikhfā' Shafawī, Idghām, Iẓhār)

Lām of the Definite Article Al- (Moon and Sun letters)

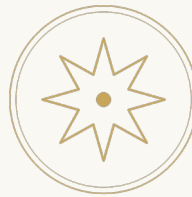
Madd (prolongation) – Natural, Connected, Separated, Compulsory, and more

The Disconnected Letters at the start of some Sūrahs

Let's begin.

PART 1

البَابُ





What are Nūn Sākinah and Tanwīn?

— Nūn Sākinah (نْ): The letter nūn with a small circle (sukūn) on top. It has no vowel after it.

Example: مِنْ (min), أَنْعَمْتَ (an‘amta).

— Tanwīn (ً): The double vowel at the end of a noun. It is actually a hidden nūn sound.

Example: كِتَابٌ (kitābun), كِتَابًا (kitāban), كِتَابِ (kitābin).

Both follow four rules depending on the letter that comes next.

THE VERSE

لِلنُّونِ إِنْ تَسْكُنْ وَلِلتَّانِوِينِ
أَرْبَعٌ أَحْكَامٌ فَخُذْ بَيِّنِي

Transliteration:

Lin-nūni in taskun wa li-t-tanwīni

arba‘u aḥkāmin fa-khudhabyīni

Translation:

For the Nūn when it is without a vowel, and for the Tanwīn, there are four rulings – so take my explanation.

Rule 1: Izhār (Clear Pronunciation)

When?

The next letter is one of the six throat letters:

ء ه ع ح غ خ

What to do?

Pronounce the nūn sound clearly and sharply, without any extra nasal hum. Then move to the throat letter.

Mnemonic (Verse):

هَمْزٌ فَهَاءٌ ثُمَّ عَيْنٌ حَاءٌ
مُهْمَلَتَانِ ثُمَّ غَيْنٌ خَاءٌ

Transliteration:

Hamzun fa-hā‘un thumma ‘aynun ḥā‘u

muhmalatāni thumma ghaynun khā‘u

Translation:

Hamzah, then Hā', then 'Ayn, then Ḥā' – both [latter] are unpointed – then Ghayn, then Khā'.

Examples from the Qur'ān:

Example Transliteration How to Pronounce

مِنْ أَهْلِ min ahli min (clear) then ahli

عَذَابِ أَلِيمٍ 'adhābun alīm 'adhābun (clear n) then alīm

مِنْ خَيْرٍ min khayr min (clear) then khayr

Rule 2: Idghām (Merging)

When?

The next letter is one of these six letters:

ي ر م ل و ن

They are remembered by the word يَرْمُلُونَ (yarmulūna).

What to do?

The nūn disappears and merges into the next letter. That next letter becomes doubled (it gets a shaddah).

THE VERSE:

وَالثَّانِي إِدْغَامُ بَسْطَةِ أَتَتْ
فِي يَرْمُلُونَ عِنْدَهُمْ قَدْ ثَبَّتَتْ

Transliteration:

Wa-th-thānī idghāmun bi-sittatin atat

fi yarmulūna 'indahum qad thabatat

Translation:

The second is Idghām, with six letters that have come together in "YARMULŪNA"; according to them [the scholars], they are firmly established.

Idghām has two types:

A. Idghām with Ghunnah (Nasal Hum)

- Letters: ي ر م ل و ن – remembered by يَرْمُلُونَ (yanmū)
- How: Merge the nūn, but keep a nasal hum (ghunnah) for 2 counts.
- Example: مِنْ يَوْمِهِمْ (min yawmihim) → say miyy-yawmihim.

B. Idghām without Ghunnah (No Nasal Hum)

- Letters: ل ر

- How: Merge the nūn completely with no nasal hum.
- Example: مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ (min rabbiḥim) → say mirr-rabbiḥim.

The Verse for the Two Types:

لَكِنَّهَا قِسْمَانِ قِسْمٌ يُدْغَمُ
فِيهِ بَغْنَةٌ يَنْمُو عَلَيَا
وَالثَّانِ إِدْغَامٌ بَغَيْرِ غَنَةٍ
فِي اللَّامِ وَالرَّاءِ ثُمَّ كَرَّرْنَاهُ

Transliteration:

Lakinnahā qismāni qismun yudghamā

fīhi bi-ghunnatin bi-yanmū ‘ulimā

wa-th-thānī idghāmun bi-ghayri ghunnah

fi l-lāmi wa-r-rā thumma karrirannah

Translation:

But they are two divisions: one division is merged with a ghunnah – it is known by "YANMŪ". The second is Idghām without ghunnah, in [the letters] Lām and Rā’ – so repeat them [to practise]!

Examples:

Type Example Pronunciation

With ghunnah مِنْ مَاءٍ (min mā’īn) mimm-mā’īn

With ghunnah مِنْ وَالٍ (min wālin) miww-wālin

Without ghunnah مِنْ لَدُنْهُ (min ladunhu) mill-ladunhu

Without ghunnah مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ (min rabbiḥim) mirr-rabbiḥim

Important Exception: Iẓhār Muṭlaq (Absolute Clarity)

If the nūn sākinah and the Idghām letter are inside the same word, you do not merge. You pronounce the nūn clearly.

This happens in only four words in the Qur’ān:

Word Transliteration Meaning

دُنْيَا dunyā world

بُنْيَانٍ bunyān structure

صِنَوَانٍ ṣinwān twin palm trees

قِنْوَانٌ qinwān clusters of dates

THE VERSE:

إِلَّا إِذَا كَانَا بِكَلِمَةٍ فَلَا
تُدْغِمُ كَدُنْيَا ثُمَّ صِنْوَانٌ تَلَا

Transliteration:

Illā idhā kānā bi-kilmatin fa-lā

tudghim ka-dunyā thumma ṣinwānun talā

Translation:

Except when they both occur in one word – then do not merge! Like "dunyā", and then "ṣinwān" follows.

Rule 3: Iqlāb (Conversion)

When?

The next letter is ب (bā') only.

What to do?

- Do not pronounce a clear nūn.
- Change the nūn into a hidden mīm.
- Hum a nasal sound (ghunnah) for 2 counts with your lips lightly closed.
- Then open your lips for the bā'.

THE VERSE:

وَالثَّالِثُ الْإِقْلَابُ عِنْدَ الْبَاءِ
مِيمًا بَغْنَةً مَعَ الْإِخْفَاءِ

Transliteration:

Wa-th-thālithu l-iqlābu 'inda l-bā'i

mīman bi-ghunnatin ma'a l-ikhfā'i

Translation:

The third is Iqlāb, before [the letter] Bā' – [it becomes] a Mīm with a ghunnah, along with hiding.

Examples:

Example Transliteration Pronunciation

مِنْ بَعْدِ min ba'di mimm-ba'di (light hummed m)

سَمِيعٌ بِصِيرٍ samī'un baṣīr samī'umm-baṣīr

أَنْبِيَهُمْ anbi'hum amm-bi'hum

Rule 4: Ikhfā' (Hiding)

When?

The next letter is any of the remaining 15 letters – not the six throat letters, not the six Idghām letters, and not bā'.

The 15 letters are the first letters of the words in this famous verse:

صَفْ ذَا ثَنَا كَمْ جَادَ شَخْصٌ قَدْ سَمَا
دُمَ طَيِّبًا زِدْ فِي تَقَى ضَعْ ظَالِمًا

Transliteration:

ṣif dhā thanā kam jāda shakhṣun qad samā

dum ṭayyiban zid fī tuqan ḍa' ḡālimā

Translation:

Describe the one of praise; how many a person has excelled and risen high! Remain good; increase in piety; put down the oppressor!

The letters are:

ص ذ ث ك ج ش ق س د ط ز ف ت ض ظ

What to do?

- Do not pronounce a clear nūn.
- Do not fully merge it.
- Instead, hide the nūn and let a nasal hum (ghunnah) last for 2 counts.
- Then move to the next letter.

THE VERSE:

وَالرَّابِعُ الْإِخْفَاءُ عِنْدَ الْفَاضِلِ
مِنَ الْحُرُوفِ وَاجِبٌ لِلْفَاضِلِ

Transliteration:

Wa-r-rābi'u l-ikhfā'u 'inda l-fāḍili

mina l-ḥurūfi wājibun li-l-fāḍili

Translation:

The fourth is Ikhfā', according to the eminent one, from the [rest of the] letters; it is obligatory for the excellent reciter.

Examples:

Example Transliteration Pronunciation

مِنْ شَرٍّ min sharr minnn-sharr (2-count hum)

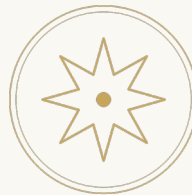
مِنْ قَبْلٍ min qablu minnn-qablu

مِنْ طِينٍ min ṭīn minnn-ṭīn

أَنْ تَقُولُوا an taqūlū annn-taqūlū

PART 2

البَابُ





What is Mīm Sākinah?

The letter م (mīm) with a sukūn (no vowel). Example: لَهُمْ (lahum), أَمْ (am).

It has three rules depending on the next letter.

THE VERSE

وَالْمِيمُ إِنْ تَسَكُنَ تَجِي قَبْلَ الْهَجَا
لَا أَلْفَ لَيِّنَةٍ لَذِي الْحَجَا
أَحْكَامُهَا ثَلَاثَةٌ لِمَنْ ضَبَطَ
إِخْفَاءٌ ادْغَامٌ وَإِظْهَارٌ فَقَطْ

Transliteration:

Wa-l-mīmu in taskun tajī qabla l-hijā

lā alifin layyinatin li-dhī l-ḥijā

aḥkāmuḥā thalāthatun li-man ḍabat

ikhfā'un idghāmun wa-iẓḥārun faqat

Translation:

And the Mīm, when it is without a vowel and comes before the alphabet letters – except the soft Alif – for the one of intellect: its rulings are three for the one who is precise – Ikhfā', Idghām, and Iẓhār only.

Rule 1: Ikhfā' Shafawī (Labial Hiding)

When?

The next letter is ب (bā').

What to do?

Hide the mīm with a light lip closure and hum (ghunnah) for 2 counts, then pronounce the bā'.

THE VERSE:

فَالْأَوَّلُ الْإِخْفَاءُ عِنْدَ الْبَاءِ
وَسَمِعَ الشَّفَوِيَّ لِلْقُرَّاءِ

Transliteration:

Fa-l-awwalu l-ikhfā'u 'inda l-bā'i

wa-sammihi sh-shafawiyya li-l-qurrā'i

Translation:

The first is Ikhfā' before [the letter] Bā' – and call it the Labial [Hiding] according to the reciters.

Example:

Example Transliteration Pronunciation

لَهُمْ بِهِ lahūm bihi lahum-m-bihi (hummed m)

تَرْمِيهِمْ بِحِجَارَةٍ tarmīhim biḥijārah tarmīhim-m-biḥijārah

Rule 2: Idghām (Merging with another Mīm)

When?

The next letter is م (mīm).

What to do?

Merge the two mīms into one doubled mīm with a 2-count ghunnah.

THE VERSE:

وَالثَّانِ إِدْغَامٌ بِمِثْلِهَا أَتَى
وَسَمِّ إِدْغَامًا صَغِيرًا يَا فَتَى

Transliteration:

Wa-th-thānī idghāmūn bi-mithlihā atā

wa-sammi idghāman ṣaghīran yā fatā

Translation:

The second is Idghām with a letter like itself – and call it Small Idghām, O young man.

Example:

Example Transliteration Pronunciation

لَهُمْ مَا lahūm mā lahum-mā (doubled m)

كَامٍ مِنْ kam min kamm-min

Rule 3: Izhār Shafawī (Labial Clarity)

When?

The next letter is any other letter (except bā' and mīm).

What to do?

Pronounce the mīm clearly with no extra hum.

THE VERSE:

وَالثَّالِثُ الْإِظْهَارُ فِي الْبَقِيَّةِ

مِنْ أَحْرَفٍ وَسَمِّهَا شَفْوِيَّةٌ

Transliteration:

Wa-th-thālithu l-izhāru fi l-baqiyyah

min aḥrufin wa-sammihā shafawiyyah

Translation:

The third is Izhār before the remainder of the letters – and call it Labial.

⚠ Special Warning:

Be extra careful before و (wāw) and ف (fā'). Because they are close to the mīm in pronunciation, you might accidentally hide the mīm. You must pronounce it clearly!

THE VERSE:

وَاحْذَرْ لَدَى وَآوِ وَأَنْ تَخْتَفِيَ
لِقُرْبِهَا وَلَا تَحَادِ فَأَعْرِفْ

Transliteration:

Wa-ḥdhar ladā wāwin wa-fā an takhtaḥfi

li-qurbihā wa-li-ttiḥādi fa-ʿrif

Translation:

And beware before Wāw and Fā' lest it [the Mīm] be hidden – because of their closeness and similarity, so know this!

Examples:

Example Transliteration Pronunciation

لَهُمْ أَجْرٌ lahum ajrun clear m

وَعَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا alayhim wa-lā clear m (do not hum)

هُمْ فِيهَا hum fihā clear m (do not hum)

PART 3

الْبَابُ





The definite article in Arabic is ال (al-). The lām in this article has two possible pronunciations depending on the letter that follows.

THE VERSE

لَلَّامِ أَلْ حَالَانِ قَبْلَ الْأَحْرِفِ
أُولَاهُمَا إِظْهَارُهَا فَلْتَعْرِفِ

Transliteration:

Li-lāmi 'al ḥālāni qabla l-aḥrufi

'ulāhumā 'iẓhāruhā fa-l-ta'rifi

Translation:

For the Lām of Al- there are two states before the letters. The first of them is its clear pronunciation – so know it!

Rule 1: Moon Letters – Clear Lām (Iẓhār Qamarī)

When?

The next letter is one of 14 Moon Letters. They are the first letters of this phrase:

إِبْغِ حَجَّكَ وَخَفْ عَقِيمَهُ

'Ibghi ḥajjaka wa-khaf 'aqīmah

(Seek your pilgrimage and fear its barrenness)

The letters: ء ب غ ح ج ك و خ ف ع ق ي م ه

What to do?

Pronounce the lām clearly.

Example: الْقَمَرُ (al-qamaru) – clear l.

Rule 2: Sun Letters – Merged Lām (Idghām Shamsī)

When?

The next letter is one of 14 Sun Letters. They are the first letters of the words in this famous verse:

طِبْ ثُمَّ صَلِّ رَحِمًا تَفُزْ ضِفْ ذَا نَعَمْ
دَعِ سَوْءَ ظَنِّ زُرْ شَرِيفًا لِلْكَرَمِ

Transliteration:

Ṭib thumma ṣil raḥīman tafuz ḍif dhā ni'am

da' sū'a ẓannin zur sharīfan li-l-karam

Translation:

Be pleasant, then maintain ties of kinship – you will succeed; be a guest of the possessor of blessings.
Abandon evil suspicion; visit a noble person for generosity.

The letters: ط ث ص ر ت ض ذ ن د س ظ ز ش ل

What to do?

The lām is completely merged into the next letter, which becomes doubled (gets a shaddah).

Example: الشَّمْسُ (ash-shamsu) – the lām disappears, and the shīn is doubled.

The Verse for Both Types:

وَاللَّامَ الْأُولَى سَمَّهَا قَمَرِيَّةً
وَاللَّامَ الْأُخْرَى سَمَّهَا شَمْسِيَّةً

Transliteration:

Wa-l-lāma l-ʿulā sammihā qamariyyah

wa-l-lāma l-ʿukhrā sammihā shamsiyyah

Translation:

And call the first Lām a Moon [Lām], and call the other Lām a Sun [Lām].

Special Note: Lām of a Verb

The lām that is part of a verb (like قُلْ qul, قُلْنَا qulnā, اِلْتَقَى iltaqā) is always pronounced clearly – never merged.

THE VERSE:

وَأَظْهَرَنَّ لَامَ فِعْلٍ مُطْلَقًا
فِي نَحْوِ قُلْ نَعَمْ وَقُلْنَا وَالتَّقَى

Transliteration:

Wa-ʾaẓhiranna lāma fiʿlin muṭlaqan

fi naḥwī qul naʿam wa-qulnā wa-ltaqā

Translation:

And you must always pronounce the Lām of a verb clearly – as in "qul", "naʿam", "qulnā", and "iltaqā".

PART 4

البَابُ





What is Madd?

Madd means stretching or prolonging the sound of a long vowel. There are three long vowels in Arabic:

Long Vowel Letter Example Sound

ā | (alif) قَالَ (qāla) "aa" as in "father"

ū | (wāw) يَقُولُ (yaqūlu) "oo" as in "moon"

ī | (yā) قِيلَ (qīla) "ee" as in "seen"

Madd is divided into two main types: Natural Madd and Secondary Madd.

Natural Madd (Al-Madd al-Ṭabīʿī)

When?

The long vowel is not followed by a hamzah (ء) or a sukūn (◌ْ).

How long?

Exactly 2 counts (the time it takes to say two short vowels).

The Verses:

وَالْمَدُّ أَصْلِيٌّ وَفَرَعِيٌّ لَهُ
وَسَمٌّ أَوَّلًا طَبِيعِيًّا وَهُوَ
مَا لَا تَوَقُّفَ لَهُ عَلَى سَبَبٍ
وَلَا بِدُونِهِ الْحُرُوفُ تُجْتَلَبُ

Transliteration:

Wa-l-maddu 'aşliyyun wa-far'iiyyun lah

wa-sammi 'awwalan ṭabī'iiyyan wa-hū

mā lā tawaqqufun lahū 'alā sabab

wa-lā bidūnihi l-ḥurūfu tujtalab

Translation:

Madd is Original and Branching. Call the first one Natural. It is that which does not depend on any cause, and without it the letters [of Madd] cannot be produced.

Examples:

Example Transliteration Pronunciation

قَالَ qāla qaa-la (2 counts)

يَقُولُ yaqūlu yaqoo-lu (2 counts)

قِيلَ qīla qee-la (2 counts)

Secondary Madd (Al-Madd al-Far'i)

This happens when the long vowel is followed by a hamzah or a sukūn. It is longer than 2 counts.

A. Madd Muttasil (Connected Madd)

When?

The long vowel and the hamzah are in the same word.

How long?

4 or 5 counts (obligatory to lengthen).

THE VERSE:

فَوَاجِبٌ إِنْ جَاءَ هَمْزٌ بَعْدَ مَدٍّ
فِي كَلِمَةٍ وَذَا بِمُتَّصِلٍ يُعَدُّ

Transliteration:

Fa-wājibun 'in jā'a hamzun ba'da mad

fī kilmatin wa-dhā bi-muttaṣil yu'ad

Translation:

It is obligatory if a hamzah comes after a Madd letter in one word – and this is counted as Muttasil.

Example: جَاءَ (jā'a) – say jāāāā-'a (4–5 counts).

B. Madd Munfaṣil (Separated Madd)

When?

The long vowel is at the end of one word, and the hamzah is at the start of the next word.

How long?

4 or 5 counts (permissible; you may also shorten to 2 counts).

THE VERSE:

وَجَائِزٌ مَدٌّ وَقَصْرٌ إِنْ فُصِّلَ
كُلُّ بِكَلِمَةٍ وَهَذَا الْمُنْفَصِلُ

Transliteration:

Wa-jā'izun maddun wa-qaṣrun 'in fuṣil

kullun bi-kilmatin wa-hādhā l-munfaṣil

Translation:

And it is permissible to lengthen or shorten if each is separated by a word – and this is Munfaṣil.

Example: قَالُوا آمَنَّا (qālū 'āmannā) – qālūūūū 'āmannā (4-5 counts) or qālū 'āmannā (2 counts).

C. Madd 'Āriḍ li-l-Sukūn (Temporary Madd due to Pause)

When?

You pause on a word that ends with a long vowel followed by a consonant that becomes still.

How long?

2, 4, or 6 counts (all are allowed).

THE VERSE:

وَمِثْلُ ذَا إِنْ عَرَضَ السُّكُونُ
وَقَفَّا كَتَعْلَمُونَ نَسْتَعِينُ

Transliteration:

Wa-mithlu dhā 'in 'araḍa s-sukūnu

waqfa ka-ta'lamūna nasta'in

Translation:

And similar to this [the permissibility] if a sukūn occurs due to pause – like "ta'lamūna" and "nasta'in".

Example: تَعْلَمُونَ (ta'lamūn) – when you pause, say ta'lamūūūūn (2, 4, or 6 counts).

D. Madd Badal (Substitution Madd)

When?

A hamzah comes before the long vowel.

How long?

2 counts (treated like Natural Madd in the reading of Ḥaḍḥ).

THE VERSE:

أَوْ قَدْ هَمَزُ عَلَى الْمَدِّ وَذَا
بَدَلْ كَأَمْنُوا وَإِيمَانًا خُذَا

Transliteration:

'Aw quddima l-hamzu 'alā l-maddi wa-dhā

badal ka-'āmanū wa-'imānan khudhā

Translation:

Or if the hamzah precedes the Madd letter – this is Badal – like "āmanū" and "īmānan"; take [these examples]!

Example: آمَنُوا (āmanū) – say 'aa-manū (2 counts).

E. Madd Lāzim (Compulsory Madd)

When?

The long vowel is followed by an original sukūn (a permanent still letter, like the first part of a shaddah).

How long?

6 counts – absolutely no shortening allowed.

THE VERSE:

وَلَا زِمُ إِنْ السُّكُونُ أَصْلًا
وَصَلًا وَوَقْفًا بَعْدَ مَدٍّ طَوَّلًا

Transliteration:

Wa-lāzimun 'ini s-sukūnu 'uṣṣilā

waṣlan wa-waqfan ba'da maddin ṭuwwilā

Translation:

And it is Compulsory if the sukūn is original – both in continuation and pause – after a Madd letter that is prolonged.

Example: الْحَاقَّةُ (al-ḥāqqah) – say al-ḥāāāāāāqqah (6 counts).

The shaddah on the qāf contains an original sukūn.

PART 5

الْبَابُ





Some Sūrahs begin with mysterious letters, like الم (Alif-Lām-Mīm), يس (Yā-Sīn), طه (Ṭā-Hā).

These letters are pronounced according to their spelling.

Letter Spelling Madd Duration Example

ا (alif) 2 أَلِف counts 'alif

ح (ḥā') 2 حَا counts ḥā

ي (yā') 2 يَا counts yā

ط (ṭā') 2 طَا counts ṭā

ه (hā') 2 هَا counts hā

ر (rā') 2 رَا counts rā

ك (kāf) 6 كَاف counts kāāāāāf

م (mīm) 6 مِيم counts mīīīīīim

ع ('ayn) 6 عَيْن counts *'ayyyn? actually 'ayyyn is 2? Wait, 'ayn is spelled عَيْن – yā' is madd, followed by nūn with sukūn → 6 counts

س (sīn) 6 سَيْن counts sīīīīīin

ل (lām) 6 لَام counts lāāāāāām

ن (nūn) 6 نُون counts nūūūūūn

ق (qāf) 6 قَاف counts qāāāāāaf

ص (ṣād) 6 صَاد counts ṣāāāāāad

Mnemonic for the 6-count letters:

كَمْ عَسَلْ نَقَصَ

Kam 'asal naqaṣ

(How much honey diminished?)

Letters: ك م ع س ل ن ق ص

Mnemonic for the 2-count letters:

حَيِّ طَاهِرٌ

Ḥayyun ṭāhirun

(Living, Pure)

Letters: ح ي ط ه ر (plus ا)

The Verse for All 14 Letters:

وَيَجْمَعُ الْفَوَاتِحَ الْأَرْبَعَ عَشَرَ
صَلِّهِ سَحِيرًا مَنْ قَطَعَكَذَا اشْتَهَرَ

Transliteration:

Wa-yajma'u l-fawātiḥa l-'arba'a 'ashar

ṣilhu suḥayran man qaṭa'ka dhā shtahar

Translation:

And the phrase "Ṣilhu suḥayran man qaṭa'ka dhā shtahar" collects the fourteen openings.

CONCLUSION

الْبَابُ

Conclusion



This guide has covered the essential rules of Tuḥfat al-Aṭfāl in a simple, practical way. You now know:

- The four rules for Nūn Sākinah and Tanwīn
- The three rules for Mīm Sākinah
- The Moon and Sun letters for the definite article Al-
- The different types of Madd and how long to prolong each
- How to pronounce the disconnected letters at the start of Sūrahs

Keep practising with a teacher or by listening to skilled reciters. May Allah make your journey in learning the Qur'ān easy and rewarding!

والحمد لله رب العالمين

Wa-l-ḥamdu li-llāhi rabbi l-'ālamīn

And praise be to Allah, Lord of the worlds.

TUḤFAT AL-AṬFĀL

Sixty-one verses. Eight parts. Two centuries of continuous transmission from a village in the Nile Delta to Qur'ān schools on every inhabited continent.

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